

FRIDAY, AUGUST 7, 2026



The Indian EXPRESS

JOURNALISM of COURAGE

NEW DELHI, LATE CITY, 24 PAGES

₹7.00 (₹8 RAIPUR, ₹15 SRINAGAR) • www.indianexpress.com

DAILY FROM: AHMEDABAD, CHANDIGARH, DELHI, JAIPUR, KOLKATA, LUCKNOW, MUMBAI, NAGPUR, PATNA, PUNE, VADODARA

EXPRESS investigation

Govt deep-tech fund: Rs 2,192 cr cleared, 62% goes to firms linked to panel that chose them

15 of 22 firms chosen have links to seven members in selection panel; members say they disclosed their interests, recused; it's public money, need guardrails, says MP who flagged issue

Amitabh Sinha & Sandeep Singh
New Delhi, August 6

A NEW public fund to boost India's deep-tech ambitions in the private sector has approved, in its first round, Rs 2,192 crore in soft loans to 22 private companies at the cutting edge of space science, energy tech and pharma, among others. These companies were chosen from 124 applicants by a 12-member panel, including 11 established names in private equity and technology, and a non-voting government representative. The credentials of each company are well-established.

There's one question mark, though. An investigation by *The Indian Express* has found that of the 22 recipients of public money, 15 have investment ties to seven members of the selection committee, raising questions of conflict of interest and propriety. These together got over Rs 1,377 crore. Nine of the firms are linked to the chairman of the selection panel, the founder of an angel investing network who also has a personal stake in at least one of the companies selected.

These members are part of the Investment Committee of the Technology Development Board (TDB), one of the two organisations under the Ministry

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

• Which firm got how much, what's the link

Saurabh Srivastava

Former Chairman, NASSCOM & IVCA and Co-founder, Indian Angel Network

Company & funding approved

- **Noccarc Robotics** (Medical) **₹11.41 cr**
- **EndureAir Systems** (Advanced Manufacturing) **₹30.01 cr**
- **e-TRNL Energy** (Energy) **₹94 cr**
- **Dhruva Space** (Space) **₹105 cr**
- **BigEndian** (Semiconductors) **₹130 cr**
- **Astrome Technologies** (Space) **₹64.05 cr**
- **Peptris Technologies** (Pharma) **₹86 cr**
- **Serigen Mediproducts**, (Medical) **₹20 cr**
- **Manastu Space Technologies** (Space) **₹116 cr**

K.R.S. Jamwal

Former Executive Director Tata Industries Ltd.

- **Noccarc Robotics**
- **EndureAir Systems**
- **Tejas Networks** (Digital Infra) **₹250 cr**
- **BigEndian**
- **Peptris Technologies**,
- **ThinkMetal** (Advanced Manufacturing) **₹6.7 cr**
- **Manastu Space Technologies**

Debashish Bhattacharjee

Former Vice President (Technology



TASHI TOBGYAL

Dept of Science & Technology.

and R&D), Tata Steel, Managing Partner, Lionstead Ventures & TDB Board Member

- **Neo Seeker Metals** (Minerals, metals) **₹10 cr**

Sanjay Nayak

Former CEO & Co-founder, Tejas Networks Ltd.

- **Ather Energy** (Semiconductors) **₹211.89 cr**
- **Tejas Networks**

Anand Deshpande

Chairman, Persistent System

- **Serigen Mediproducts**

Gopal Srinivasan

Chairman & MD, TVS Capitals Fund

- **Agnikul Cosmos** (Space) **₹200 cr**
- **Sudhir Mehta**

Founder and Chairman, Pinnacle Industries and EKA Mobility

- **Replus Engitech** (Energy) **₹42.75 cr**

RDIFUNDING APPROVED IN ₹CR, SOURCE: DEPARTMENT OF SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY, RoC RECORDS

Soft loan for R&D in private sector to cut red tape: How it works

Amitabh Sinha
New Delhi, August 6

THE RESEARCH, Development and Innovation (RDI) Fund, with a corpus of Rs 1 lakh crore, was created by the Government last year to provide collateral-free, low-cost, long-term loans to private sector companies engaged in advanced research and innovation in priority deep-tech sectors like artificial intelligence, quantum technology, space science, defence, robotics, clean energy, semiconductors and digital healthcare.

Who administers the fund?

The fund is housed under the Anusandhan National Research Foundation (ANRF), a recently established statutory body under the Ministry of Science and Technology to promote research and innovation, especially in the university system, mobilise additional financial resources for R&D activities, and strengthen industry-academia collaborations. A Special Purpose Fund (SPF) has been created under ANRF, which is the custodian of money allocated for the RDI Fund.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

IF GEN Z IS PROTESTING, IT IS NOT ANTI-NATIONAL, HE SAYS AT MEETING WITH YOUTH

RSS chief: Gen Z grievances real, protest way of dialogue

Leadership brings image of someone giving speeches, winning elections... it doesn't work that way, says Bhagwat

Shubhangi Khapre

Mumbai, August 6



Bhagwat in Mumbai, Thursday. AP

as anti-national, and said reforms in education must come through dialogue.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Experts relied on chits, memory to leak NEET questions: CBI probe

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, August 6

THE CBI probe into the NEET (UG) paper leak has found that three subject experts took exam questions out of the National Testing Agency (NTA) office in Delhi using different methods — one scrawled questions on paper chits before hiding them while two others memorised the questions, returned to their

hotel rooms to either write them down or mark the relevant paragraphs in NCERT textbooks.

And, according to the CBI, they could do this because they were not frisked while exiting the "confidential section", a wing situated on the first floor of the NTA office, which also lacked a dedicated CCTV live feed monitoring control room.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

HC overrules acquittal of Tejpal, sentences him to 10 years in jail for rape

Pavneet Singh Chadha

Panaji, August 6



Ex-Tehelka editor-in-chief Tarun Tejpal in Panaji, Thursday. ANI

UNDERLINING THAT notions of a "perfect victim" are a myth and neither the court nor the respondent can decide how she should react or process her trauma, the High Court of Bombay at Goa Thursday overturned the 2021 trial court

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Consider Opp request for Shah presence in House, RS Chairman tells Govt

Nikhil Ghanekar

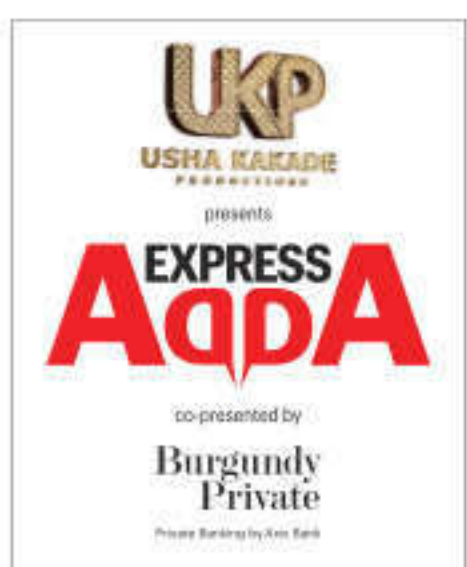
New Delhi, August 6

AMID OPPOSITION demands for a statement in the House by Union Home Minister Amit Shah on the July 20 police action on protesters marching towards Parliament from Jantar Mantar, Rajya Sabha Chairman and Vice-President CP Radhakrishnan told Parliamentary Af-

fairs Minister Kiren Rijiju Thursday to "echo the sentiments of the Opposition" to Shah and "consider the request" for his presence in the House.

Radhakrishnan made the remarks amid interruptions after House proceedings had resumed at noon after an adjournment. After Question Hour began, disruptions

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



In Conversation with Ted Sarandos

Netflix co-CEO Ted Sarandos in conversation with Anant Goenka, Executive Director, Indian Express Group, at Express Adda in New Delhi on Thursday. RENUKA PURI

Happening today

• **UNION EDUCATION** Minister Pralhad Joshi will lead deliberations at the BRICS Education Ministers' meet in Bhubaneswar, aimed at deepening cooperation among member countries.

TRACK THIS AND MORE ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Business as Usual

By EP UNNY

Will the Hon'ble Minister of Cooperation address the House on the National Handloom Day?



• THE AIM: PREVENT REPEAT OF MONKEY SIGHTING, BIRD POOP DROP AT IG STADIUM

Anti-pigeon gel, sound machines: All set for badminton world meet

PAGE 1 anchor

Prithish Raj

New Delhi, August 6

NON-TOXIC slippery gel to prevent pigeons from perching over courts; specialised machines imported from the US that mimic the sound of predatory birds; reinforced glass doors to prevent unauthorised entry during matches.

These are some of the measures taken by organisers at the IG Indoor Stadium for the BWF World Championships starting in New Delhi on August 17. Their aim: prevent a repeat of incidents, such as a monkey sighting, and falling pigeon poop and fragments of



Glass gates installed at IG Indoor Stadium in New Delhi. PRITHISH RAJ

nests on the court, which marred the India Open in January and left officials red-faced.

"We will equip the whole arena with 24/7 security, and the glass gates will make sure that there are no distractions when the event is going on. We

are using a slippery, non-toxic bird deterrent gel. We also have sound machines to keep the pigeons away," Badminton Association of India (BAI) secretary Sanjay Mishra told *The Indian Express*.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

DO YOU WISH TO KNOW KRACK'S ZERO CALORIE RECIPE?

SCAN TO KNOW MORE

IT'S SWEET. IT'S SALTY.

And stand a chance to win Amazon vouchers*.

*Conditions Apply

YELLOW ALERT TODAY

Another wet day, brief waterlogging even as cleaning of drains continues in Delhi

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, August 6

THE STENCH of wet sludge hung in the air outside Govindpur Metro station on Thursday as commuters stepped around heaps of freshly-dredged muck from a roadside stormwater drain, hours after heavy morning showers lashed Delhi and prompted the India Meteorological Department (IMD) to issue a red alert across most of the Capital.

With 56 mm of rainfall recorded at Safdarjung — the base station for Delhi — as of Thursday night, the city has received 67.8 mm of showers, nearly 29% of its total normal August rainfall of 233.1 mm, as per the IMD.

Throughout the day, contractual sanitation workers remained bent over open drains, loosening compacted silt with iron rods before lifting it out with a shovel, as fresh rainfall carried silt, debris and waste into the drainage system.

The Public Works Department (PWD) had earlier said that it had completed nearly 90% of the annual desilting exercise across its road network before the onset of monsoon.

Govind from Uttar Pradesh, who was clearing a drain near the Govindpur Metro station, said, "We have been doing this for months, but the workload increases during the monsoon. Even when it is raining, we are outside clearing the drains. People throw garbage into them, which blocks the flow and makes our work harder."

Meenu, who runs a roadside stall near the station, said, "Workers keep coming here, but during the rainy season, they come more often because the drains fill up quickly."

Mahesh, a contractual sanitation worker from Madhya Pradesh, said every spell of rain brings fresh deposits into the drains. "Rain washes mud, garbage and construction waste into the drains. If roads are not cleaned properly, we have to keep returning to clear them so they don't choke and cause waterlogging," he added.

According to Govind, similar teams of four to five workers have been deployed along the stretch from Chirag Delhi to Govindpur to carry out desilting and drain-cleaning operations through the monsoon.

A senior PWD official told *The Indian Express* that "removing sludge is a continuous process".

"During rain, construction debris, sludge and sewage enter the drainage system. Even after



(From top) A man covers himself amid heavy rain; desilting work underway and commuters make their way through an inundated road, in New Delhi on Thursday. AMIT MEHRA, TASHI TOBGYAL & ANI

scheduled desilting is completed, workers have to continue removing these deposits manually to keep drains functional," the official added.

According to PWD, as of July, 1,900.15 km of drains — around 90% of its 2,125.87-km network — had been desilted. It also removed around 12.7 lakh metric tonnes of silt from the Najafgarh drain — the largest component of the exercise — before the June 30 deadline to complete major pre-monsoon desilting across civic agencies.

Despite this, Thursday's rain led to brief waterlogging at vulnerable locations, including the Modi Mill flyover underpass near Okhla in Southeast Delhi and Bhairon Marg along

the Outer Ring Road in Central Delhi, slowing traffic.

The city had received light to moderate rainfall over the previous 24 hours, with Lodhi Road recording the highest rainfall (43.8 mm) until 8.30 am Thursday. It was followed by KVK CRPF Campus (28.5 mm), Narayana (27.5 mm), Palam (25.2 mm) and Safdarjung (18.7 mm).

The rain also brought temperatures down, with Safdarjung recording a maximum of 32.6°C, 1.6°C below normal while the minimum settled at 25.6°C, 1.3°C below normal.

The IMD has forecast generally cloudy skies with intermittent rainfall over the coming days, with a yellow alert in place for Friday.

Gurgaon: Work from home advised, MCG Commissioner transferred

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurgaon, August 6

A TWO-DAY 'work from home' advisory has been issued for Gurgaon after a relentless spell of rain beginning around 3 am threw normal life out of gear across the city on Thursday. Major arterial roads were inundated, low-lying residential sectors were submerged, and massive traffic snarls were seen during peak rush hours.

The Haryana government, meanwhile, transferred Municipal Corporation of Gurgaon (MCG) Commissioner Pradeep Dahiya, who was appointed in May last year. The move comes as the city continues to reel under persistent waterlogging following heavy rainfall.

While Dahiya was appointed the Deputy Commissioner of Rohtak, the government did not name a successor to Dahiya.

Gurgaon, which received 20 mm of rain between 8 am and 5 pm on Thursday, followed Sohna which recorded 30 mm of rain. Wazirabad recorded 26 mm of rain, followed by Badshahpur (25 mm) and Tehsil Manesar (22 mm). Gurgaon had recorded an average of 97 mm of rainfall between 8 am on Wednesday and 8 am on Thursday.

The India Meteorological Department issued an 'orange' alert for the city.

The District Disaster Management Authority issued an advisory urging all corporate offices and private establishments to allow employees to work from home on Thursday and Friday.



Vehicles waded through a flooded road in Gurgaon, Thursday. PTI

The advisory aimed to reduce vehicle density on flooded roads and allow civic agencies to undertake urgent drainage restoration and repair works.

The city police also issued a cautionary advisory, appealing to commuters to avoid unnecessary travel.

A general House sitting of the MCG scheduled for Thursday had to be postponed indefinitely owing to the rain.

Earlier in the day, Dahiya said corrective steps taken by the corporation ensured areas like Alpine School Road at Sector 10, I-Block in South City-2, Swagat Park in Sector-4, and the Government Middle School in Shivaji Nagar did not witness waterlogging.

ACP Traffic (HQ and Highways) Satpal Yadav asked residents to use public transport, and acknowledged the pressure on traffic due to both the rains and the diversions in place due to the Kanwar Yatra.

Deputy Commissioner of Police (Traffic) Prateek Gahlot

claimed that waterlogging hotspots were mapped well in advance. "Following joint civic inspections of the GMDA, MCG, and NHAI, choked drains were desilted and auxiliary drain connections were established to accelerate rainwater discharge. Crucial technical and structural overhauls were also executed at major bottlenecks, including Mahavir Chowk, Bristol Chowk, Atlas Chowk, and Shankar Chowk, to facilitate smoother traffic flow. To ensure safety of devotees during the ongoing Kanwar Yatra, lanes have been barricaded and pedestrian crossings regulated along key stretches," he said.

Gridlocks were reported from key junctions including Subhash Chowk, Rajiv Chowk, Hero Honda Chowk, Golf Course Extension Road, Old Delhi-Gurgaon Road, and the Gurgaon Expressway.

In several residential areas, roads were blocked by trees uprooted by the heavy rain and strong wind.

• Skywatch



Forecast: August 7, 2026

Generally cloudy sky. Moderate to heavy rain.

MAX: 31-33

1.2°C below normal

MIN: 22-24

2.4°C below normal

• Sunrise: 5:47 AM (August 8)

• Sunset: 7:08 PM (August 7)

• Moonrise: 12:33 AM (August 8)

• Moonset: 2:10 PM (August 7)

• AQI Tracker



Bawana
Satisfactory
AQI: 99

Anand Vihar
Moderate
AQI: 133

Shadipur
Good
AQI: 40

Aya Nagar
Satisfactory
AQI: 54

● Good (0-50)
● Satisfactory (51-100)
● Moderate (101-200)
● Poor (201-300)
● Very Poor (301-400)
● Severe (401-500)

Wanted for 27 years, murder accused found living double life as 'Dr Jhatka'

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 6

A FUGITIVE accused in multiple attempt to murder cases, wanted for killing a Haryana Police constable in 1998, and an audacious escape from police custody while still in handcuffs a year later — Rajinder Bairagi existed only in police records for over 27 years.

Till the law caught up with him.

Earlier this week, the Delhi Police Crime Branch found him in a small Madhya Pradesh town, where the 53-year-old had spent years as 'Dr Jhatka' — an unregistered medical practitioner, property dealer, husband, father of two teenagers, and, to neighbours, Rajender Singh Yadav.

But by then, Bairagi had changed his identity twice.

"After fleeing custody, he first travelled to Kolabain Maharashtra, where he allegedly worked as a physical education teacher in a Kendriya Vidyalaya for about a year. He later shifted to Mungaoli in Madhya Pradesh's Ashok Nagar district, adopted the name Rajender Singh Yadav and built an entirely new identity," said the DCP.

Police said in 2003, he married an auxiliary nurse midwife employed at a government hospital. He obtained an Aadhaar card, PAN card, driving licence, voter ID and domicile certificate under his new identity and became a familiar face in the town.

Through his wife, police said, Bairagi picked up basic medical knowledge and began treating patients. Local residents came to know him as Dr Jhatka who ran a small clinic and a property dealer.

Police said the name Dr Jhatka was coined by local residents due to Bairagi's looks. "They thought he looked like the character named Dr Jhatka in the animated series *Motu Patlu*, who was a potbellied man with a round face and a balding head," an officer said.

On the night of May 10, 1998, he allegedly attended a wedding at Saiyan Khara village in Haryana's Sonapat, where an argument broke out with members of the bride's family.

The argument soon turned violent, and Bairagi and five armed associates opened indiscriminate fire, said police.

"Haryana Police personnel Jai Bhagwan, who was related to the bride's family, died at the spot, while another person was critically injured," said DCP Chander Kumar Singh of the Crime Branch.

A murder case was registered at Gannaur police station, and Rajinder was put in jail.

But not for long.

On February 14, 1999, while being escorted by Uttar Pradesh Police from Ghaziabad Jail to a court in Sonapat, Bairagi escaped at Gannaur railway station despite being handcuffed.

Another FIR was registered against him for escaping lawful custody.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

As part of a drive to trace long-absconding proclaimed offenders, the Northern Range-1 unit of the Crime Branch reopened the files relating to Bairagi. He had been declared a proclaimed offender in both cases in 2008.

As investigators dug deeper into his past, they realised the fugitive they were looking for was also wanted in the murder of a Haryana Police officer and in several other criminal cases.

But by then, Bairagi had changed his identity twice.

"After fleeing custody, he first travelled to Kolabain Maharashtra, where he allegedly worked as a physical education teacher in a Kendriya Vidyalaya for about a year. He later shifted to Mungaoli in Madhya Pradesh's Ashok Nagar district, adopted the name Rajender Singh Yadav and built an entirely new identity," said the DCP.

Police said in 2003, he married an auxiliary nurse midwife employed at a government hospital. He obtained an Aadhaar card, PAN card, driving licence, voter ID and domicile certificate under his new identity and became a familiar face in the town.

Through his wife, police said, Bairagi picked up basic medical knowledge and began treating patients. Local residents came to know him as Dr Jhatka who ran a small clinic and a property dealer.

Police said the name Dr Jhatka was coined by local residents due to Bairagi's looks. "They thought he looked like the character named Dr Jhatka in the animated series *Motu Patlu*, who was a potbellied man with a round face and a balding head," an officer said.

On the night of May 10, 1998, he allegedly attended a wedding at Saiyan Khara village in Haryana's Sonapat, where an argument broke out with members of the bride's family.

The argument soon turned violent, and Bairagi and five armed associates opened indiscriminate fire, said police.

"Haryana Police personnel Jai Bhagwan, who was related to the bride's family, died at the spot, while another person was critically injured," said DCP Chander Kumar Singh of the Crime Branch.

A murder case was registered at Gannaur police station, and Rajinder was put in jail.

But not for long.

On February 14, 1999, while being escorted by Uttar Pradesh Police from Ghaziabad Jail to a court in Sonapat, Bairagi escaped at Gannaur railway station despite being handcuffed.

Another FIR was registered against him for escaping lawful custody.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

For the next 27 years, investigators from multiple states failed to trace him.

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 6

TO RESOLVE recurring waterlogging problems on NH-24 and other major flyovers and underpasses, PWD Minister Parvash Sahib Singh has directed the National Highway Authority of India (NHAI) to raise the level of roads in these areas.

Officials said that at a meeting of the UT Level Coordination Committee chaired by Singh on Wednesday, recurring waterlogging on NH 24, particularly at Patparganj and Pan-

dav Nagar underpasses, were discussed. Vulnerable locations, including Nausena Bhan, Parade Road/Thal Sena Bhawan Underpass, Mahipalpur T-Point and the R&R Hospital underpass were reviewed.

Singh asked PWD and NHAI to implement permanent engineering solutions to curb waterlogging on key traffic bottlenecks, officials said.

"Effective coordination among all departments is essential for infrastructure development. Clear responsibilities and timelines have been assigned to

every agency. Our priority is to eliminate inter-departmental bottlenecks and accelerate project execution..." an official quoted Singh as saying.

At the meeting, officials said, it was noted that PWD has already completed desilting of the concerned drain on NH 24. "Now, NHAI has been directed to raise the level of the road to ensure a permanent solution to the waterlogging issue," said an official.

"NHAI consultants were directed to submit detailed technical reports to facilitate per-

manent engineering interventions. All agencies were also instructed to jointly address drainage and sewer-related issues," the official added.

The meeting also reviewed progress on the Andheria Mor-NH 48 Corridor, utility shifting for the Rangpur Bypass Tunnel, the Rohtak Road Corridor, service roads and drainage infrastructure.

BSES was directed to complete the remaining technical formalities on priority, while all departments concerned were instructed to expedite pending

approvals and utility shifting to keep project timelines on track, said officials.

According to officials, the committee directed the Revenue department to complete pending land demarcation, mutation and other land-related formalities within stipulated timelines. It also emphasised close coordination with the Delhi Development Authority to expedite pending land-related issues concerning important highway projects.

Officials said it was directed that pending utility shifting, in-

principle approvals and no objection certificates relating to Delhi Jal Board infrastructure be processed on priority.

Further, the meeting discussed traffic congestion at Delhi's border entry points due to the presence of MCD toll plazas. NHAI and MCD were directed to jointly address operational bottlenecks and take action.

The committee also reviewed encroachments, unauthorised parking and traffic management along national highways.

Anusree KC & Reva Thakkar
New Delhi, August 6

A BRAIDED cane strap rests against Mitali Baruah's lower back, attached to a loom, as she sits on two jute cushions at the National Crafts Museum & Hastkala Academy in Pragati Maidan. One end of the traditional portable loom is tied to a wall, the other fastened around her waist. Every time she leans her body, the threads tighten — the weaver's body central to the loom.

The 57-year-old artisan from Guwahati is among four artisans demonstrating traditional weaving techniques at 'Know Your Weaves', an exhibition organised by the Ministry of Textiles ahead of World Handloom

Day on August 7. Running until August 10 alongside 'Worlds Within Cloth', the exhibition also features artisans from Kutch, Banaras and Bhagalpur showcasing kala cotton, Banarasi silk and Bhagalpur cotton weaves, respectively.

The portable loom Baruah is working on, traditionally used in Assam's hill and tribal regions, is simple in design but physically demanding. "You cannot install large looms in the hills, so people attach this to a wall inside the house and weave like this," Baruah says.

She learnt this art of weaving from her mother. "We used to weave our own clothes."

After graduating in fashion design from NIFT Kolkata in



Artisan Mitali Baruah; bags made using loom at 'Know Your Weaves' exhibition at National Crafts Museum & Hastkala Academy. EXPRESS

1991, Baruah started a business selling Assam silk sarees, dress materials and readymade garments in 1993. She received an MSME award in 2008 and soon after, expanded into manufac-

turing by opening a centre for weaving cloth in Guwahati, sourcing yarn from mills in the region.

"I had a readymade garments unit, but wanted to pro-

duce my own fabric," she says.

Today, her production centre makes table mats, stoles, shawls, wrap skirts, dress materials and purses using mercerised cotton. "We products last

upto 25 years because of the cotton we use," Baruah says.

The loom Baruah is using is smaller in size than other traditional looms. "This is why we can't make sarees on

this (loin loom). At most, a two-piece wraparound skirt can be made, which will take about 10 to 15 days," she says.

"In Assam, women usually do this in their free time after finishing household chores. Even our tribal dresses are made like this. It's not always professional work. But those who pursue it professionally come in the morning and leave in the evening."

Baruah herself no longer spends long hours at the loom. Her production centre is now run with the help of a couple of women and graduate students she has employed.

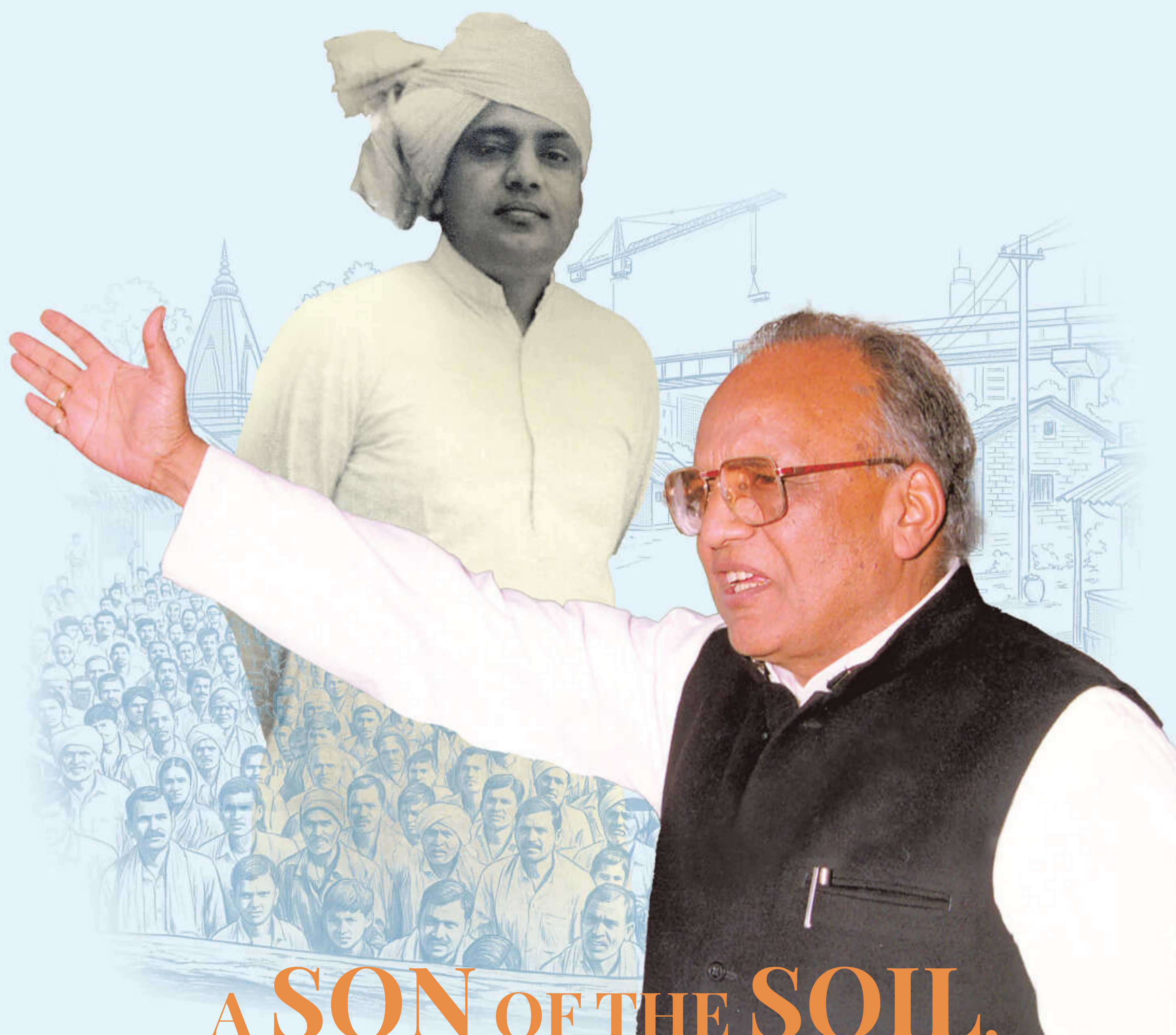
"Working on this loom needs a strong back," she says, pointing to the cane strap tied against her waist.

"You have to keep loosening and tightening it while weaving. The pressure is on the back. As due to age I have developed back problems, the younger girls do most of the weaving now at the production centre," she adds.

Baruah says she favours synthetic dyes over natural ones. "Natural dyes lack durability... Because our cloth lasts almost 25 years, we would want the colour to last. In natural dyes, the colour fades over time," she says.



#RememberingBauji



A SON OF THE SOIL, A LEADER WHO SHAPED SOCIETY

7TH AUGUST 1930 ~ 31ST MARCH 2005

Shri O.P. Jindal never saw barriers. He saw possibilities waiting to be unlocked. A son of the soil, a visionary, and a nation-builder, he opened doors to new horizons of development—expanded access to education, promoted affordable healthcare, and pioneered employment opportunities in rural India. He transformed countless lives, and helped build our India.

On his 96th Birth Anniversary, we remember a legacy that continues to inspire generations.



SCAN THIS QR CODE
TO WATCH THE VIDEO



‘Sabarimala ghee bought at higher prices’: Kerala HC directs Vigilance probe

Express News Service
Thiruvananthapuram, August 6

THE KERALA High Court has directed a Vigilance probe into the alleged irregularities and misappropriation in the purchase of ghee at Sabarimala temple during the last annual festival season.

This is the third Sabarimala scandal being probed by SITs following the intervention of the high court.

The Vigilance and Anti-Corruption Bureau (VACB) will register a case against Travancore Devaswom Board’s (TDB) former president P S Prasanth and member Ajikumar. Citing a report, the court noted that the duo had decided to purchase ghee for the festival season – that spanned from November 2025 to January 2026 – at a higher price after cancelling an e-tender process that was already underway.

Prasanth, a CPI(M) leader, had served as the president of TDB – the state-run Board that manages the temple – from 2023 to 2025.

After examining a report from the temple vigilance and chief security officer, the court on Wednesday found serious irregularities in the Board’s decision to abandon an e-tender, and purchase ghee from Milma – state’s co-operative venture in the dairy sector – at a substantially higher price.

The court found that although the lowest bidder had quoted Rs 369 per litre and met the quality prescribed, the TDB approved the purchase of 1.65 lakh litres of ghee from Milma at a higher price of Rs 510 per litre.

The Board had claimed that Milma ghee was of superior quality and would require less quantity for preparing Aravana (prasad).

The Board took the decision, disregarding the objection of the Devaswom commissioner, the report noted.

South Africa recalls envoy after he is spotted at Zuma-Gupta meeting

Sooklal plays it down, says just a formality, will return; was seen at the meeting in Haridwar in June

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, August 6

THE SOUTH African envoy to India, Anil Sooklal, has been “recalled for consultations” by the South African government over his association with former president Jacob Zuma and controversial Indian-origin South African businessman Ajay Gupta.

Sooklal, an Indian-origin South African diplomat, was the country’s G20 sherpa, as well as the BRICS Sherpa, before he was appointed as the High Commissioner to India.

When contacted, Sooklal told *The Indian Express* that it was a “formality” and there were “no issues of concern.” He said that he will be back in Delhi after two days.



South Africa’s former president Jacob Zuma

When Zuma visited India in his private capacity in June this year, he had gone to Haridwar where he was photographed with South African envoy Sooklal and businessman Gupta.

The trio were spotted together at the Sidhpeeth Shri Dakshin Kali Mandir in Haridwar during a religious ceremony.

South Africa’s International

Relations Minister Ronald Lamola said on Wednesday that the government has recalled Sooklal for “consultations”. The minister also announced that the Department of International Relations and Cooperation (DIRCO) has proposed stricter rules governing diplomatic support for former presidents travelling abroad.

About a decade ago, the Gupta brothers were accused of profiting from their close ties to the then President Zuma. The Gupta family left South Africa in 2018 after a judicial commission began investigating allegations that they were involved in a massive fraud known as “state capture”.

In 2022, the commission concluded that Zuma had hired and fired ministers at the behest of the Gupta family, which included the two younger Gupta brothers, Atul and Rajesh.

Zuma has since been expelled from the African National Congress (ANC), the party he once led, and now heads the opposition uMkhonto weSizwe (MK), or ‘Spear of the Nation’.

On the current situation, La-

mola said, “We have also submitted recommendations to Parliament and the presidency to consider a new framework for protocol and diplomatic support to former presidents and deputy presidents during international travels.”

Under the proposed framework, the presidency and DIRCO have established a mandatory disclosure mechanism requiring former presidents and deputy presidents seeking protocol and diplomatic assistance to provide full details of their travel plans.

This includes the purpose of the trip, planned activities, sources of funding, key engagements and the capacity in which they will be travelling.

Lamola said the measures were aimed at preventing former leaders from creating the impression that they represent South Africa’s foreign policy.

“This will help us avoid a situation where former presidential portray themselves as also representing South Africa’s foreign policy, particularly when they have not been mandated by the sitting head of state,” Lamola said.

After HC’s ‘no work, no pay’ warning, docs withdraw strike

Omkar Gokhale
Mumbai, August 6

HOURS AFTER the Bombay High Court (HC) questioned the real-life consequences of doctors protesting and stopping work in Maharashtra, the Indian Medical Association (IMA) informed it that it was withdrawing the strike “forthwith”, but its grievances remain pending before it.

Dr Atharva Shinde, president of Maharashtra Association of Resident Doctors (MARD)’s central unit, representing government doctors, said they were protesting but did not stop emergency services.

During the hearing in the second session, the HC warned the IMA it would be compelled to stop wages if the medical association resorts to “confrontation”. The High Court bench of Acting Chief Justice Ravindra V Ghuge and Justice Gautam A Ankhad said, “Will you strike at the cost of patients? There will be no work and no pay. Not one patient should die in municipal or government hospital. Will you start treating patients by calling off the strike? We will ask the state to go on a war foot-

ing (in the homeopaths registration matter),” the bench said.

Senior advocate S U Kamdar, representing IMA, enumerated a “host of reasons” behind the strike but said the issues did not justify it. On instructions from the IMA office-bearers, Kamdar submitted that the strike would be withdrawn immediately.

Appreciating the association’s “maturity”, the court said they would participate in the suo motu plea on the larger issue. It also directed the State to implement, in “letter and spirit”, its Government Resolution (GR) providing a committee to frame a Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) on the homeopaths registration issue.

Advocate General Milind Sathe for state said another HC bench in 2025 refused to stay eligible homeopaths’ MMC registration, the pending case is at final hearing stage, with IMA concluding arguments and the government beginning submissions.

The bench appointed senior advocate Vineet Naik and Advocate Amogh Singh as *amici curiae* (friends of the court) and posted the hearing to September 8.

‘Can docs bring dead people back to life?’

Raising concern over doctors threatening to suspend emergency services if the impasse continued, the High Court bench said it was “pained” by the doctors’ protest.

“We are pained by the fact that practicing doctors have resorted to a strike. We have read in the newspaper today that they have said, we will not even take care of ICU patients,” Acting CJ Ghuge said.

“We have to look at what could be the ramifications. One can understand that if there is a strike in a factory for 30 days, the worst case is loss of earnings. In the case of lawyers, we do not say anything. In the case of doctors, if patients die, can they bring back the dead patients to life?” the bench said.

One of the key issues for the doctors’ protest was the Maharashtra government’s move to implement a provision that allowed certain homeopathy (BHMS) practitioners to be registered under a separate register maintained by the Maharashtra Medical Council (MMC) after completing a bridge course.

LAUNCHED IN OCT 2021, THE RAH-VEER SCHEME AWARDS Rs 25,000 TO ANYONE WHO HELPS AN ACCIDENT VICTIM REACH HOSPITAL WITHIN THE FIRST 60 MINUTES

Despite rising road fatalities, only 813 good Samaritans rewarded in 5 yrs

People often hesitate to help due to the fear of police, paperwork and follow-ups

Dheeraj Mishra
New Delhi, August 6

DESPITE RISING road fatalities in the country, few have availed of a key government scheme that rewards good Samaritans who help accident victims reach hospital during the crucial ‘golden hour’.

According to data tabled by the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH) in Lok Sabha on Thursday, only 813 people have been awarded under the Rah-Veer scheme in the past five years, i.e. from 2021-22 to 2025-26.

Also noteworthy is that participation has mostly been confined to just 15 states and two union territories. Out of eight states that account for two of every three accident deaths in the country, two, namely Maharashtra and Karnataka, did not have any takers for the scheme in the same period, data revealed.

The other six states are

Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan, Bihar and Uttar Pradesh. Among them, Rajasthan registered the most success under the scheme with 224 awardees, followed by Bihar (95), Madhya Pradesh (54), Uttar Pradesh (35), Andhra Pradesh (23), and Tamil Nadu (19).

As for why the numbers remain low, it is commonly understood that people often hesitate to help due to the fear of being pestered by the police or members at the hospital with paperwork and follow-ups. The good Samaritans matter as, according to a 2021 NITIAayog-AIIMS Emergency

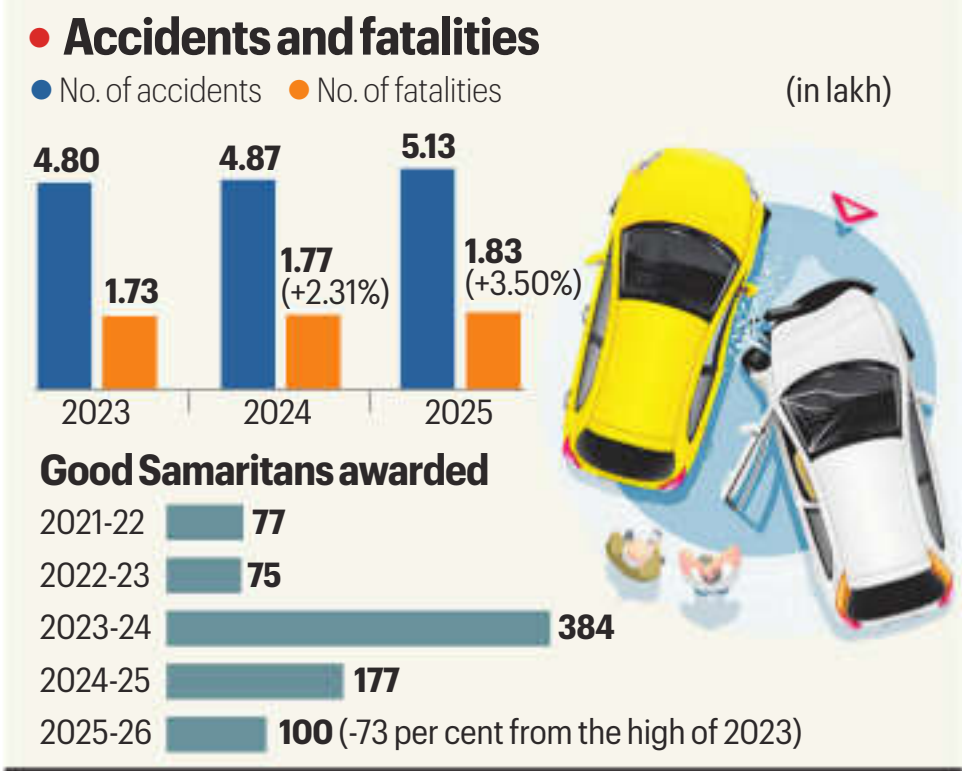
and Injury Care Report, at least 30 per cent of all trauma-related deaths in the country are attributable to delays in emergency care.

To remedy this, the Supreme Court, on March 30, 2016, passed a significant order recognising the rights of good Samaritans and directed the states to establish a grievance redressal system to deal with their grievances.

Interestingly, as *The Indian Express* reported on June 26, Maharashtra and Karnataka are the only two states among the eight states with high fatalities to have established such a system.

Launched in October 2021, the Rah-Veer scheme awards a sum of Rs 25,000 to anyone who helps an accident victim reach the hospital within the first 60 minutes after a crucial accident. The reward sum was revised recently from an earlier Rs 5,000 to motivate the general public to help the victims.

The Ministry in July extended the scheme by another five years, and allocated an initial grant of Rs 25 lakh to the states for disbursing the reward sum to Rah-Veers. It has also directed the states to publicise the scheme more effectively among the public.





सत्यमेव जयते
दिल्ली सरकार





Greetings on
National Handloom Day
Celebrating the Threads
that Weave India’s Heritage



Today is a day to celebrate our rich weaving traditions, which showcase the creativity of our people. We are proud of India’s handloom diversity and its role in furthering livelihoods and prosperity.

-Narendra Modi, Prime Minister



Rekha Gupta
Chief Minister, Delhi

Narendra Modi
Prime Minister

Preserving Heritage | Empowering Artisans | Weaving India’s Future

BJP makes way for Kushwaha’s son, but a question on merger may resurface in seven months

Santosh Singh
Patna, August 6

AMID PRESSURE from the BJP to merge with it, the Rashtriya Lok Morcha (RLM) seems to have got a reprieve, albeit for only seven months, with its leader and Bihar’s Panchayati Raj Minister Deepak Prakash getting nominated to the Legislative Council on August 5.

With this, Prakash, son of RLM chief and Rajya Sabha MP Upendra Kushwaha, will continue to serve as a minister in the Samrat Choudhary-led Cabinet. His tenure as an MLC will expire in March 2027, when 12 council seats fall vacant, triggering the possibility of a fresh round of intense negotiations between the BJP and its ally.

Prakash became an MLC after BJP leader Devesh Kumar resigned from his position, seven months before the completion of his term, to make way for the former’s nomination.

Prakash served as a minister for nearly six months, without holding a seat in either House, across the tenures of former CM Nitish Kumar and incumbent Samrat Choudhary, separated by a 22-day gap.

Following the Supreme Court’s direction last week, asking the Bihar government to respond to a PIL challenging Prakash’s continuation as a minister, the RLM leader seems to have received a seven-month reprieve before fresh nominations are invited for 12 MLC posts that will fall vacant around the same time next year.

Sources in the BJP said while Kushwaha had the option of appointing his wife Snehlata, an MLA from Sasaram, or any of his party’s other three MLAs as a minister, he insisted on securing a post for his non-legislator son.

“The NDA could have



Bihar Panchayati Raj Minister Deepak Prakash, (second right), greets Council chairman Abhidesh Narayan after taking oath as member of the Bihar Legislative Assembly Council in Patna on Thursday. PTI

granted the RLM one MLC berth during the recent vacancy of 10 seats, but the BJP expected Kushwaha to merge his party with us. Previously, the party had given Kushwaha a Rajya Sabha term with the same expectation of an RLM-BJP merger,” said a BJP leader, describing Kushwaha as a “tactful bargainer and political survivor”. Kushwaha’s party represents a segment of the Koeri (Kushwaha) vote bank.

The BJP also seems to be recalculating the extent to which it can accommodate the demands of Kushwaha, given the changed political scenario in Bihar. “Now that the BJP has Samrat Choudhary, a prominent Kushwaha leader, as CM, why should the party continue to pamper Upendra Kushwaha? The RLM chief will face another tough hurdle after seven months,” said the BJP leader.

“For now, we have accepted the seven-month term for Prakash as there was no other immediate alternative available. People can keep talking about the BJP putting merger pressure on us, but the fact remains

that we are an independent political entity,” said an RLM leader.

The recent political developments in the state centre on the constitutional mandate under Article 164(4), which dictates that an un-elected individual serving as a cabinet minister must be elected or nominated to either the Legislative Assembly or the Legislative Council within six months of assuming office. Prakash reached the threshold of his six-month grace period across cabinet iterations under JDU’s Kumar and current CM Choudhary, leading to a legal challenge in the Supreme Court via a PIL.

To avert Prakash’s removal from the Bihar cabinet, BJP leader Kumar surrendered his MLC seat seven months early. This vacated a Governor-nominated slot, enabling immediate nomination without the need to wait for an election cycle.

The RLM may have secured a seat for now, but the recent developments highlight growing friction within the ruling coalition in Bihar.

AI may augment judicial intelligence, not replace its conscience: CJI Kant

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 6

TECHNOLOGY AND human values are not competing ideals... When responsibly deployed, the former strengthens the very values that sustain the administration of justice, Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant said on Thursday.

He was speaking at a lecture organised by the Supreme Court Advocates-on-Record Associ-

ation (SCAORA) on the topic, ‘The Future of Justice Delivery: Innovation, Inclusion, and Integrity’, and delivered by Justice Abha Nayar Patel, Judge of the Supreme Court of Zambia.

Addressing the gathering, the CJI said that technology “enables courts to become more inclusive without compromising integrity, and more efficient without sacrificing fairness”.

Touching on the role of AI, Justice Kant said that it “may

augment judicial intelligence without replacing the judicial conscience”. “Technology can process information with remarkable speed, but justice ultimately demands wisdom, empathy, and exercise of reasoned human judgment,” he said.

The CJI said “the greater the capabilities of AI, the greater is our responsibility to ensure that its use remains transparent, accountable, and firmly subject to human oversight”.

Wayanad set to get advanced X-band weather radar

Thiruvananthapuram: Nearly two years after landslides that killed 298 people in Kerala’s Wayanad district, the IMD has announced plans to install an X-band Doppler Weather Radar to improve forecasts of extreme weather and strengthen early warning systems in the region.

The radar will be commissioned in Wayanad by December this year, IMD said Thursday. It will be installed at Pulpally, where Pazhassi Raja College has provided land for the project. ENS

PUBLIC NOTICE

State Environment Impact Assessment Authority, Haryana has accorded environment clearance for the Proposed Group Housing Colony under TOD Policy at Village- Badha & Nawada Fatehpur, Sector-90, Gurugram, Haryana over an area measuring of 6.4166 Acres developed by M/s North Star Towers Private Limited and Others through EC Identification No. EC24C3801HR5920941N on dated: 06.12.2024.

The copy of Clearance Letter is available on the website of Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change - <https://parivesh.nic.in/>.

Dated: 07.08.2026
M/s North Star Towers Private Limited
Office: SS House, Plot no. 77, Sector-44, Gurugram, Haryana-122003

भारतीय समुद्री विश्वविद्यालय
INDIAN MARITIME UNIVERSITY
(A Central University, Government of India)
Established by an Act of the Parliament in 2008
Vangali, Tekkalipalem (PO), Near Rayavapuram Agraharam, Sabbavaram (MD),
Visakhapatnam Campus - Visakhapatnam - 531 035 Andhra Pradesh
Website : www.imuv.edu.in in GST 37AAAAI2610K2ZV

Advt. No. IMUV/Estt./Recrt./RP-025/2026-27/02 Date: 06.08.2026

NOTICE
WALK-IN INTERVIEWS

It is to inform that, applications are invited from interested & eligible candidates to attend walk-in interviews scheduled to be held on 19.08.2026 (Wednesday) from 10.00 hrs till 13.00 hrs for the post of Project Staff on contract basis under the research project titled "Study of Ship Hull Geometry Flow Noise" at the School of Naval Architecture and Ocean Engineering, Indian Maritime University, Visakhapatnam

Eligibility criteria, location of walk-in Interview and other details for the said post can be obtained from www.imuv.edu.in and www.imu.edu.in.

-Sd-
Campus Director

केन्द्रीय भण्डारण निगम
(नवरत्न सीपीएसई)
CENTRAL WAREHOUSING CORPORATION
(A NAVRATNA CPSE)

No. CWC CO-HR0ADMIN/14/2026-HUMAN RESOURCES Date 06.08.2026

Engagement of Part-time Professional Doctor

Central Warehousing Corporation, a Navratna CPSE intends to engage Part-time Professional Doctor (Homeopathy) having suitable experience for its Corporate Office, New Delhi, as per following details:

Post	Educational Qualification & Work experience	Monthly Fee
Part-time Professional Doctor	MD (Homeopathy) with at least seven years of post-qualification experience (PSU experience is preferred).	₹ 25,000/- (Two hours visit per week)

Please visit Career Portal of our [website www.cewacor.nic.in](http://www.cewacor.nic.in) for detailed advertisement and application form.

कोटा विश्वविद्यालय, कोटा
महाराव भीमसिंह मार्ग, कबीर सर्किल के पास, कोटा

नीलामी निविदा सूचना संख्या-13/2026-27

विश्वविद्यालय की वर्ष 2024 व 2025 की विभिन्न परीक्षाओं में प्रयुक्त उत्तरपुस्तिकाओं, ओ.एम.आर. शीट्स, पुराने प्रश्न पत्र, टाट के खाली कट्टे, कानन की कवरन, पत्र-पत्रिकाएं आदि के विक्रय हेतु अनुमतिन लागत र. 35.00 लाख की खुली नीलामी निविदा द्वि-लिफाफा पद्धति से दिनांक 20.08.26 के दोपहर 02:00 बजे तक आमंत्रित की जाती है।

निविदा प्रश्न एवं शर्तों आदि का विस्तृत विवरण <http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in> और University Website www.uok.ac.in पर उपलब्ध है।

(मुस्लीहर प्रतिहार)
कुलसचिव

UBN-UOK2627GLOB00014

दिल्ली प्रौद्योगिकी विश्वविद्यालय
DELHI TECHNOLOGICAL UNIVERSITY
Established by Govt. of Delhi vide Act 6 of 2009
(Formerly Delhi College of Engineering)
SHAHBAD DAULATPUR, BAWANA ROAD, DELHI-110042

File No. FDTU/Recrt./T&P/2025/F-988/5363 Dated: 28/07/2026

ADVERTISEMENT NOTICE No. 02/2026

RECRUITMENT TO THE POST OF ASSISTANT PROFESSOR OF PRACTICE (TRAINING & PLACEMENT) AND PROFESSOR OF PRACTICE (TRAINING & PLACEMENT) on Tenure Track Appointment basis (for a maximum 05 years term)

The opening date and closing date for receipt of applications are as under:-

Opening Date for Submission of Online Applications	-:- 07/08/2026 (7 th August, 2026) from 11:00 AM
Closing Date for Submission of Online Applications	-:- 07/09/2026 (7 th September, 2026) till 05:00 PM
Closing Date for Submission of Hard Copy of Applications	-:- 21/09/2026 (21 st September, 2026) till 05:00 PM

Delhi Technological University is a teaching-cum-research University committed to foster excellence in education, research, technology incubation, product innovation, outreach and extension activities in Engineering, Management, and Applied Sciences. The University invites applications from the talented individuals to fill up the following posts on Tenure Track Appointment basis (for a maximum 05 years term):

Sr. No.	Nomenclature of Post	Classification of the post (Group)	Total No. of Posts* (Tenure Track Appointment basis)	Category
1.	Assistant Professor of Practice (Training & Placement)	Group A	01	UR
2.	Professor of Practice (Training & Placement)	Group A	01	UR

*The number of posts advertised is provisional and can be varied as per the requirement of the University. The interested candidates are required to fill up the online application form. After submitting the applications through **ONLINE**, candidates should take a printout of application form and submit it alongwith self-attested copies of certificates/documents to the Recruitment Cell, Room No. 801, 8th Floor, AB-3 Block, DTU, Delhi-110042. All further communications related to recruitment will be displayed on the university website www.dtu.ac.in from time to time. No personal communication will be entertained in this regard. The candidates are advised to visit the university website i.e. www.dtu.ac.in for detailed advertisement.

-Sd-
Registrar

Reliance Industries Limited
Growth is Life

Regd. Office: 3rd Floor, Maker Chambers IV, 222, Nariman Point, Mumbai - 400 021.
Phone: 022-3555 5000 • Fax: 022-2204 2268 • E-mail: investor.relations@ril.com
CIN: L17110MH1973PLC019786

NOTICE
SPECIAL WINDOW FOR TRANSFER AND DEMATERIALISATION (DEMAT) OF PHYSICAL SHARES

Please note that a **Special Window for transfer and dematerialisation (demat) of physical shares** will remain open **up to February 04, 2027** as per SEBI Circular No. HO/38/13/11(2)2026-MIRSD-PoD/I/3750/2026 dated January 30, 2026 (“SEBI Circular”).

This facility is available to those investors who had **purchased physical shares of Reliance Industries Limited (“the Company”) prior to April 01, 2019**, and:

(a) had not lodged the shares for transfer; or

(b) had lodged the shares for transfer, but the same were rejected, returned, or not attended to due to deficiencies in documentation.

Applicability of the Special Window

For clarity regarding the applicability of this window to transfer the deeds executed before April 1, 2019, investors may refer to the matrix below

Lodged for transfer before April 01, 2019?	Is the Original Share Certificate available with the Investor?	Whether eligible to lodge in the Special Window?
No - it is fresh lodgement	Yes	Yes (subject to conditions stated in the SEBI Circular)
Yes, but was rejected/ returned earlier	Yes	
Yes, was lodged	No	No
No, was not lodged	No	No

Kindly note that request(s) which are accompanied by original share certificate(s) along with transfer deed(s) and other supporting documents will only be considered under the Special Window.

Investors wishing to avail of this Special Window may contact the Company’s **Registrar and Transfer Agent, KFin Technologies Limited** (Unit: Reliance Industries Limited), having their address at Selenium Tower-B, Plot Nos. 31 & 32, Gachibowli, Financial District, Nanakramguda, Hyderabad – 500 032.

For further details, investors may refer to the SEBI Circular available at: <https://tinyurl.com/29ab3727>.

Queries may be addressed to rilinvestor@kfintech.com

For Reliance Industries Limited
Sd/-
Savithri Parekh
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer

Place : Mumbai
Dated : August 7, 2026

www.ril.com

HERO KA SCOOTER
SCOOTER KA HERO

SCAN TO CREATE YOUR OWN DESTINY STORY
AND GET A CHANCE TO WIN A HERO DESTINY!

*T&C Apply

Creative Visualization.

STATEMENT OF STANDALONE AND CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED JUNE 30, 2026

The Board of Directors of Hero MotoCorp Limited (“the Company”) at its meeting held on August 06, 2026, approved the un-audited (standalone and consolidated) Financial Results of the Company for the quarter ended June 30, 2026.

The Financial Results are available on the website of Stock Exchange at www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com and also on the Company’s website at <https://www.heromotocorp.com/en-in/company/investors/annual-report.html?key1=quarterly-results> and can be accessed by scanning the **QR Code**.

For and on behalf of Board of Directors
Dr. PAWAN MUNJAL
Executive Chairman
DIN: 00004223

Note: The above information is in accordance with Regulation 33 & 47 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015

Financial Highlights	Key Parameters		Quarter ended June 30, 2026	Quarter ended March 31, 2026	Quarter ended June 30, 2025
	Revenue from operations	Standalone	Rs. 12,999 Crores	Rs. 12,797 Crores	Rs. 9,579 Crores
Consolidated		Rs. 13,126 Crores	Rs. 12,978 Crores	Rs. 9,728 Crores	
Profit after Tax (PAT)	Standalone	Rs. 1,454 Crores	Rs. 1,401 Crores	Rs. 1,126 Crores	
	Consolidated	Rs. 1,418 Crores	Rs. 1,474 Crores	Rs. 1,706 Crores	

Hero MotoCorp Ltd. - Regd. Office: The Grand Plaza, Plot No.2, Nelson Mandela Road, Vasant Kunj- Phase-II, New Delhi- 110070. | CIN NO. L35911DL1984PLC017354 • Visit www.heromotocorp.com



Young & Witty

THE RELEASE of four volumes of parliamentary speeches by former MP Vaiko in the Capital saw prominent faces from the Opposition bloc share the stage. LoP Rahul Gandhi launched the volumes and Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav received them. The evening's most engaging moment belonged to the compère, CPI(M)'s John Brittas, who introduced the 82-year-old Vaiko as "the youngest person on the dais". Gandhi seconded him, declaring Vaiko as "indeed young". After Gandhi's speech, Brittas returned to the podium and smilingly said what he actually meant was that Vaiko was not only young, "but younger than Rahulji himself". The hall erupted in laughter.

'Mission' Siwan

THE OPPOSITION parties are planning to send their MPs to Siwan in Bihar to meet the student protesters injured in police action during the July 25 state bandh. Sources said Leader of the Opposition Rahul Gandhi floated the idea during a meeting of floor leaders of the Opposition parties on Thursday. Gandhi said the Opposition can't confine itself to Parliament and must hit the streets, said sources. He appealed to all the parties to send maximum MPs to Siwan, and they agreed, the sources said. A final schedule for the programme will be prepared in the coming days.

Direct Feedback

UNION JAL Shakti Minister C R Patil has launched a unique initiative to collect direct feedback on the implementation of Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM) 2.0. He has been holding interactive meetings with MPs from both Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha to assess the Mission's progress and address constituency-specific concerns. Patil has so far met MPs from Chhattisgarh, Gujarat, Haryana, Odisha and West Bengal. He is scheduled to hold similar interactions with MPs from UP, MP and Maharashtra in the coming days.

As Govt seeks support on delimitation, Cong says 'convene all-party meeting'

Manoj C.G, Liz Mathew & Asad Rehman
New Delhi, August 6

ADAY after the Centre signalled its intention to reintroduce the legislative package on operationalising women's quota law and carrying out delimitation, and urged the Congress to reconsider its position, the Opposition party on Thursday asked the government to convene an all-party meeting on the matter.

In a phone call, Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi asked Union Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju to take all parties into confidence on the key points of the proposed legislation. The government, however, rejected the demand, with sources saying Union Home Minister Amit Shah and Rijiju had discussed the matter with leaders of almost all the parties, including the SP and the DMK. "There were no objections to the Bill. They just wanted security for their respective states and their interests to be protected," said a government functionary.

The SP denied it was planning to support the Delimitation Bill. "We defeated it three months ago. And now too we are



Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi with Congress MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra in Parliament on Thursday. PTI

against this design of the government to redraw the boundaries of constituencies. The government should first tell us what has changed in the Bill which was defeated by the united Opposition. If nothing has changed, then how can we change our stand?" said a senior SP MP.

Some BJP leaders, including a few ministers, claimed the government had mustered the numbers required to get the Constitutional amendment Bill passed, but wants to follow for-

malities. "There is no deadlock, because we have the numbers. We just don't want to bulldoze the Bill through the House. We were meeting Congress leaders for formalities," said a minister.

However, other leaders of the ruling party said the party needs to be sure it has the numbers locked down. "We need to be sure that we have numbers which are more than two-thirds majority to bring the Bills to Parliament again. We can't afford to make another gamble here. We

don't want a repetition of what happened in April," a source said. In April, the Opposition defeated the Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026, to fast-track the implementation of 33% women's quota. It proposed lifting the freeze on expanding the number of Lok Sabha seats and linked reservation directly to a new delimitation exercise.

Sources said Gandhi discussed the government's overture with Congress chief Mallikarjun Kharge before speaking to Rijiju. Kharge and senior Congress leaders K C Venugopal and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra were present during the telephone conversation. Sources said Gandhi made it clear that the government should convene the all-party meeting and explain to the political parties its "intention" and whether it was amenable to making any changes in the Constitution amendment Bill on operationalising the women's reservation law, which was defeated on the floor of the House in April.

"Kharge ji kept saying there should be an all-party meeting to discuss delimitation. We asked him, 'Why do you want to call a meeting in which you are going to say that the Congress

does not support the Bill?," said a government functionary.

"We want to know what the government's intention is. We want to know whether the government is making any changes in the Bill. Our position is still the same. We are opposed to the Delimitation Bill as it stands today," Venugopal said. The Congress leadership had conveyed to Rijiju its stand Wednesday, but the minister urged the party to reconsider its position. Gandhi and Congress leaders briefed other Opposition leaders about the government's overture at a meeting of Opposition floor leaders Thursday, sources said. The Opposition remains united on the demand for an all-party meeting before the government makes any move to reintroduce the Constitution amendment Bill.

Gandhi is also learnt to have told Rijiju that the Opposition won't back down on the demand for Union Home Minister Amit Shah to explain to Parliament the reasons for the police crackdown on agitating students and youth. Any Bill can be discussed after Shah addresses Parliament on the matter, sources said.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

CENTRE ACKNOWLEDGES COMPLAINTS

Rahul questions Ken-Betwa river link impact on tribals

Nikhil Ghanekar
New Delhi, August 6

LEADER OF Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi Thursday raised an unstarred question on displacement and rehabilitation concerns of tribals impacted by the Ken-Betwa river linking project. The Centre acknowledged that it had received representations on the issue and they were forwarded to the Madhya Pradesh government.

Gandhi and SP MP Ajendra Singh Lodhi asked the Ministry of Tribal Affairs to provide details on the families affected by India's first river linking project. They also sought to know if the government has taken cognizance of protests by tribal communities that are being evicted. The LoP asked if any of the beneficiaries of rehabilitation had complained about not receiving funds.

MoS for Tribal Affairs Durgadas Uikey informed in a written response that the ministry has received "various representations raising issues of displacement due to the Ken-Betwa River Link Project". These, he said, were examined and forwarded to the MP government and re-

spective district administrations for "examination and necessary action", as implementation of the Forest Rights Act lies with the governments of states and UTs. The Centre's reply came in the backdrop of a 'chita' (pyre) protest by tribals across MP's Chhatarpur, alleging irregularities in the rehabilitation of project-affected families, including incomplete coverage of beneficiaries.

Uikey said the ministry was a member of the steering and monitoring panel for the project, which monitors the progress of the action plan for relief and rehabilitation of project-affected families. Forest clearance was accorded by the Environment Ministry subject to conditions that the state government will ensure implementation of relief and rehabilitation plan as per its policy and ensure compliance with the Forest Rights Act.

The Rs 44,605-crore project's stated objective is the inter-basin transfer of water from Ken River in MP to UP's Betwa River basin. The construction of Daudhara Dam on Ken River in the core of Panna Tiger Reserve and its submergence zone together would displace thousands of families.

Rajya Sabha clears Appropriation Bill for Rs 54,067-cr excess spend

Divya A
New Delhi, August 6

THE RAJYA Sabha on Thursday cleared the Appropriation Bill, 2026, which seeks to authorise appropriation of money from the Consolidated Fund of India to meet amounts spent on certain services during the financial year ending March 31, 2023, in excess of the amounts granted.

Replying to the debate on the Bill, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said, "This is the demand for excess grant for expenditures undertaken in the year 2023 on just two accounts. These two accounts were a part of what the Public Accounts Committee in its 39th report presented to the Lok Sabha this year in April." She explained that one excess demand arises from a particular court order on the Railway Ministry for Rs 196.44 crore. The second demand pertains to a larger amount of Rs 53,871 crore for repayment of debt. The total amount is Rs 54,067 crore.

The Bill was returned to the Lok Sabha after the Upper House gave its nod with a voice vote, completing the parliamentary process for the Money Bill. Before that, a section of Opposition MPs — from Congress and other parties — staged a walkout demanding a statement from Home Minister Amit Shah on



Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman in Rajya Sabha, Thursday. PTI

police action against protesting students in the Capital. When the House convened at 2.15 pm, Deputy Chairman Harivansh announced that the proceedings will be adjourned for one hour. However, the Rajya Sabha reassembled earlier at 2.45 pm and Sitharaman moved the Bill for consideration and return.

Referring to concerns raised by members regarding J&K, Sitharaman assured the House that the government has extended substantial financial and administrative support to the UT after the abrogation of Article 370 in 2019. She informed that the salaries and pensions of J&K Police are being disbursed fully, involving an annual expenditure of Rs 13,000 crore. The abrogation of Article 370 reaffirmed that

J&K is an integral part of India, inclusive of the territory illegally occupied by Pakistan.

The government has also undertaken restructuring of the UT's debt and cleared liabilities related to Ladakh, she said, reiterating the government's commitment to ensuring economic stability and development of the region, so that it can progress alongside the rest of the country.

RJD MP Manoj Jha urged the Finance Minister to take steps to protect small grocery owners from distress caused by quick-commerce platforms and their predatory pricing. Pramod Boro from UPPI raised the demand for a border economic zone for the north-east region after extending his support to the Bill.

FCRA Bill may be taken up for discussion on Aug 12; Mizoram CM meets Shah, hands over memorandum

Deeptiman Tiwary
New Delhi, August 6

THE FOREIGN Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026 is likely to be taken up for discussion in Parliament on August 12, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

Mizoram Chief Minister Lalduhoma met Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Thursday and handed over a memorandum expressing concerns over the Bill. He said Shah indicated it would be taken up in the Lok Sabha on August 12 and had assured him it would carry no retrospective provision. "The Home Minister assured me that the retrospective clause will not be there," he said.

A Union minister, on Lalduhoma's claims, said the Bill could be taken up in this session. "There is nothing for the Christian community to fear in the Bill. This Act was enacted by the UPA government. In the Amendment Bill, there is no retrospective clause." The assurance came amid concern among Christian organisations over a provision in the Bill that they say gives a government-designated authority retrospective powers over assets of organisations whose FCRA registration has lapsed.

"We humbly submit that the FCRA Amendment Bill, 2026 and its Rules should operate prospectively. Retrospective application of regulatory provisions may create uncertainty and expose bona fide organisations to penalties for past procedural variations," the memorandum submitted by Lalduhoma said. It added that organisations which voluntarily discontinued foreign funding or underwent restructuring should not be treated as defaulting entities, since such decisions reflected compliance and good faith, and

their legitimately acquired assets, dedicated to public welfare, should remain protected.

After Lalduhoma's meeting, a delegation of church leaders under the Joint Action Forum for Minorities, headed by DMK MP P Wilson, also met Shah. Wilson said the delegation had a discussion with the Home Minister, who assured them he would look into their concerns. "We have demanded that the Bill, in its current form, be either withdrawn or sent to a JPC," Wilson said.

Jonathan Lalremruata, adviser and coordinator of the Catholic Bishops' Conference of India (CBCI), earlier told *The Indian Express* that a CBCI delegation had received a similar assurance from Shah at a recent meeting. "When the CBCI delegation met the Home Minister, we were promised that the law will not be retrospective."

A senior BJP leader said the assurance was part of the party's outreach to minority communities. "It is a promise that the BJP has given to the minority groups," the leader said. Another BJP leader from the South said the Bill would "demolish all the propaganda by the Congress and other vested interests that this is targeting Christians".

The Bill is sensitive for the BJP, as many churches and Christian institutions have been built using foreign contributions regulated under the FCRA. With the party seeking to expand its footprint among Christians, particularly in Kerala, it is keen to address these concerns.

A senior government official told *The Indian Express* that the Bill's objective was to ensure continuity in the management of institutions in case of a break in their FCRA registration. The official also said the government wanted the Bill debated before it was passed.

Don't renew Farakka treaty without safeguarding Bihar's interests, JD(U) tells Centre

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 6

THE JD(U), a key ally of the BJP, on Thursday raised concerns over the proposed renewal of the 1996 Farakka Water Treaty with Bangladesh, urging the Centre not to extend the agreement unless Bihar's long-term water security and developmental needs are fully addressed.

Raising the issue through a Special Mention in the Rajya Sabha, JD(U) leader Sanjay Kumar Jha said the treaty is due to expire on December 12, and argued that renewing it without adequately factoring in Bihar's

interests would be detrimental to the state's long-term development. Jha said the Farakka Barrage was constructed primarily to ensure adequate water flow for the Kolkata Port and the Hooghly river, but Bihar has over the decades faced adverse consequences, particularly during the lean season, when water availability declines.

The JD(U) leader urged the Centre not to renew the 1996 treaty in its present form. Instead, he called for a fresh arrangement based on a scientific assessment of the water requirements of all Ganga basin states, including Bihar.

● THE BANKIPUR BYPOLL, A PERSONAL SETBACK FOR BOTH BJP NATIONAL PRESIDENT NITIN NABIN AS WELL AS BIHAR CM SAMRAT CHOUDHARY, MAY INDICATE A CHURN BEYOND BIHAR

In PK's win, BJP's moment of reckoning: Can Bankipur be straw in a shifting wind?



WHO COULD have imagined that within weeks of wresting West Bengal from Mamata Banerjee and splitting her TMC — and Uddhav Thackeray's Shiv Sena once again — and coming close to mustering a two-thirds majority in Parliament to push through the constitutional amendment legislation linked to Delimitation Bill in the current Monsoon Session of Parliament, the BJP dispensation would "sacrifice" Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan to placate protesting youths at Delhi's Jantar Mantar.

Similarly, who would have thought that eight months after sweeping the Bihar Assembly polls and going on to install a BJP Chief Minister on the Patliputra gaddi for the first time, the BJP would be defeated in one of its most secure constituencies in the state, which it held for over three decades.

The point remains that in every state the bypolls are

usually a cakewalk for its ruling party. In this case, the BJP-led NDA had bagged as many as 202 seats in the 243-member House only last November. What is more, Bankipur has been known as a bastion of Nitin Nabin, the new BJP national president, who won the seat for five consecutive terms since 2006. Before Nabin, it was held by his late father Nabin Kishore Sinha from 1995 until his death in 2006. In fact, the bypoll was necessitated as Nabin vacated the seat — which he won by about 52,000 votes in the Assembly election — following his elevation as the BJP chief and his subsequent election to the Rajya Sabha earlier this year.

Bankipur was also the first electoral challenge that BJP CM Samrat Choudhary faced amid general expectations that he would pull out all stops to clinch it, especially since the main challenger, Jan Suraj Party (JSP) founder Prashant Kishor, had made the contest a "referendum" on his leadership.

As a Kushwaha leader, Samrat was expected to bolster the Luv-Kush (Kurmi-Kushwaha) alliance put in place by his late father, the socialist leader Shakti Choudhary, along with Nitish Kumar in the 1990s to counter the dominance of Ya-

davs among the OBC groups. Bankipur is thus a personal setback for both the BJP chief as well as the Bihar CM.

Beyond Bankipur

Bankipur saw dissatisfaction with the incumbent BJP, rejection of the principal Opposition RJD, and the mandate for debutant Prashant Kishor, the poll strategist-turned-politician, whose fledgling JSP had failed to open its account in the 2025 Bihar elections despite contesting 238 seats. But Bankipur may indicate a churn beyond Bihar, reflecting a changing mood in some other parts of the country too.

It can be tempting to over-read such a situation. The BJP remains firmly in the saddle in Patna and still has about four-and-half-years left for its term and can also be expected to apply correctives. Bankipur is not a typical Bihar constituency. While it is an out-and-out urban seat, earlier known as Patna West, it is also marked with historic landmarks like Gandhi Maidan which gave birth to many a political movement that not only shaped Bihar's roadmap but also India's sometime as seen in the mid-1970s during the JP movement. Bankipur has represented



Prashant Kishor celebrates the JSP's win, in Patna on Monday. PTI FILE

the power of ideas, dominated as it is by educated, upper caste groups, particularly Kayasthas who are bureaucrats and professionals and would have been exercised by the recent NEET examination leak row.

Messages for BJP

For the BJP, the messages emanating from Bankipur are loud and clear. Several BJP leaders and NDA allies are already articulating, in private, what went wrong — that people have reacted against "arrogance of power" and wanted to give the party a jolt. The purported remark from the BJP camp that even a dog or cat "kutta-billi" fielded by the

party would win from Bankipur was picked by Kishor as his war cry during his campaign.

Second, the Bankipur outcome could be a pointer that the BJP's core support base, the upper castes, may be getting disenchanted with it. This was apparent earlier this year when sections of the upper caste groups were up in arms against the UGC equity norms in higher educational institutions, as they saw it as tilted in favour of the OBCs.

The Congress's student wing NSUI then won the president's post in the Patna University Students' Union (PUSU) polls. The killing of 28-year-old social activist Bharat Tiwari in an alleged fake police encounter in

Bhojpur sparked widespread outrage in the state. Most of all, the "chanda chori" in the funds donated to the Ram temple in Ayodhya made many Hindus unhappy, especially among the upper castes who had rallied behind the Ayodhya temple movement over the years.

There is also the Gen Z factor, although Kishor has underplayed it. Gen Z, which accounts for about 26% of India's population, makes up over 29% of Bihar's population. The youth agitation led by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) at Jantar Mantar has created a ripple effect in different parts of the country, leading to student protests across Bihar, where the use of an AK-47 gun by police for firing on protesters set off a storm.

The PK factor

And then, there is Prashant Kishor, popularly known as PK. The backroom strategist who had played a role in the victory of Narendra Modi in the 2014 Lok Sabha polls and of regional heavyweights like Nitish, Captain Amarinder Singh, Mamata, Jagan Mohan Reddy, among other satraps, decided to take the plunge into the electoral arena himself this time. Before launching the JSP on October 2, 2024, he had undertaken a two-

year padyatra across Bihar.

Perhaps there was unease among some Bankipur voters over the JSP's rout in the 2025 elections despite Kishor's efforts to focus on education, jobs and migration and rise above caste and communal politics. He also put in a lot of hard work on the ground, canvassing from door to door, telling common people, "Your vote is precious and you can make a difference to your child's future", which struck a chord. Many of the younger Yadavs also viewed PK with favour than the RJD and state Leader of Opposition Tejashwi Yadav should worry about that.

Even though he will be a lone JSP MLA, Kishor is expected to take up important issues in the House, keeping the NDA government on its toes, while building his party for the 2030 Assembly polls.

Bankipur marks the end of the Nitish era in Bihar. Would Kishor have emerged as Nitish's successor had the two not fallen out? The JD(U) chief might have initially seen him in that light. Today, with Nitish having shifted to the Rajya Sabha amid health issues, the JD(U) seems to be in disarray.

There were reports that many Kurmis in Bankipur, unhappy with Nitish's exit as the

CM, had opted for PK. Significantly, barely a day after the Bankipur results, the PM was photographed with Nitish in Parliament. Bankipur has shown that the social coalition of upper castes and OBCs/EBCs (and of Mahadalits and Pasmanda Muslims) crafted by Nitish, which fuelled the BJP-JD(U) alliance's repeated wins, may have frayed now.

This may lead to new alignments and emergence of new faces among whom Kishor is the most prominent "chehra". The BJP can be expected to go all out to field young candidates in the coming elections. A new leadership may come up not necessarily through protracted socio-political struggles like in the past, but through movements driven primarily on social media on platforms like Instagram. This was seen in the CJP's case that gained a national visibility in just a few weeks — a phenomenon unimaginable in the past. We are entering a new political era, and Bankipur may be a symbol of that change.

Neerja Chowdhury, Contributing Editor, *The Indian Express*, has covered the last 11 Lok Sabha elections. She is the author of *How Prime Ministers Decide*



No plan to blend ethanol with ATF: Aviation Minister

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, August 6

CIVIL AVIATION Minister Ram Mohan Naidu has dismissed AAP Convener Arvind Kejriwal's claim that the government plans to blend ethanol with aviation turbine fuel (ATF). Without naming Kejriwal, Naidu posted on X that the ethanol-ATF claim was "completely false" and "irresponsible", and there was no such proposal. Naidu also said that ethanol and sustainable aviation fuel (SAF) are entirely different and should not be conflated.

"The claim that the Government plans to blend ethanol with Aviation Turbine Fuel (ATF) is completely false and irresponsible. There is no such proposal. Ethanol and Sustainable Aviation Fuel (SAF) are entirely different and should not be conflated. SAF is an internationally certified aviation fuel recognised by International Civil Aviation Organization (ICAO) and adopted globally. It undergoes rigorous testing and meets stringent global safety standards," Naidu said. "Spreading misinformation on aviation safety only creates needless anxiety among air travellers. Passenger safety remains the Government's highest priority," the minister added.

To cut gas imports, Cabinet gives nod to Rs 24K-cr biogas scheme 'GOBARdhan'

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, August 6

FOCUSED ON boosting compressed biogas (CBG) production in the country, the Union Cabinet on Thursday approved 'GOBARdhan', the National Circular Bioenergy Scheme, with an outlay of Rs 23,731 crore for implementation between 2026-27 and 2035-36, or 10 years.

The scheme aims to increase domestic CBG production by nearly 10-fold and mobilise large-scale private investment in this segment through assured offtake by city gas operators, stable administered pricing, capital subsidies, credit support and pipeline infrastructure.

CBG is an eco-friendly and purified form of biogas that is compressed to high pressures for use as a vehicle and industrial fuel. It has properties and energy content very similar to compressed natural gas (CNG), which means it can be blended with CNG or be used as a replacement fuel in automotive, industrial, and commercial sectors. Unorganised feedstock supply chains, high initial capital expenditure, inadequate local distribution infrastructure and weak offtake have been among the major challenges and roadblocks in the

CBG segment, and the scheme aims to overcome them.

Given India's dependence on imports to meet about half of its natural gas requirement, boosting CBG production and use could help reduce imports and strengthen the country's clean energy transition. It would also help insulate the domestic market against major supply and price shocks in the international market, like the prevailing Strait of Hormuz crisis.

According to the government, the GOBARdhan (Galvanising Organic Bio-Agro Resources Dhan) scheme — to be implemented by the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas — has the potential to transform the country's abundant agricultural residue, cattle dung, press mud, municipal organic waste and other biomass resources into clean fuel, organic manure, rural income and national economic value.

"Over the past several years, the Government of India has systematically built the foundations of the CBG sector through the Sustainable Alternative Towards Affordable Transportation (SATAT) initiative, the Market Development Assistance (MDA) Scheme for organic manure, the Biomass Aggrega-

The scheme aims to increase domestic CBG production by nearly 10-fold between 2026-2036

tion Machinery (BAM) Scheme, the Development of Pipeline Infrastructure (DPI) Scheme and Central Financial Assistance (CFA) for CBG plants under the National Bioenergy Programme.

Together, these initiatives have enabled the commissioning of over 200 CBG plants, established production and offtake systems, strengthened the organic manure value chain and demonstrated the potential of CBG across feedstocks and geographies," the government said.

The GOBARdhan scheme is expected to further build and strengthen the CBG ecosystem by creating an integrated platform across the entire CBG value chain. This is likely to enable faster implementation, stronger project economics and greater certainty for investors, lenders and developers. "India's demand for natural gas is expanding across transport, households, industry and commercial sectors. CBG can meet a growing

share of this demand through domestic renewable production, strengthening energy resilience and reducing dependence on imported fossil fuels. CBG is chemically equivalent to natural gas and can be seamlessly integrated into the existing gas ecosystem. It therefore combines the benefits of a renewable fuel with the reach and utility of India's expanding gas infrastructure," the government said.

GOBARdhan will have a dedicated CBG offtake assurance framework to provide a reliable and predictable market for producers. The procurement will be done by city gas distribution (CGD) entities to support their CBG blending obligations — 3% in 2026-27, 4% in 2027-28 and 5% from 2028-29 onwards — in CNG and household piped natural gas (PNG) segments. According to the government, the framework converts the blending obligation into a "clear, long-term demand signal for the industry", and consistent implementation across CGD networks will improve project bankability and support capacity utilisation, which would in turn encourage long-term private investment.

"GOBARdhan introduces a stable administered CBG price

of Rs 2,110 per Metric Million British Thermal Unit (MMBTU), supported through a government-backed pricing framework. The framework provides long-term revenue visibility while protecting consumer affordability through a combination of government support and a market-based cost-sharing mechanism. With a minimum 10-year horizon, the pricing framework will provide producers with durable revenue certainty, commercially attractive returns and a stronger business case for investment and capacity expansion," it said.

Under the scheme, eligible greenfield CBG projects will receive capital assistance of up to Rs 2 crore per tonne per day of installed capacity. The support extends beyond core plant machinery to critical value-chain assets for feedstock aggregation, organic manure processing and value addition. Brownfield projects expanding their production capacity will also be eligible.

As per the government, this support will lower the initial capital burden, accelerate financial closure and expand participation by private developers, small and medium enterprises, cooperatives, and rural entrepreneurs.

Netanyahu calls Modi, discusses West Asia crisis, India-Israel ties

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 6



Prime Minister Narendra Modi

ISRAELI PRIME Minister Benjamin Netanyahu called Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday, in their second phone conversation since the war in West Asia began on February 28. The two leaders exchanged views on the recent developments in West Asia.

A statement issued by the Prime Minister's Office (PMO) said the two leaders reviewed sustained progress in the India-Israel Special Strategic Partnership and reaffirmed their commitment to strengthening the bilateral cooperation across various sectors for mutual benefit.

Later, in a post on X, Modi said, "Received a phone call from Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu. We reviewed progress on various aspects of the India-Israel Special Strategic Partnership which continues to grow from strength-to-strength. We also exchanged views on the current situation in West Asia. @netanyahu." Modi had visited Israel for a bilateral meeting with Netanyahu,

just less than 48 hours before the war in West Asia began. The war has continued for more than five months now, and the fragile truce has been violated several times. Iran on Thursday said it is in the final stage of drafting an agreement on the Strait of Hormuz with Oman, even as two Israeli soldiers were killed in Lebanon.

They had last spoken on March 1, a day after the US and Israel attacked Iran. During the call, the PM had conveyed India's concerns over recent developments and emphasised the safety of civilians as a priority. "India reiterates the need for an early cessation of hostilities," Modi had posted on X, tagging @netanyahu.

Over 4,200 quintals of paddy transported in ambulances, cabs, buses in Bengal: CAG

Atri Mitra
Kolkata, August 6

THE COMPTROLLER and Auditor General (CAG) has flagged fresh irregularities in West Bengal's Public Distribution System, including paddy being transported in ambulances, passenger three-wheelers, buses and luxury cabs, besides duplicate procurement entries involving rice mill owners and their associates, during audit of paddy procurement between 2016-17 and 2020-21.

According to the report, 4,211.89 quintals of paddy during the 2020-21 Kharif Marketing Season (KMS) were shown to have been transported by 19 vehicles that were either not registered for goods carriage or whose registration details could not be verified. The audit found that six passenger three-wheelers were shown transporting 1,159.03 quintals of paddy, while two ambulances allegedly carried 1,764.61 quintals. A bus and a luxury cab were shown transporting another 138.39 quintals, while the registration numbers of nine vehicles, linked to the movement of 1,149.86 quintals, could not be traced on the government portal.

In its response, BENFED's

Hooghly unit attributed the discrepancies to "unintentional errors" while entering vehicle registration numbers on the online procurement portal.

The audit also flagged irregular procurement at a Central Procurement Centre (CPC) in Singur block of Hooghly during the 2018-19 season. The CAG said, "In gross violation of Government orders and procurement guidelines for the KMS 2018-19", it found 59 repeated entries in the names of 10 individuals through which 2,568.13 quintals of paddy worth Rs 44.94 lakh were procured.

An inquiry by the Assistant District Controller (Food and Supplies), Arambagh, found that the 10 individuals included owners of two rice mills (Shree Krishna Rice Mill and Joyguru Rice Mill) their family members and associates, some of whom belonged to other blocks and even other districts.

The inquiry further revealed 97 additional entries in the names of 21 other individuals involving 3,893.71 quintals of paddy. According to the CAG, these persons had merely shared their bank account details and documents with the mill owners and had not actually sold any paddy in the CPC.

50% Bengaluru voters face deletion ahead of SIR draft roll on Aug 17

Akram M
Bengaluru, August 6

THE ONGOING Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Karnataka could lead to the removal of nearly half of Bengaluru's registered voters from the draft electoral roll scheduled for publication on August 17.

According to data shared on Wednesday by Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) V Anbukumar, out of Bengaluru's 1.03 crore voters, 49.42 lakh have been flagged under the Absent, Shifted, Dead, Duplicate, or Other (ASDDO) category during the enumeration phase. Across Karnataka, the number of ASDDO-flagged voters stands at 1.11 crore, representing one-fifth of the 5.54 crore voters mapped for the SIR.

The highest proportion of deletions will occur in the Bommanahalli constituency. There, 57.08 per cent of mapped voters, totalling approximately 2.76 lakh, have been flagged under the ASDDO category during the enumeration phase. Bommanahalli is one of 10 constituencies within Bengaluru city limits where flagged deletions exceed 50%. Other

high-deletion constituencies include Vijayanagar (53.66%), Dasarahalli (53.55%), BTM Layout (53.43%), and C V Raman Nagar (53.25%).

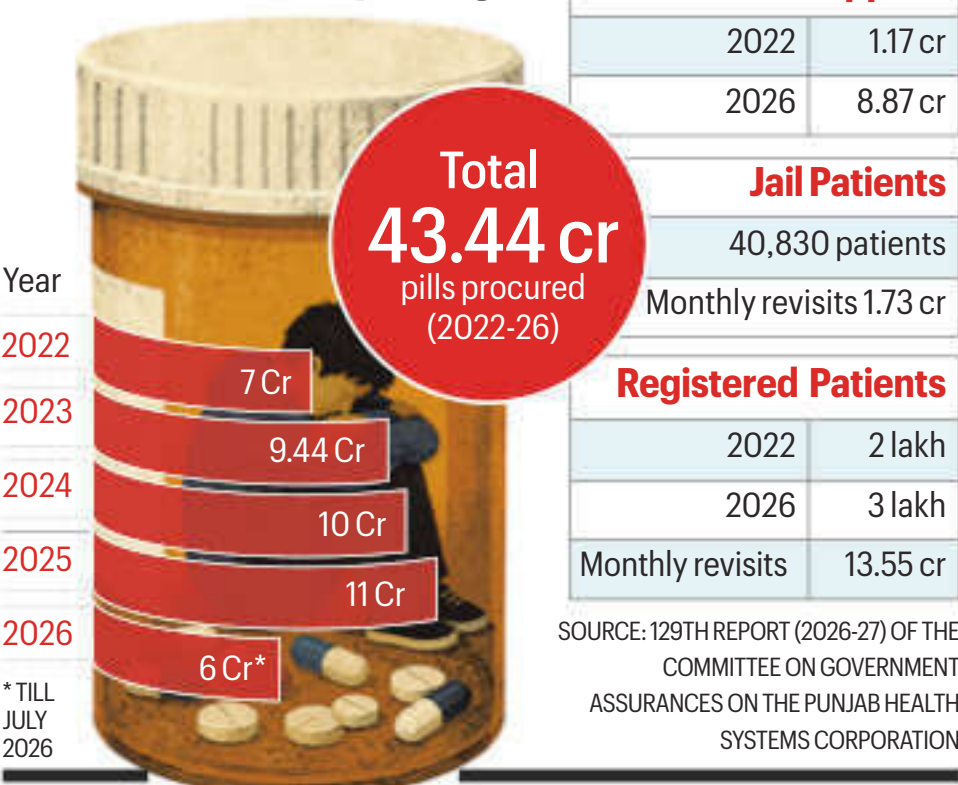
In absolute terms, the highest number of exclusions will be in Bangalore South and Mahadevapura. In Bangalore South, 3.84 lakh voters (48.99%) will be omitted from the draft roll, while Mahadevapura will see 3.13 lakh voters (45.66%) excluded.

Out of Bengaluru's 28 Assembly constituencies, Yelahanka recorded the lowest deletion rate. Even so, 1.81 lakh voters, 38.01% of those mapped for the SIR, were categorised under ASDDO.

Across the four electoral districts making up Bengaluru Urban, BBMP South has 51.65 per cent (11.07 lakh) of its voters listed under ASDDO. The Bangalore Urban electoral district accounts for the largest absolute number of ASDDO entries, with 18.13 lakh voters (45.03 per cent) set to be removed across its seven constituencies. Meanwhile, BBMP North has 11.07 lakh voters (47.46%) flagged under ASDDO, and BBMP Central has 9.15 lakh voters (48.42%).

In 4.5 years, Punjab procures 43.44 crore tablets of opioid used to treat drug addiction

The de-addiction pill saga



Kanchan Vasdev
Chandigarh, August 6

IN JUST over four and half years, Punjab has procured 43.44 crore Buprenorphine for opioid substitution therapy, with the annual requirement continuing to rise, prompting a Punjab Vidhan Sabha committee to question whether the state's de-addiction programme was reducing addiction or merely replacing one dependency with another.

The figures, contained in the 129th Report (2026-27) of the Committee on Government Assurances on the Punjab Health Systems Corporation (PHSC), tabled by its chairman and AAP MLA Jagrup Singh Gill on Thursday, show that procurement of the 2mg tablets increased from 7 crore in 2022 to 9.44 crore in 2023, 10 crore in 2024 and 11 crore in 2025.

In the first six months of 2026 alone, another 6 crore tablets have already been procured, taking the cumulative total to 43.44 crore tablets.

The rise in procurement has coincided with an increase in the number of patients registered at Outpatient Opioid Assisted Treatment (OOAT) clinics, from about 2 lakh in 2022 to nearly 3.17 lakh in 2026.

However, the Assembly committee questioned whether increasing registrations and medicine procurement could be treated as indicators of success when the government could not specify how many addicts had completely recovered.

During the committee's proceedings, the members asked how many patients who began treatment in 2022 were still taking Buprenorphine and how many had become drug free. As per the report, the officials replied that a person who had stopped consuming illicit drugs and was taking Bupre-

norphine under medical supervision was considered de-addicted. They also said that there was no fixed duration for the therapy, comparing it with medicines taken for chronic diseases such as diabetes. They also said that if an addict had to take Buprenorphine for life, it did not risk his life due to overdose, as is the case with other narcotics.

The explanation did not satisfy the committee with members asking whether the government was effectively accepting long-term dependence on Buprenorphine as part of its de-addiction strategy.

The committee also raised reports of misuse of the medicine. Officials informed the committee that some patients dissolve Buprenorphine tablets in water and inject the solution intravenously, creating a fresh pattern of needle based addiction.

The report highlighted infrastructure gaps as well. Ludhiana Civil Hospital, despite witnessing over 250 patients daily at its de-addiction centre, has only 15 dedicated beds.

The committee recommended increasing bed strength and reviewing facilities across the state.

Responding to the concerns, Health Minister Dr Balbir Singh said the increase in the supply of medicines was a result of the government's decision to expand de-addiction services, particularly inside prisons.

He said dedicated de-addiction wards and OOAT clinics had been established in jails, with psychiatrists, counsellors and specialists posted to ensure that inmates underwent treatment before being released. "There should be no misunderstanding. The increase is because we have strengthened treatment facilities inside jails," he said.

Jatin Anand & Shubhangi Khapre
New Delhi, Mumbai, August 6

GEN Z may call it "extra", but the BJP can never be accused of anything less. So, still hurting from the Jantar Mantar protests that forced the resignation of one of its ministers, the BJP government is bouncing back the way it knows best: firing on all cylinders, from Parliament floor to the streets, to public meetings.

"MIA", "FOMO", "Delulu", young BJP MPs have embraced the words in the ongoing Parliament Session, and have been caught doing fist-bumps where earlier handshakes would suffice. And they are doing this with the knowledge that Prime Minister Narendra Modi is watching closely, having himself taken to Instagram — the medium of choice of Gen Z and Jantar Mantar protests — and instructed his ministers to shine there.

BJP leaders, however, insist that its Gen Z outreach is not entirely driven by the 36-day Cockroach Janta Party (CJP)-led protest that posed the Modi government its biggest crisis. And that the party has always reinvented when needed, especially when it comes to social media, pointing out how the BJP wrote the rules of the game on everything from X and WhatsApp to Facebook. "The PM has, evidently, taken the lead by posting reels directly addressing everything from the paper leaks issue to the protesters who were misled into abusing him and his mother (during the protests). This is likely to continue," a senior BJP leader said.



A billboard poster on citizens who support both Gen Z and Prime Minister Narendra Modi, in Mumbai on Thursday. REUTERS

As apparently will the use of Gen Z words by MPs of the BJP and its allies, which was seen during the Parliament debate on the new anti-paper leak law (the only time the House has functioned this Session so far). As BJP MPs Tejasvi Surya (35) and Bansuri Swaraj (42), as well as Shiv Sena MP Shrikant Shinde (39) spoke, their interventions were marked by a smattering of "FOMO", "MIA", "Vasteguna Huiya", "Kuchu Puchu" and

"Clock It". From the Opposition side, NCP (SP) MP Supriya Sule (57) joined in, telling Treasury benches to "not be in delulu" about support from Gen Z just because of the new law.

One of the highlights of the BJP's course correction was its post of Modi posing with groups of youngsters, decidedly of more tender ages than the Jantar Mantar group, crowding around him as the title track of the Friends sitcom played. In a post on August

Fresh off Bihar victory over BJP, Kishor stirs Mumbai waters, meets its ally NCP's top brass

Alok Deshpande
Mumbai, August 6

DAYS AFTER dealing the BJP a resounding defeat in the Bankipur Assembly bypoll in Bihar, Jan Suraj Party chief Prashant Kishor flew into Mumbai on Wednesday night, and held a six-hour closed-door meeting with NCP leader and Deputy Chief Minister Sunetra Pawar and son Parth Thursday.

While both sides were tight-lipped on what transpired at the meeting, it set tongues wagging with Maharashtra politics again in a state of flux, especially over the direction the NCP will take.

Kishor arrived on a chartered flight from Delhi along with Parth. Sunetra had cleared her official schedule for Thursday, and the meeting with the JSP

PK holds a 6-hour closed-door meeting with Parth Pawar & Sunetra Pawar

chief at the Pawar residence was her only known engagement. No other senior NCP leader was present. Sunetra, who has been trying to establish her hold over the NCP after the death of husband Ajit Pawar, and is seen as vulnerable to ally BJP's moves, could do with a shrewd political head by her side. And Kishor, who built his reputation as a political strategist, offers that.

As per sources, Kishor's inputs would be valuable in helping the NCP rebuild the party organisation and redefine its electoral strategy. It is Parth who

is believed to have reached out to the JSP leader, who has always had a good ties with the Pawars.

A source close to the family said one line of thinking is that the state NCP leadership be changed and the organisation "be headed by someone who is not an elected representative". The national faces also came in for a review, sources said.

Incidentally, over the past two days, the NCP has announced a series of appointments to its women, youth, student and young women's wings, filling them with leaders seen as close to Parth. The NCP's relationship with the BJP has been under a strain, with the senior partner seen as dabbling with the Sharad Pawar-led NCP (SP) to keep Sunetra and Parth on tenterhooks. The NCP could go it

alone in the coming zilla parishad panchayat polls, instead of as part of the ruling Mahayuti alliance, with one topic of discussion at Thursday's meeting reportedly being "testing NCP's political strength on its own, under the leadership of Sunetra". NCP sources said the Congress's recent criticism of Sunetra as "goongi gudiya (mute doll)" also came up for discussion. Kishor said the Deputy CM had done the right thing in avoiding a public confrontation, effectively silencing the criticism. Sources said Kishor could take on a larger role in the coming days with NCP, as the local body elections draw nearer.

This was Kishor's third meeting with the family in recent months. Kishor and the Pawars did not respond to texts and calls.

SC allows Asaram to engage full-time caregiver in prison

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 6

THE SUPREME Court on Thursday allowed self-styled godman Asaram Bapu, undergoing life imprisonment for the rape of a minor girl, to engage a full-time caregiver in jail given his health condition.

A bench of Justices M M Sundresh and P B Varale gave this direction after reviewing a report filed by the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), which stated that although Asaram did not need hospitalisation, he would need round-the-clock care.

"We have taken note of the letter dated July 31, 2026 by the AIIMS. On the statement of the Solicitor General that the contents of the letter will be considered in letter and spirit, accordingly the petitioner will have liberty to have assistance of a trained caretaker of his choice on round-the-clock basis," the bench ordered.

The SC also gave Asaram liberty to approach it again if his health deteriorates. The bench expressed its displeasure at Asaram's conduct after Solicitor General Tushar Mehta pointed out that the 85-year-old had secured a 20-day parole from the Rajasthan HC by not disclosing his SC bail plea, which also withheld information about a high court order that had refused him bail on medical grounds.

GOVT RESPONDS TO PETITION SEEKING MODIFICATION OF RESERVATION POLICY

Extending creamy layer to SC, ST is Parliament's call: Govt to top court

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 6

THE COUNTRY'S reservation policy is based "not solely on economic status" but on "historical and social criteria like caste, tribe and social backwardness," the Centre told the Supreme Court on Thursday, adding that its "modification...particularly to introduce income-based preferences within reserved categories, should be preceded by a holistic review and thorough empirical study, including socio-economic data of reserved category beneficiaries."

In a counter affidavit filed in the top court in response to a petition on June 15, 2026, the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment said that only the Parliament can take a call on the question of extending the creamy layer principle to Scheduled Castes (SC) and Scheduled Tribes (ST), and urged the court to reject a petition seeking directions to it to frame guidelines to introduce among others, income-based sub-quotas within reserved categories.

The government further pointed out that the reliefs sought fall in the realm of policy, and urged the court to "refrain

from directing the executive to frame policies on reservation or income-based preferences without empirical data or legislative mandate, keeping in view the separation of powers and judicial precedents."

The petition sought directions to the Centre to "frame policies for a more equitable and just system of reservation in government employment and educational opportunities thereby Ensuring Equitable Distribution of Reservation Benefits on a Merit-Cum-Means Approach" and/or "to implement/adopt the income-based preferences within each reserved category to ensure equitable distribution of benefits among economically weaker candidates belonging to SC, ST, Other Backward Classes (OBC), and Economically Weaker Sections (EWS)".

The petitioners also sought the court to direct the government "to frame guidelines to ensure that candidates from economically weaker backgrounds within each reserved category are treated as a sub-class, and accorded higher merit and priority in the selection process, in compliance with the law laid down...in the landmark case of State of Punjab & Ors v Davinder Singh & Ors," wherein a Su-

“Criteria for inclusion in the SC, ST, and Socially and Educationally Backward Class lists are based on historical, social, and economic backwardness. SCs face historical disadvantage from untouchability, while STs exhibit... geographical isolation... Socially and Educationally Backward Classes are identified by social, educational, and economic disadvantages, along with a lack of representation in services”

— CENTRE'S AFFIDAVIT

preme Court constitution bench held that SCs and STs could be sub-classified for the purpose of

reservation.

Responding to this, the government pointed out that a five-judge Supreme Court bench had in its 2005 decision in E V Chinnaiah v State of Andhra Pradesh & Ors "held that whenever, a situation arises for exclusion of creamy layer from SCs, it will be the Parliament alone to take the necessary legislative steps in terms of clause (2) of Article 341 of the Constitution."

The Centre's affidavit further pointed out that the "criteria for inclusion in the SC, ST, and Socially and Educationally Backward Class lists are based on historical, social, and economic backwardness. Scheduled Castes face historical disadvantage from untouchability, while Scheduled Tribes exhibit distinct cultures, geographical isolation, and backwardness. Socially and Educationally Backward Classes are identified by social, educational, and economic disadvantages, along with a lack of representation in services."

"These criteria," the affidavit read, "are not spelt out in the Constitution but have become well established. Thus, the identification of SCs, STs, and Socially and Educationally Backward Classes

(SEBCs)/OBCs is based on historical and social criteria like caste, tribe, and social backwardness, not solely on economic status."

Citing the apex court decisions in various reservation related cases, the Centre also contended that the principle of excluding the creamy layer has been developed in the context of OBC reservations and is not applicable to SCs and STs.

"It has nowhere specifically been held that the principle of creamy layer is applicable to SCs and STs..." and "this has been clarified by a Constitution Bench of" the court "in the case of Ashoka Kumar Thakur vs. Union of India...decided on 10.04.2008 that for the purpose of reservation the principles of creamy layer are not applicable to SCs and STs", the counter affidavit pointed out.

It added that "in majority of schemes of welfare and development of SCs, STs, and Socially and Educationally Backward Classes expecting reservation in educational institutions and reservation in services under the State, there are means to ensure that benefits of schemes percolate to those who actually deserve them."

NATIONAL WORKING COMMITTEE FORMED

'Kya Bolti Public': CJP to launch nationwide youth outreach drive

Manoj More
Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar, August 6

THE COCKROACH Janta Party (CJP) Thursday announced a major nationwide campaign called Kya Bolti Public to mobilise youth around critical issues such as education reforms, rising unemployment and media credibility.

Speaking at a press conference in Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar, CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke outlined the initiative, which will see the organisation travel across India to engage directly with young people.

"Kya Bolti Public will be a nationwide campaign wherein we will tour the country, meet and interact with youth. We will try to understand their problems, grievances, demands and expectations. Over 65 per cent of our population is below 35 years of age, yet our leaders, political parties, and governments do not speak seriously about their education, employment and future. The government's focus is solely on Hindu-Muslim politics," Dipke said while announcing the launch of the campaign.

Through the campaign, Dipke said CJP will travel and directly interact with citizens, students, and parents. "Our campaign seeks to build broad public opinion against those commercialising education and

against administrative negligence, thereby exerting pressure on the government," he said.

Dipke said that through the protests at Jantar Mantar demanding Union Education Minister's Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation, they made the government bow down. "It wasn't just the resignation of a single minister; it was a major victory in eliminating the fear of the government residing in the hearts of citizens," he said while expressing confidence that citizens across the country will not only ask questions but also take to the streets if necessary.

Beyond employment and policy concerns, Dipke took aim at skyrocketing fees in schools, colleges, and coaching institutes, turning education into a heavy debt burden.

PTI adds: The (CJP) on Thursday formed its National Working Committee, with founder Abhijeet Dipke being appointed as its national convener. CJP's chief spokesperson Saurav Das and spokesperson Ashutosh Ranka will be the co-conveners of the outfit.

The announcement was made during a press conference here after the conclusion of the CJP core team's two-day meeting held at Dipke's residence in the city. Its office-bearers said the CJP will not be turned into a political party any time soon, but will work at the grassroot level.

Manish Sahu
& **Maulshree Seth**
Lucknow, August 6

AS THE Congress and BJP trade charges over the cancellation of ground for Rahul Gandhi's rally in Prayagraj, little has changed for the students whose protests prompted the Congress to choose the city as one of the venues for its 'Chhatron ki Goonj' outreach.

On May 29, hundreds of students had hit the streets in Prayagraj, a major coaching hub, demanding the release of scorecards for the Uttar Pradesh Police Sub-Inspector examination and cancellation of the Lekhpal recruitment test, over what they alleged were serious irregularities in the process. They also called for greater transparency in Uttar Pradesh's recruitment mechanisms.

Besides students, owners and teachers of several coaching institutes in the city had joined the protests, following which three popular coaching centres were sealed by the Prayagraj Development Authority (PDA) for alleged irregularities.

More than two months later, while the centres essentially remain shut, the government released scorecards for the S-I examination only last week, after the final results were declared. The Lekhpal recruitment test was not cancelled, but its results are yet to be announced.

Congress UP general secre-



UP Congress president Ajay Rai addresses a press conference on the party's 'Chhatron Ki Goonj' programme in Prayagraj on Thursday. PTI

tary Anil Yadav, the coordinator of the 'Chhatron Ki Goonj' campaign in Prayagraj – earlier events were held by Gandhi in Kota and Dehradun – said they plan to raise several issues, including the alleged harassment of students, the closure of coaching institutes, and the matter of pending bharti (recruitments). While the Congress was the organiser, it would be a non-political, student-centric event, Yadav said.

Before the booking for K P Ground in Prayagraj's George Town area for Gandhi's August 8 rally was cancelled, the Congress expected around 50,000 students to participate. The Kayastha Pathshala Trust that owns the ground revoked permission, citing an Allahabad High Court order saying the venue could be used only for

sports and educational activities, and claiming the ground was waterlogged. It also said that the Congress could hold the programme after the rainy season or during vacations, and that the advance amount of Rs 51,000 would be refunded.

The Congress has contested the cancellation, pointing out the prior permission for it. With the party trying for alternative venues, Gandhi declared Thursday that the government could not stop him from "raising the voice of students". In a post in Hindi on X, Gandhi said the Modi government's policy was to "suppress the voice of the youth". "Ask a question and you get lathicharged, protest and you face cases, and raise your voice and you get pellet guns... It's clear that they are even afraid of 'Chhatron ki

Goonj'... No matter how hard the government tries, it cannot stop me from raising their voice," he wrote.

UP Congress president Ajay Rai, who visited Prayagraj on Wednesday in connection with the event, told The Indian Express: "Just a few days ago, a marriage function was held on K P Ground, and there was no objection. If there was any issue, they should not have allotted the ground in the first place... This is nothing but a pressure tactic by the BJP, which does not want Rahul Gandhi to address students in Prayagraj. But Rahul Gandhi will come, whether permission is granted or not."

The owners of two of the three coaching institutes whose premises remain sealed, however, won't be among those participating – the May experience apparently weighing on their minds. While they were aware of the Congress meeting, they did not wish to be a part of it, they said.

Maroof Ahmed, owner of Super Climax, said that of the three rented buildings from which he ran his institute, the seal on only one has been removed. Going forward, he would only lease buildings that had completed all the formalities required by the PDA, Ahmed said. On the Congress protest, he said: "I only want to do my work. I'm not interested in any campaign."

• **BRIEFLY**



The damaged car at the accident site in Jhansi on Thursday. PTI

UTTAR PRADESH

Son of slain gangster Atiq Ahmed dies in road accident in Jhansi

SLAIN MAFIA don-turned-politician Atiq Ahmed's youngest son, Abaan, was killed in a road accident in Uttar Pradesh's Jhansi on Thursday while he was on his way to meet his brother in jail. Police said Abaan, 21, was travelling in an SUV along with four of his friends when it hit a divider and overturned. One of his friends, Sonu, was also declared dead when taken to the hospital. Two others are undergoing treatment. The injured men told police and the media that they had left Prayagraj early to visit Abaan's elder brother, Ali Ahmed, who is lodged in Jhansi jail. Abaan was one of Atiq's twin sons. His twin brother, Ahzam, is currently at the family home in Prayagraj. ENS

Six of a family die in Pratapgarh as house collapses

HEAVY RAINS turned tragic for a family sleeping together in a room in UP's Pratapgarh district, as the roof of their house collapsed following heavy rain in the early hours of Thursday. Six members of the family, including two children, were buried alive under the debris, leaving a lone survivor in the incident that took place around 2 am in the city's Maholi locality. ENS

Odisha: Agni-4 missile tested successfully

INDIA ON Thursday successfully test-fired nuclear-capable ballistic missile Agni-4 from Odisha's Chandipur, demonstrating its strategic strike capabilities. The testing of the missile was carried out by the SFC and the DRDO. "Medium Range Ballistic Missile 'Agni-4' was successfully test-fired from the Integrated Test Range, Chandipur in Odisha on August 6," the defence ministry said. PTI

Jharkhand students, Soren govt set for talks amid recruitment row

Shubham Tigga
Ranchi, August 6

AN 11-MEMBER delegation of protesters is set to meet the Jharkhand government to try and break the impasse over alleged irregularities in the state's public service and staff selection commissions, organisers said. This comes after Governor Santosh Gangwar met CM Hemant Soren as protests for wider reforms intensified in the state.

According to protest organisers JPSC-JSSC Reforms Manch, a list of 11 members has been drawn up to lead talks with the Hemant Soren government's three-member delegation. The government's delegation will have one member each from the ruling JMM, the Congress and the RJD, sources said.

The meeting was expected on Thursday evening, but it didn't happen. "We have formed an 11-member delegation, comprising eight students, two experts (journalists) and an advocate, in response to the government's offer to hold talks in connection with the stir," an

office bearer of the JPSC-JSSC Reforms Manch, the organisers of the protest, said.

The developments come at a time when the protesters rolled the Monsoon Session of the Jharkhand Assembly, where the Opposition BJP wore masks and carried printed messages demanding the government's reply over the alleged irregularities. Legislators have demanded a CBI probe into the allegations.

It also comes a day after Soren met Governor Santosh Gangwar to assure him of action. In a statement Wednesday, Lok Bhawan said the governor was "apprised of the appointment processes of the Jharkhand Public Service Commission (JPSC) and Jharkhand Staff Selection Commission (JSSC), as well as matters related to the student movement.

Meanwhile, in a video message to students, Lok Sabha Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi said that all governments, irrespective of the party in power, should improve the education system and listen to the students.

THE DRAMATIS PERSONAE INCLUDE OFFICIATING DGP ASHOK TEWARI, DIG SANJEEV GANDHI, SHIMLA SP GAURAV SINGH AND FORMER DGP SR MARDI

'What will such a force do in real crisis?': Open spat among top police officers in Himachal

Saurabh Parashar
Shimla, August 6

AFTER A spat among its top bureaucrats early this year, Himachal Pradesh is now seeing open squabbling by its senior police officers – in a dispute that first began over a British-era bungalow.

The two main characters in the tussle are officiating Director General of Police (DGP) Ashok Tewari and DIG (Traffic, Tourism and Railways) Sanjeev Gandhi, with Shimla Superintendent of Police (SP) Gaurav Singh and former DGP SR Mardi playing secondary roles.

The sprawling Southwood bungalow that sparked off the war of words is the official residence of the Shimla SP. A part of the Brockhurst Estate, Southwood is located in one of Shimla's poshest areas, that also houses the residence of the Governor, the Leader of the Opposi-

tion and former chief minister Jairam Thakur, and Himachal Revenue and Tribal Minister Jagat Singh Negi, among others.

Gaurav Singh took over as Shimla SP in January, but he has not been able to move into Southwood as Gandhi, his predecessor in the post, is yet to vacate it. Singh has been staying at the Police Headquarters.

In June, six months after he was moved out as the Shimla SP, Gandhi was finally issued a notice by the Police Headquarters directing him to vacate Southwood. The notice, issued under the Himachal Pradesh Allotment of Government Residences (General Pool) Rules, also proposed a penalty of nearly Rs 1.8 lakh on Gandhi for overstaying. Sources said Gandhi said he could not shift as the government accommodation allotted to him was occupied by the Medical Superintendent of Indian Gandhi Medical College

& Hospital. Subsequently, another house was allotted to Gandhi, but he rejected it reportedly because of its "dilapidated" condition.

As Gandhi delayed vacating the bungalow, on July 31, DGP Tewari constituted a three-member committee to conduct a special audit of expenditure incurred on repairs and maintenance works at Southwood between 2022 and 2025, when Gandhi headed the Shimla district police. The committee was reportedly asked to examine the source, sanction, allocation and utilisation of funds, as well as scrutinise financial records and identify any procedural violations or financial irregularities.

A senior officer said, "The base of the special audit was a report... which said that approximately Rs 14.07 lakh was spent on the maintenance, repairs of Southwood between 2022 and 2025. Of this, Rs 11.57 lakh came



A part of the Brockhurst Estate, Southwood, is located in one of Shimla's poshest areas. EXPRESS

out of the residential fund of the district police, and Rs 2.50 lakh was money meant for the maintenance of a police post in Shoghi, Shimla."

Almost simultaneously, Gandhi sent a report to the Chief Minister's office claiming irregularities in procurement of equipment by the Traffic, Tourism

and Railways Department, as well as in spending of the Road Safety Fund under it.

In response, DGP Tewari ordered an audit of financial records and sanctioned expenditure, and investigation into compliance with the Himachal Pradesh Road Safety Fund and Activities Rules, 2022, by the

Road Safety Fund. It nominated a Joint Controller of the State Vigilance and Anti-Corruption Bureau to conduct the audit.

Gandhi objected, demanding an audit by the Comptroller and Auditor General of India through the Accountant General (Audit), Himachal, – a demand rejected by Tewari as "inappropriate". While Tewari declined to comment on the row, Gandhi confirmed raising the issue of Road Safety Fund spending with senior officials, and added: "I have conveyed my stand pertaining to my official residence to the department."

Adding a twist to the tale, remarks surfaced of ex-DGP Mardi questioning "delays" in the handling of the investigation into fake degrees of Manav Bharti University in March 2020, under Tiwari as Additional DGP (CID).

The Police Headquarters responded to this with a detailed

rebuttal, citing official records and asserting that the CID had completed its inquiry within a week, and that subsequent decisions were taken at the level of the then DGP (that is, Mardi).

Mardi told The Indian Express: "I have nothing to do with either Ashok Tewari or Sanjeev Gandhi. I heard that BJP MLA Bikram Thakur had raised the issue of the delay in registration of FIRs in the Manav Bharti fake degree scam. A journalist called me to get my version, and I told him that, whatever the reasons for the delay, they were mentioned in the FIR. To my surprise, the next day I found that the office of DGP Ashok Tewari had issued a rebuttal claiming that I had made certain allegations." In a sharp criticism of the public airing of differences by the top police officers, Additional Chief Secretary (Home) R D Nazem told The Indian Express that it was "absolute indis-

cipline". "A force whose senior officers are busy pointing guns at each other, what will they do in a real crisis? Whatever is going on, is not good," he said, adding that Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu would be apprised of the matter.

Gandhi, incidentally, was involved in a public row last year too, when he had openly attacked DGP Atul Verma over a probe against him. The two had eventually been sent on leave.

Earlier this year, Himachal's bureaucracy was caught up in allegations and counter-allegations, with ex-Chief Secretary Sanjay Gupta questioning his former colleagues over clearances given for a mega housing project in Solan. The two he openly blamed, current Real Estate Regulatory Authority (RERA) chief R D Dhiman and former RERA chief Shrikant Baldi, have both been Chief Secretaries of the state.





Shri Narendra Modi
Prime Minister

Shri Mohan Charan Majhi
Chief Minister, Odisha

ODISHA FOODPRO

2026

GLOBAL TASTE, **MADE IN ODISHA**

7 AUGUST 2026 | NEW DELHI

ODISHA'S FIRST DEDICATED FOOD-PROCESSING
INVESTMENT OUTREACH IN DELHI NCR

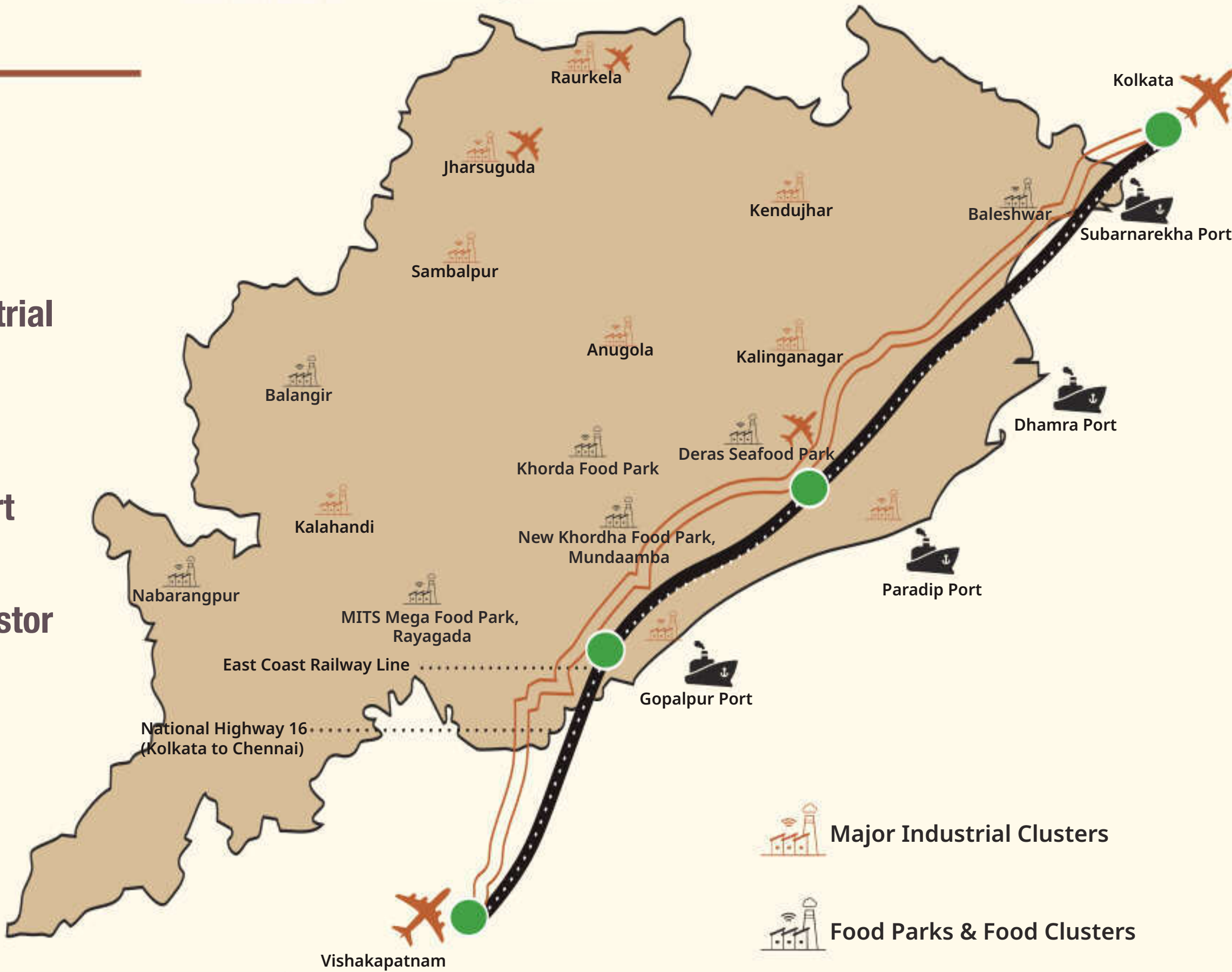
Chaired by
Shri Mohan Charan Majhi

ODISHA : AN ESTABLISHED FOOD-PROCESSING DESTINATION



WHY ODISHA?

- Strong Logistics Connectivity
- Dedicated Industrial Infrastructure
- Strategic Market Access
- Competitive Financial Support
- Abundant Raw Material Base
- Responsive Investor Facilitation



Best-in-Class Incentives

20%

Capital Investment Subsidy on the cost of Plant & Machinery, with no upper cap

100%

Stamp Duty exemption on Concessional Industrial Land rates

100%

SGST reimbursement up to 200% of cost of Plant & Machinery

₹2

per unit Power Subsidy & 100% Electricity Duty Reimbursement

100%

ESI/EPF Reimbursement

- Explore Investment Locations
- Identify Business Partnerships
- Understand State Incentives
- Schedule One-To-One B2G Meetings

Don't miss the Odisha growth story!

Meet the State delegation and explore opportunities in India's fastest-growing investment destination

7th August
New Delhi

8th August
Noida



In association with



scan to register

Schedule a meeting

Chief General Manager (SLNA)
Mob : +91 9955327527
rajibbdhal@investodisha.org

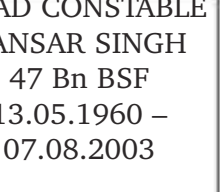
Nodal Officer - Food Processing
Mob : +91 7799001170
nishikant@investodisha.org

INVEST IN ODISHA, INVEST IN FUTURE

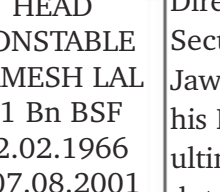
SALUTE THE SOLDIER

BORDER SECURITY FORCE			
			
HC SOCHENDRA KUMAR 19 Bn BSF 01.01.1957 – 07.08.1993	NK ABDUL RAZAQ GANI 19 Bn BSF 05.04.1955 – 07.08.1993	CT TULCHI RAM 19 Bn BSF 18.03.1969 – 07.08.1993	CT VIJAY PAL 19 Bn BSF 25.05.1972 – 07.08.1993

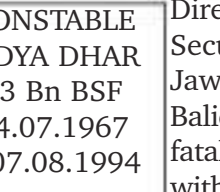
Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawans Head Constable Sochendra Kumar, Naik Abdul Razaq Gani, Constables Tulchi Ram and Vijay Pal on their Balidan Diwas. On this day, they sustained fatal bullet injuries in a fierce encounter with militants in Sopore area, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.

	
HEAD CONSTABLE SANSAR SINGH 47 Bn BSF 13.05.1960 – 07.08.2003	CONSTABLE HARI RAM 47 Bn BSF 07.10.1976 – 07.08.2003

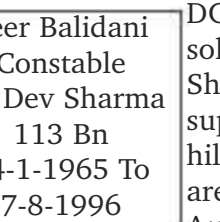
Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawans Head Constable Sansar Singh and Constable Hari Ram on their Balidan Diwas. On this day, they sustained fatal injuries in a grenade blast triggered by militants in area of Lal Chowk, Srinagar (J&K) and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.

	
HEAD CONSTABLE RAMESH LAL 31 Bn BSF 02.02.1966 – 07.08.2001	NAIK RAM LAL 62 Bn BSF 02.09.1956 – 07.08.1993

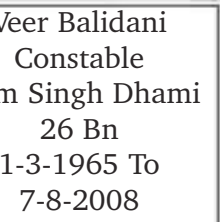
Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Naik Ram Lal on his Balidan Diwas. On 6th Aug 1993, he sustained fatal bullet injuries in a fierce encounter with militants in area of Lalpora, Kupwara (J&K) and later succumbed to his injuries at Army hospital, Drugmullah on 07th Aug 1993.

	
CONSTABLE VIDYA DHAR 73 Bn BSF 04.07.1967 – 07.08.1994	SI GIRWAR SINGH RAWAT 106 Bn BSF 24.10.1943 – 07.08.1996

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Subordinate officer Sub Inspector Girwar Singh Rawat on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal injuries in a grenade blast triggered by militants in Srinagar area, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.

	
Veer Balidani Constable Jai Dev Sharma 113 Bn 24-1-1965 To 7-8-1996	Veer Balidani Constable Manjunath A. 109 Bn 1-7-1985 To 7-8-2008

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Jai Dev Sharma of 113 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after falling from a hill due to an IED blast while on an area domination patrol in Tripura on 7 August 1996. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

	
Veer Balidani Constable Ram Singh Dhami 26 Bn 1-3-1965 To 7-8-2008	Veer Balidani Constable Bijender Singh 26 Bn 5-4-1977 To 7-8-2008

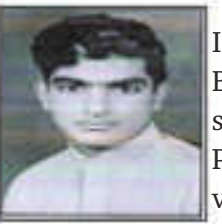
DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Ram Singh Dhami and Constable Bijender Singh of 26 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating Maoists during an operation in Giridih district, Jharkhand on 7 August 2008. #CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.

	
Veer Balidani Constable Mukul Chandra Barman 204 CoBRA Bn 5-7-1988 To 7-8-2012	Veer Balidani Constable/ Driver Krishan Pal Singh 204 CoBRA Bn 25-12-1979 To 7-8-2012

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Mukul Chandra Barman and Constable/ Driver Krishan Pal Singh of 204 CoBRA Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating Maoists in Bijapur district, Chhattisgarh on 7 August 2012. #CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.


Constable Devendra Singh

ITBP salutes its braveheart Constable Devendra Singh of 16th Battalion, who laid down his life in the line of duty on this day in Ladakh in 2019.


L NK (LATE) CHAMEL SINGH

In proud memory of L Nk Chamel Singh of 6th Battalion The Dogra Regiment, who made the supreme sacrifice while serving the Nation at South of Hajipur Pass (INDO PAK WAR) on 07 Aug 1965. Your act of valour, raw courage & devotion to duty will always remain a source of inspiration and motivation to all of us.

"BRAVES DIE, BUT ONLY ONCE"

Remembered by Commanding Officer and All Ranks 6 DOGRA.

Man smashes emergency exit window panel mid-air; says ‘felt like doing so..’

Thiruvananthapuram: A passenger aboard a Kuala Lumpur to Kochi flight allegedly smashed the emergency exit window panel and attempted to open the emergency exit door while the aircraft was mid-flight on Wednesday night.

Jamsheer Athanikkal, 36, a native of Palakkad, was arrested based on the complaint of the security incharge of Batik Airlines at Kochi airport.

The incident took place mid-air at Batik Air's aircraft OD 231.

According to Kochi airport police, Jamsheer, who works in the hospitality sector in Malaysia, was on a trip to his hometown. "The incident took place mid-air between 9.30 pm and 11 pm. Jamsheer was a traveller in seat number 12A. Without any provocation, he tried to open the emergency exit and destroyed the exit window panel. He threatened the co-passengers and the crew, who tried to prevent him. Later, he was overpowered by the co-passengers and the crew," said a police officer at the airport.

The arrested person has not cited any provocation behind the act, the officer said. "He said he felt like doing so at that moment. He said he was coming home to see his newborn. Police will seek his custody for further questioning," the officer added.

SC refuses to relax bail conditions of Lakhimpur Kheri violence accused

Express News Service New Delhi, August 6

THE SUPREME COURT on Thursday rejected a plea to relax the bail conditions of Ashish Mishra, the prime accused in the 2021 Lakhimpur Kheri violence case.

Mishra had urged the court to ease his bail conditions as he was not able to even attend family events, including the birthday celebrations of his daughter.

A bench of Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justices Joyimalya Bagchi and V Mohana said it found no reason to entertain his request "at this stage".

Appearing for the families of some victims, Advocate Prashant Bhushan also raised objections to the manner in which the trial was being conducted. He said some of the prosecution witnesses were being given only one day to appear in court and in case they failed to reach in time, they were being dropped from the case. The SC bench asked him to raise such objections before the trial court itself.

Four anti-farm law protesters were killed when a convoy of vehicles, including one belonging to Mishra's father and former Union minister of state Ajay Mishra, ran over them on October 3, 2021. Two BJP workers, the driver of one of the vehicles, and a journalist were killed in the ensuing violence.

UP headmistress suspended over poor quality mid-day meal

Lucknow: After a video showing watery vegetable curry being served to students during mid-day meal at a primary school in Uttar Pradesh's Sitapur district went viral on social media, the education department Wednesday suspended the school's headmistress and terminated the services of the cook.

Officials said an FIR was also registered against the two at the Mahmoodabad police station late Wednesday evening.

The video purportedly showed chunks of potato floating in watery curry ladled onto the children's plates.

Sitapur District Magistrate Dr Rajaganapathy R and Basic Shiksha Adhikari (BSA) Gorakhnath Patel said in a statement that the block education officer (BEO), Udaimani Patel, who is the immediate supervising official for primary schools in the block, was also held responsible for dereliction of duty.

An adverse entry was made in his service record. ENS

SHIV SENA SPLIT

SC questions Shiv Sena (UBT) over amendment to party constitution

Express News Service New Delhi, August 6

HEARING PETITIONS over the split in the Shiv Sena, the Supreme Court Thursday questioned the amendment made to the party's constitution in 2018, saying it appeared to have transformed the party from a "democratic" organisation to a "complete one-man show".

"You talk of democratic principles in different institutions... then the question would arise whether as a political party, are you also not supposed to follow this principle?", the Chief Justice of India Surya Kant asked.

His remarks came while presiding over a three-judge bench comprising Justices Joyimalya Bagchi and V Mohana on the petition challenging the Election Commission of India's (ECI) decision to recognise the Eknath Shinde-led group as the real Shiv Sena and to allot it the party symbol.

Senior Advocate Kapil Sibal, appearing for the rival Shiv Sena (Uddhav Thackeray) faction, denied this and said, "We didn't. I will demonstrate that. But the question is this is not the remit of the Election Commission".

Elaborating, Sibal said, "There are institutions that perform a constitutional function. There are institutions that perform a political function. The level of integrity is much higher when you are performing a constitutional function. A political function can be rectified, but a decision made by an [Election] Commission seldom in circumstances can never be rectified."

He added that there were cases wherein elections were not held in organisations for years, and asked whether "anyone said it is undemocratic, and therefore I will take action, not recognise the constitution".

However, Justice Bagchi pointed to Paragraph 95 of the ECI's February 17, 2023, order made under the Election Symbols (Reservation and Allotment) Order, 1968, recognising the Shinde group, and said that it gives the reasons why the Commission had not relied on the amended constitution. "Show us if it's factually incorrect or legally untenable," the judge said.

In response, Sibal said, "I will show both. It's both factually incorrect and legally untenable", adding, "give this power to the Commission that at a given point in time, they can say 'your constitution is unconstitutional'... 'that we will not deal with it'... 'we will not look at it' – see the consequences of that in politics".

The senior advocate pointed out that the consequences of giving "this power to the Commission... will be very grave".

Sibal further contended that Section 29A of The Representation of the People Act requires an association of individuals

calling itself a political party to be registered with the ECI.

"The party need not have returned candidates to the assembly to be registered as a political party. Under the Symbols Order, a political party receives recognition as a state party or a national party based on the total number of candidates returned to the assembly by the political party and/or the total percentage of the vote secured in the election," he said.

"The purpose of the requirement under the Symbols Order," he maintained, "is to identify whether the political party has a substantial presence in the electoral fray to freeze an electoral symbol for that party. And that it does not refer to an association of legislators *dehors* (outside) the political party."

Sibal said the concept of legislature party is not recognised by the Symbols Order. "It's only the political party which is recognised," he said, adding, "If you base your decision on the legislature party, then it's a problem."

The senior advocate also referred to the Supreme Court's 1992 judgement in the landmark Kihoto Hollohan v. Zachillhu case, which upheld the constitutional validity of the Tenth Schedule (anti-defection law), and added that the court had then said "defection is a constitutional sin".

The hearing will continue on August 11.

Mumbai: 12 arrested for cyber fraud

Mumbai: Police have busted an international cyber fraud racket with links to Dubai and arrested 12 persons from a villa in Goa for allegedly duping people through fake online gaming platforms, an official said Thursday. PTI

**OFFICE OF THE RESIDENT ENGINEER**
BUILDING DIVISION, BIHAR BHAWAN, NEW DELHI
National Competitive Bidding by e-tendering Website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in

E-tender Notice
CORRIGENDUM

This is to inform to all that in E-tender notice No-01/2026-27 whose PR No. is IPRD_PR_008236/26-27 Published in daily new-paper and issued from this office by letter No. 435 enc, dated 20.07.2026 following modifications are being made.

Name of Work :-	Comprehensive Housekeeping, Maintenance and operation Contract (for 5 years) of Bihar Sadan, Dwarka, New Delhi 2026-31		
Sl. No	Particulars	Last Modified Date and time	5 th Modified Date and Time
1	Last date and time of sale: (download) of BOQ	from Date 06.08.2026 to 01.09.2026 up to 15.00 hrs	from Date 11.09.2026 to 05.10.2026 up to 15.00 hrs
2	Last Date and time of submission (upload) of tender	Date 02.09.2026 upto 15.00 hrs	Date 06.10.2026 upto 15.00 hrs
3	Date and time of opening of tender (Technical Bid)	Date 03.09.2026 upto 15.30 hrs	Date 07.10.2026 upto 15.30 hrs
4	Date and time of opening of tender (Financial Bid)	After disposal of Technical Bid from Departmental Tender Committee	After disposal of Technical Bid from Departmental Tender Committee
5	Pre Bid Meeting Date/Time/Place	Date 13.08.2026 at 15.00 Hrs, in office of Chief Engineer (Patna), BCD, Patna. Date 17.08.2026 at 15.00 Hrs. in office of Bihar Bhawan, New Delhi.	Date 18.09.2026 at 15.00 Hrs. in office of Chief Engineer (Patna), BCD, Patna. Date 21.09.2026 at 15.00 Hrs. in office of Bihar Bhawan, New Delhi.

All other conditions will remain unchanged

Resident Engineer
Building Division
Bihar Bhawan, New Delhi

PR-009427 (BCD) 2026-27

सिस्लु सूचना www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर भी देखी जा सकती है।

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT, CIRCLE NO-1
RAIPUR (C.G.)
Tender Notice

Contractors, Registered appropriate class in Unified Registration System [e- Registration] invited Online tenders for the following works :-

NIT No./System Tender No.	Name of Work	Probable amount of contract
39/195202	Estimate for Room for Various Purpose at Family Court, Raipur (C.G) (3rd Call)	Rs. 59.02 Lakh
07/195323	Road safety work for Vidhansabha road to Haritage Hospital Kachna Raipur (C.G.) (5th Call)	Rs. 131.05 Lakh
10/195324	Construction of (Balance Work) 4 Way Direction Ce Road, Bt Road & Drain Work (Length-2.373 km) at Pt. Jawahar Lal Nehru, Ward No. 2, Kabser Nagar, Municipal Corporation, Raipur I/C Culverts At Dist. Raipur (4th Call)	Rs. 124.59 Lakh
304/195974	Special Repair work in (1) Km-3/2 & Km-3/4(100m) to KM-3/8 in Borid to Mokhla Road (VR-113), (2) Km 59/8, 72/2 & KM 78/4 in Simga Tilda Kharora Arang Nawapara Kurud (SH-20) Road, (3) at Km 8/4 (Length= 180Meter) in Charoda Gidhwa Chhiatera (MDR-305) Road, (4) in KM 16/2 to 16/4(100m), in Paragon Goida Tila (MDR-220) Road, (3rd Call)	Rs. 85.06 Lakh
152/194983	Construction of Boundary Wall, Drain Line & Renovation Work for Govt. College Mana at Mana Camp, Raipur (C.G.) (1st Call)	Rs. 43.37 Lakh
153/194984	Construction of Govt. High School Building at Puraima, Raipur, C.G.(As Per Revised Approved Drawing) (1st Call)	Rs. 68.39 Lakh
154/194985	उपरोक्त क्र.-1 के अंतिम उपखंड क्र-4 के रै आखरीय बन्द में विशेष भस्म, लघुसुल नीय कार्य एवं डिजाईन कार्य। (1st Call)	Rs. 25.00 Lakh

NIT No.39 System Tender No.195202, NIT No.07 System Tender No.195323, NIT No.10 System Tender No.195324 & NIT No.304 System Tender No.195974 Last date of tender Download Date up to 13.08.2026 Time 17:30 PM & NIT No.152 System Tender No.194983, NIT No.153 System Tender No.194984 & NIT No.154 System Tender No.194985 Last date of tender Download Date up to 23.08.2026 Time 17:30 PM

Note:- All eligible/interested contractors are mandated to get enrolled on the e Procurement portal (<https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in>) in order to download the tender documents and participate in the subsequent bidding process.

Sd/-
Superintending Engineer
Public Works Department
Raipur Circle No-1, Raipur (C.G.)

RO. No. 262702587/5

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE					
Sr. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / END (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH
1.	THE TENDRA CO-OPERATIVE MILK PRODUCCERS UNION LIMITED, ROHTAK (HARYANA)	CONSTRUCTION/FABRICATION OF MILK BOOTH AS PER OUR DRAWING/DESIGN AND SPECIFICATION COMPLETE IN ALL RESPECT FOR THE MILK UNIONS E.IE MILK UNION, ROHTAK	05.08.2026 21.08.2026	AS PER BIDD	vtanand@gmail.com vtanand@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 47909/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE					
Sr. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / END (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH
1.	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION, FARIDABAD	ESTIMATE FOR RENOVING OF 600 KVA TRANSFORMER COIL AND REMOVING AND REPAIRING OF 600 KVA TRANSFORMER, INCLUDING LABOUR CHARGES AT MCF-HEAD OFFICE BK CHOWK NIT FARIDABAD - 1 WORK	04.08.2026 11.08.2026	Rs. 13,01,266/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in nctanand@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 47934/HRY

पंजाब नैशनल बैंक
...भरोसे का प्रतीक !

**punjab national bank**
...the name you can BANK upon !

Circle Office: Muzaffarnagar #Plot No. 01, Shakuntlam
Awass Vikas Colony Circular Road, Muzaffarnagar (U.P.)
E-Mail: COMZNSAM@PNB.BANK.IN

POSSESSION NOTICE

The undersigned being the Authorised Officer of the Punjab National Bank under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets & Enforcement of Security interest Act. 2002. and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13 (2) read with the Security d Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, issued demand notice/s on the dates mentioned against each account calling upon their respective borrower's to repay the amount as mentioned against each account within 60 days from the date of notice(s)/date of receipt of the said notice(s). The borrower's having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrower/s and the public in general that the under signed has taken possession of the properties described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him/her under Section13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said Rules on the dates mentioned against each account. The borrower's in particular and the public in general is here by cautioned not to deal with the property/ies and any dealing with the property/ies will be subject to the charge of Punjab National Bank for the amounts and interest thereon. The Borrower and Guarantor's attention is invited to provisions of sub section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

S. No.	Name of Branch	Name of the Borrower/ Guarantor of the mortgaged property	Description of the mortgaged property	Demand Notice Date	Possession Notice Date	Amount outstanding as on the date of demand notice
1.	BO: Kairana (302300)	1. Sh. Alishan s/o Faiyaja (Borrower) 2. Sh. Irshad Ahmad s/o Abdul Hasan (Guarantor)	One residential house facing south in the name of Alishan s/o Faiyaja, measuring 167.29 sqr mtrs situated at Moh. Al Kalan,Town- Kairana Paragana and Tehsil Kairana, District Shamli, registered in the office of S.R.Kairana in Bahi I Volume No. 4635 Page no. 185/212 at serial no. 1687 on 15.03.2017. The property is bounded as below: East: Deewar Neeji Badahu Rama Palace, West: Deewar Neeji Badahu House of Ved Prakash, North: Deewar Neeji Badahu House of Noora, South: Rasta Gali 15 ft wide	22.04.2026	01-08-2026 Symbolic	Rs. 15,24,890.62 as on 31.03.2026 with further interest w.e.f. 01.04.2026 together with incidental expenses, cost, charges, etc.
2.	BO: Kairna (302300)	1. Mr. Saleem S/o Mr. Alamudeen (Borrower) 2. Mr. Ikbal S/o Mr. Alamudeen (Co-Borrower) 3. Mr. Umaradaraj S/o Mr. Haneeef (Guarantor)	Residential Plot (Now House), In the name of Mr. Ikbal (1/2 part) And Mr. Saleem (1/2 Part), measuring 84 Sq Mtr, situated at Mohalla Ikrampura Kairana Pargana and Tehsil Kairana Distt Shamli Registered with sale deed no.4945 dated 28.04.2014. The Property is bounded as below: East: House of Ahsan, West: House of Laik, North: Rasta 10 ft Wide, South: House of Suleiman	20.03.2026	01-08-2026 Symbolic	Rs. 19,02,453.86 as on 28.02.2026 with further interest w.e.f. 28.02.2026 and incidental expenses, costs, charges, etc
3.	BO : South Bhopa Road (372000)	1. Mr. Sanoj Kumar(Borrower) 2. Mr. Sanoj Kumar(Borrower)	Residential Plot(Now House) in the name of Mr. Sanoj Kumar, measeuring 88.17 Sq Mtrs situated at part of khasra no. 1268 of village Sarwat (Bahar Hadood), Pargana, Tehsil and District Muzaffarnagar registered with sale deed no. 3651 dated 18.04.2015 at sub Registrar First Muzaffarnagar. Property is bounded as: East: Road 25 Feet Wide, West: Plot of Smt. Chandrakala, North: House of Smt Somi Devi, South: House of Mukesh & Plot of Amit	05.05.2026	05-08-2026 Symbolic	Rs. 19,93,594.71 as on 30.04.2026 with further interest w.e.f. 31.03.2026 together with incidental expenses, cost, charges, etc.
4.	BO : Shahpur (644600)	1. Mr. Sharvan Kumar Garg S/o Mr. Gordan Das (Borrower) 2. Mr. Rajeev Kumar Garg S/o Mr. Gordan Das (Guarantor)	Residential house in the name of Mr. Sharvan Kumar Garg S/o Mr. Gordan Das situated at Mohalla Manglapuri Mandi Kasba Shahpur Pargana Shikarpur, Tehsil Budhana and District Muzaffarnagar measuring total area 56.73 sq. mtrs. registered as per sale deed no. 2825 dated 10.07.1992 along with order and decree dated 09/05/2015 of civil court & plaint of O.S. No. 91 of 2015. The property is bounded as below – East- House of Smt. Bala Devi & Kalu , West- House of Mr. Rajeev Kumar, North- Aara Machine of Jai Bhagwan, South- Partly Aashirvad Hospital and partly rasta	14.05.2026	04-08-2026 Symbolic	Rs. 3,57,463.52 as on 14.05.2026 with further interest w.e.f 01.05.2026 together with incidental expenses, cost, charges, etc.

Place : Muzaffarnagar / Shamli

Authorised Officer, (Punjab National Bank)

Office of the Superintending Engineer
Bulandshahr Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr
No- 7818 /96M(iv)-BSR Circle-2026-27
Short E-Procurement Inviting Tenders
Dated- 01.08.2026

On behalf of Governor of Uttar Pradesh, Superintending EngineerBulandshahr Circle, U.P.P.W.D., Bulandshahr invites following percentage rate bid online through <http://etender.up.nic.in> from the eligible and approved Contractors registered with P.W.D. class as per column no. 10 below Road work Category as applied from Date 11.08.2026 to 17.08.2026 upto 12:00 Noon as per the prescribed T-2 of Govt. of U.P. The technical bids will be opened online on dated 17.08.2026 at 12:30P.M. If the office happens to be closed on the date of opening of the bids as specified, the bids will be opened online on the next working day, at the same time any validity of bid will be considered from the original date. The date and time of opening of the financial bid shall be notified on the website.

Sl. No	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs.in Lakhs)	Bid Security (Rs.in Lakhs)	Time of Completion work including rainy season	Tender document fee including GST (In Rs.)	Address of Executive Engineer executing the work	Address of Superintending Engineer	Address of Chief Engineer	Category
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
1	जलपट्टी निर्माण कार्य में शामिल वर्ष 2024-25 में बजटित कार्य के अन्तर्गत काला सात पर खुल्ला नदी में अग्री वाह से क्षतिग्रस्त कार्य को विशेष महत्त्व का कार्य।	75.50	5.78	03 Months	Tender Cost Rs. 300/-20004.18 % G.S.T.Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	Executive Engineer Provincial Division, P.W.D., Gautambudh nagar	Superintending Engineer Bulandshahr Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr	Chief Engineer Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A.B

- Time allowed for completion of Whole work is mention in col. No. 5 with including rainy season.
- The Tender Document fee must be deposited through Internet Banking only.
- All registered contractors have to upload Turnover certified by C.A. of last 5 years and details of maximum cost of work satisfactorily completed in last 5 years on Chanakya Software before submission of tender.
- Details of e-tender uploaded on <http://etender.up.nic.in> shall also be uploaded on UP PWD Chanakya software, before last date & time of submission of bid.
- Terms & other conditions related to bid are available on <http://etender.up.nic.in>
- During execution of work contractor should ensure the all safety Measures for COVID-19 issued by the Uttar Pradesh government.
- In PWD technical evaluation of tenders is to be done by Prahari Software URL for Prahari is <http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/Prahari/>.
- According to Government Order No. 86/2026/649/2026/23-7099/106/2025 Lo. Ni. Anu-7 dated 23.05.2026 additional performance security will have to be deposited.

(Kanchan Singh)
Executive Engineer
P.D., PWD,
Gautambudhnagar

UPID-254461 Dt. 05/08/2026
www.upidaddv.gov.in

(Manceesh Verma)
Superintending Engineer,
Bulandshahr Circle, PWD.
Bulandshahr

The Agricultural Heartland

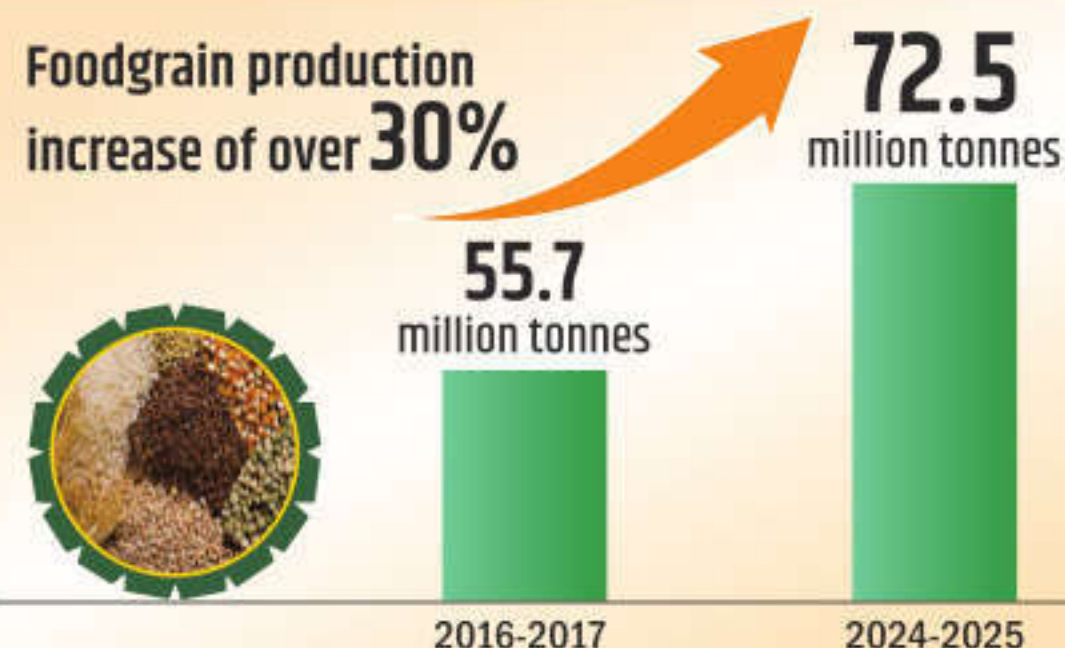
Uttar Pradesh Leads India in Food Grains and Milk Production



Led by the transformative vision of Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, Uttar Pradesh has sparked a green revolution of its own, writing a remarkable new chapter of agricultural excellence. Through farmer centric reforms, expansion of irrigation, scientific farming, record procurement, timely payments and promotion of value-added industries, the state has strengthened both agricultural productivity and rural prosperity. Today, Uttar Pradesh leads India across multiple agricultural sectors, from foodgrains and wheat to sugarcane, milk and ethanol making it the backbone of India's food security and biofuel economy.

UP No. 1 in Foodgrain Production

- ❖ Uttar Pradesh remains India's largest producer of foodgrains, contributing nearly 20% of the country's total foodgrain output.
- ❖ Foodgrain production has increased from 55.7 million tonnes (2016-17) to around 72.5 million tonnes (2024-25), an increase of over 30%.



- ❖ Record production has been driven by improved irrigation, modern farming practices, better seed varieties and farmer welfare initiatives.
- ❖ The state's agricultural growth continues to strengthen India's food security.

India's Largest Wheat Producer

- ❖ Wheat production reached 414.39 lakh metric tonnes in 2024-25, making Uttar Pradesh the largest wheat-producing state in India.
- ❖ The state contributes 35.3% of the country's total wheat production, reaffirming its vital role in ensuring India's food security.
- ❖ Wheat productivity increased by 42.8%, compared to an average growth of 8.7% during 2001-02 to 2016-17.

Leading India in Rice Production

- ❖ Rice production reached 219.20 lakh metric tonnes in 2024-25, making Uttar Pradesh the second-largest rice-producing state in the country.
- ❖ Rice productivity registered an impressive 47.7% growth from 2017 to 2025, against 14.8% in the previous period.
- ❖ The remarkable rise in productivity reflects the success of the state's progressive agricultural policies, improved irrigation, adoption of advanced technologies, and sustained support to farmers.



Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath during Kisan Samvad Event

- ❖ Uttar Pradesh continues to be the largest wheat-producing state in India
- ❖ Uttar Pradesh contributes 14.7% of India's total rice production
- ❖ Uttar Pradesh has retained its position as India's largest milk producing state
- ❖ Uttar Pradesh is the largest sugarcane producing state in the country

Leading in Industrial & Horticultural Crops

- ❖ 28%+ contribution of horticultural crops to agricultural sector growth.
- ❖ Ranked No. 1 in India in the production of sugarcane & sugar, foodgrains, mangoes, milk, potatoes, peas, mentha, and honey.
- ❖ Horticulture area expanded from 21.41 lakh hectares to 25.66 lakh hectares; horticulture production increased from 3.87 crore MT to 6.03 crore MT.
- ❖ 20 new Krishi Vigyan Kendras (KVKs) established; 89 KVKs now operational across the state.
- ❖ 2 Potato Centres of Excellence (CoE) established in Hapur & Kushinagar, Fruit CoE established in Kaushambi, Vegetable CoE established in Chandauli, Fruit & Vegetable CoE (Saharanpur)
- ❖ Tissue Culture Lab established at Acharya Narendra Deva University of Agriculture & Technology, Ayodhya (NAAC A++)
- ❖ Mahatma Buddha University of Agriculture & Technology, Kushinagar is under establishment.

No. 1 in Sugarcane Production

- ❖ India's No. 1 Sugarcane Producing & Highest Sugarcane Price-Paying State
- ❖ More than ₹3.23 Lakh Crore paid to sugarcane farmers since 2017 - Highest Ever
- ❖ ₹31,682 Crore paid in Crushing Season 2025-26; 91.64% farmers already paid
- ❖ A record 9,220 lakh tonnes of sugarcane were crushed in nine years.
- ❖ Sugarcane productivity increased from 72.38 to 83.25 tonnes/hectare in the last 9 years.
- ❖ Farmer income increased by ₹40,720 per hectare.
- ❖ Record sugar production of 968.58 lakh tonnes.
- ❖ 52.54 lakh hectares under intercropping, generating 25% additional income.
- ❖ 78,697 hectares brought under drip irrigation for water conservation.
- ❖ e-Ganna App and caneup.in provide digital survey, cane slips and payment services.



Leading India's Ethanol Revolution

- ❖ Uttar Pradesh now contributes around 55% of India's total ethanol production, making it the country's leading ethanol-producing state.
- ❖ Expansion of sugarcane- and grain-based distilleries has diversified farmers' income while supporting clean energy production.
- ❖ Ethanol production has reduced dependence on imported crude oil and accelerated India's energy security.
- ❖ The ethanol ecosystem has transformed the state's sugar industry into a major pillar of the biofuel economy.



UP Largest Milk Producer in the country

- ❖ Milk production has increased from 277 lakh tonnes in 2016-17 to nearly 388.15 lakh tonnes in 2024-25, registering an increase of about 40%.
- ❖ The state now contributes nearly 16.2% of India's total milk production.



- ❖ Initiatives such as the ₹1,000-crore Nand Baba Dugdh Mission, dairy infrastructure expansion and women-led milk producer companies have significantly strengthened the dairy economy and rural livelihoods.



Vikas ki Gati Apaar-Double Engine Sarkar

epaper.indianexpress.com

New Delhi



The Indian EXPRESS
~ FOUNDED BY ~
RAMNATH GOENKA
◆ IN 1932 ◆
BECAUSE THE TRUTH
INVOLVES US ALL

India-Bangladesh ties should be Hasina-proof

WEDNESDAY'S PRESS conference, during which exiled former Bangladesh Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina said she cannot "stay away" while her "beloved countrymen are suffering", comes less than six months after the Bangladesh Nationalist Party-led government took office. Even though the Awami League was barred from contesting, PM Tarique Rahman's administration is seen to have restored a measure of legitimacy to the political system. Hasina, who was sentenced to death by Bangladesh's International Crimes Tribunal, remains a deeply unpopular figure in her country for several reasons, including her government's heavy-handed response to the 2024 student protests. Against this backdrop, comes her announcement of a political comeback while being in exile in India. Her timing is fraught, a mob hurled petrol bombs at the residence of former Bangladesh cricket captain and party member Shakib Al Hasan after he joined Hasina virtually. It also comes when New Delhi is working to rebuild ties with Dhaka after one-and-a-half years of strained relations with the Muhammad Yunus-led interim government.

India was right to offer Hasina refuge, especially given the concerns over the blatant unfairness of the legal proceedings against her in Bangladesh. But while a sanctuary offers her a home away from home, turning it into a political platform is problematic. The personal struggle of the former PM — who once anchored the close relationship between neighbours bound together by geography, security, culture — is filled with challenges. Yet, she must surely know that her political aspirations cannot bruise New Delhi's relationship with the democratically elected Rahman government. Rahman's election, followed by high-level exchanges between the two governments, has opened the door to a pragmatic reset. This is even as difficult issues — from illegal border crossings to the future of the Ganga Water Treaty — remain unresolved. Dhaka's sharp reaction to Wednesday's event, in spite of New Delhi making it clear that it was not involved, is thin-skinned and hardly helps the two countries.

Indian investment, technical cooperation and infrastructure financing have contributed to Bangladesh's growth story. India has stakes in Bangladesh's power and connectivity sectors. New Delhi is also wary of Dhaka's possible drift into Beijing's orbit. The two countries share a 4,000-kilometre border, making cooperation indispensable to tackling trafficking, illegal infiltration and cross-border extremism, particularly given the sensitivity of India's northeast region. Both governments need to insulate bilateral ties from short-term compulsions. While Hasina remains a welcome and protected guest, the bilateral relationship is too important to be held hostage by any one individual or interest.

Behind Tejpal verdict, survivor's long journey

EVER SINCE the allegations of sexual assault against *Te-helka* editor Tarun Tejpal by a woman colleague became public in November 2013, the case became consequential for what it said about the relationship between power and accountability. The allegations came barely a year after the horrific December 2012 Delhi gang rape had ignited a nationwide reckoning over women's safety and gender justice. The Bombay High Court judgment convicting Tejpal and sentencing him to 10 years of imprisonment, is significant, therefore, for what it says about the slow, difficult fight for justice and accountability.

In 2021, seven years after the Justice JS Verma committee report acknowledged the layered realities of sexual violence and called for a more dignity-centric approach, and a year after Hollywood producer Harvey Weinstein's conviction in New York on charges of rape and sexual assault came as a turning point in the global MeToo movement, a sessions court in Goa had acquitted Tejpal. In the 527-page judgment, a considerable portion was devoted to the conduct of the survivor — that she "did not look disturbed, reserved, terrified or traumatised in any way even though this was immediately after she claims to have been sexually assaulted", that she was smiling in photographs, that she did not fit into the quintessential mould of the "victim". It showed yet again, that the demand for accountability can be a sharp scimitar that turns on the aggrieved, diminishing and disbelieving, asking them if they misread intentions, if a consensual relationship had soured into bitterness, if the "no" had, in fact, meant "yes". It showed that this is a battle only the most resilient can take on.

In the near-decade since MeToo snowballed into a global movement and survivors of sexual abuse at the workplace came forward to indict their violators — powerful men with money, institutional backing and ease of influence — the arc of gender justice in the country remains erratic. The expansiveness of the Criminal Law (Amendment) Act, 2013, has often been overtaken by narrow formalisms that reforms were meant to dismantle. Tejpal has said he will knock on the door of the Supreme Court. For now, The High Court's verdict is a moment to reflect on the distance covered, and yet to be crossed, in an arduous journey.

Fraggle, the dolphin, is grieving

MAN HAD always assumed that he was more intelligent than dolphins", wrote Douglas Adams in *The Hitchhiker's Guide to the Galaxy*, "because he had achieved so much — the wheel, New York, wars and so on — while all the dolphins had ever done was muck about in the water having a good time... dolphins had always believed that they were far more intelligent than man — for precisely the same reasons." There is indeed quite a bit of culture, in the broadest sense of all human endeavour, that moves away from nature, that separates the homo sapien from other feeling, thinking mammals. But there is also enough of the universal "human" condition, beyond the over-rated quality of intelligence, that bridges the gap between species.

A video posted by Geographe Marine Research, a whale conservation organisation, went viral this week. In it, a dolphin, named Fraggie, is seen carrying the body of her deceased calf. It is the fourth child she has lost. She is surrounded by others from her pod. Dolphins, along with cetaceans like whales, and land mammals including elephants and primates, are known to form social bonds and grieve, much like humans.

There has been an outpouring of sympathy for Fraggie. Of course, the fleeting sense of solidarity from a social media crowd is of little value to the grieving mother. In fact, emotion and empathy barely move the needle on how people treat each other — as a cursory glance at the wars and politics will show. Thankfully, Fraggie isn't reliant on the homo sapien. Her pod is with her.

Tamil Nadu to Jantar Mantar to Bankipur, join the political dots

POLITICS CAN sometimes change in a week much more than it does over many months. After the BJP's disappointing 2024 Lok Sabha results were followed by the party's big wins in several state assembly elections, it looked like Indian politics was heading toward one-party dominance. But between July 20 and August 3, the focus shifted from the Opposition's weakness to the BJP's vulnerabilities.

On July 30, the Lok Sabha passed the Prevention of Insults to National Honour (Amendment) Bill granting Vande Mataram the same statutory protection the national anthem has enjoyed since 1971. A symbolic victory for the Hindutva movement arrived in a week that belonged, completely, to India's youth. Five days earlier, Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan had stepped down after protests led by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) at Jantar Mantar in Delhi. This kind of political reversal is rare in Narendra Modi's third term, and it was led by people, many of whom were too young to have voted in 2014.

The political aftershocks did not stop in Delhi. Days later, the BJP lost Bankipur — one of its safest urban constituencies in Bihar which has been represented by the BJP's national president or his family members for nearly three decades. Six months after Prashant Kishor's Jan Suraj was dismissed as an electoral experiment, it captured precisely the kind of affluent, upper-caste, urban seat that should have remained comfortably with the BJP. By-elections are imperfect predictors of broader political trends. Yet, given the wider political context, dismissing the significance of

the Bankipur result altogether would risk overlooking an important signal.

After the BJP's big win in West Bengal, the Trinamool Congress came apart. Seven Rajya Sabha MPs from the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) had joined the BJP a few weeks earlier. The party also got its own chief minister in Bihar for the first time in April, and there was another split in the Shiv Sena (UBT) in June 2026.

How do we understand the sudden change of the last two weeks? Does the rise of CJP show that there is now an opening in India's political scene?

Youth-led movements have recently changed politics in South Asian countries — Bangladesh, Sri Lanka, and Nepal. While a similar regime change is unlikely in India, it would be a mistake to ignore the feelings of a digitally connected generation. This generation is growing impatient with governments that seem unable to provide opportunities. The 2026 Tamil Nadu election may have been the first sign of this shift.

Joseph Vijay's Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) won in a way that traditional ways of understanding Indian elections can't fully explain. His party swept much of urban Tamil Nadu, especially Greater Chennai, even though it lacked the usual organisation, support of caste networks, or ideological orientation that often lead to electoral victories. Post-election surveys showed that younger voters were much more likely to support TVK than older people. Most said their main reason was simple: Change. It seems the DMK and AIADMK were still using ideas meant for a more rural Tamil Nadu.



PRADEEP CHHIBBER



RAHUL VERMA

Opposition leadership must produce a vision of the future that is far more than a ledger of past injuries or a list of promises to particular groups

On the face of it, a student protest in Delhi and a film star winning an election in Tamil Nadu might seem unrelated. But both show the same trend: A generation looking for leaders who can bring change. While India's youth population is starting to stabilise, the mix of being young, urban, with college degrees and digitally connected is something new. Such voters organise through social media, vote almost as much as older generations, and judge governments based on their hopes for the future rather than on old political loyalties.

What links Jantar Mantar and Chennai is that India's cities are growing faster than its politics can keep up with. Half the population is under 30. Twice in one summer, established parties were defeated when outfits and movements spoke to young people. There is a tough lesson for all political parties here. The Opposition must understand that echoing the old grammar of caste and class grievances would mean that the beneficiary of such discontent could be a completely new political entrepreneur. The current Opposition might pick up a few more seats and, at best, will get a chance to cobble together a weak coalition. Opposition leadership must produce a vision of the future that is far more than a ledger of past injuries or a list of promises to particular groups.

For the BJP, the challenge is even more profound. Its extraordinary rise after 2014 rested on convincing millions of first-generation aspirational Indians that tomorrow would be better than yesterday. The CJP protests suggest that this promise is no longer believable. The party is increasingly speaking to

those who agree with it, and even some of them may be defecting as the Bankipur results indicate. The Jantar Mantar protestors too came from the constituency which Modi's BJP has drawn heavily upon.

Today the BJP looks more like what it was before becoming the party of aspiring India: A right-wing conservative party speaking for a particular slice of middle-aged Hindu India. As the party starts planning for the 2029 general election, it faces a challenge that all long-ruling parties eventually meet. By then, it will have spent 15 years in power at the Centre. The benefits of being in office slowly turn into the problems of governing. This leaves the party with few options: It must either renew itself or keep shrinking back to its core supporters. As one longtime RSS and BJP affiliate told us, if the party wants to avoid another setback like 2024 — or worse — in 2029, it needs its own Kamaraj Plan, like when senior Congress leaders resigned in 1963 to rebuild their party.

The events of the last two weeks may not be enough to predict what will happen in 2029. But they are important enough to raise a question the BJP cannot ignore. The generation that brought Narendra Modi to power in 2014 is not the same as the one joining the electorate now. The BJP's real challenge is not just to win over young Indians, but to show them it can offer the most believable promises for a better future.

Chhibber is Professor of Political Science and Indo-American Community Chair in India Studies at the University of California, Berkeley, US. Verma is Fellow at Centre for Policy Research (CPR), New Delhi. Views expressed are personal

RBI sees inflation risks — but opts to support growth



RAJANI SINHA

THE RBI Monetary Policy Committee left the policy rate unchanged and retained its neutral stance in the August meeting. The tone of the policy, however, was more dovish than expected. With the risk of food inflation rising and volatile crude oil prices, we expected the central bank's tone to be more cautious.

The RBI highlighted that while CPI inflation is rising, it is mainly because of higher food and fuel prices. CPI inflation has increased steadily to 4.4 per cent in June from 2.7 per cent at the beginning of the year. However, even with high input-cost inflation, core inflation (excluding food and fuel) has remained relatively lower.

In fact, core inflation excluding precious metals, which reflects demand-side inflation, is at a benign 2.4 per cent. The central bank has marginally lowered the average CPI projection for FY27 to 5 per cent, while highlighting that so far supply-side inflationary pressure has not become broad-based. However, volatile global crude oil prices and weak monsoon remain inflationary risks.

On the growth front, the central bank was quite optimistic and raised the GDP growth projection marginally to 6.7 per cent for FY27, in line with our projection. Even in the midst of the uncertain macro-environment marked by the West Asia crisis, US tariff threats, and the likelihood of a deficit monsoon, the Indian economy is showing strong resilience.

High-frequency macro indicators like IIP, ISP (Index of Services Production), core sector, bank credit demand, and export growth have been quite robust. The corporate performance in the first quarter is also looking healthy. Based on the healthy data so far, growth in the first quarter is likely to be strong at around 7 per cent.

However, there will be some moderation in the subsequent quarters as the economy begins to feel the adverse impact of the West Asia crisis. The progress of the monsoon and subsequent impact on the agriculture sector and rural demand is another important factor to watch.

India's external sector has been managing well in the midst of the volatile global environment. After a weak FY26, India's goods exports have picked up by a strong 16 per cent in Q1 FY27.

And it's not just because of high crude oil prices as exports excluding petroleum products have also recorded a strong growth of 13 per cent in this period. Services exports and remittances have also remained healthy.

While the current account deficit is expected to widen in FY27, we expect it to remain comfortable at around 1 per cent of GDP. Financing even a small current account deficit had become a challenge in the last two years because of feeble capital flows. However, the recent measures announced by the central bank are likely to support this. We are already seeing strong inflows through FCNR deposits. FII inflows into debt and equity have also improved as per recent data.

Overall, the Balance of Payments is likely to move to a large surplus in FY27 from deficits recorded in the previous two years. This should be supportive of the Indian rupee. But we will have to closely watch the policy action of the major central banks globally.

With global inflationary risks rising, in the coming months we could see a rate hike by the US Federal Reserve and further rate hikes by the ECB and the BoJ. This, in turn, could put some pressure on the Indian currency.

Given the uncertain macro-backdrop, the future policy decisions of India's central bank will remain data-dependent. The RBI is likely to keep the policy rate on hold, unless the inflationary risks aggravate. With food inflation likely to peak in Q3 FY27, the real rate of interest could turn negative temporarily.

However, the central bank may look through it if the inflationary pressure is supply-side and there are no indications of the pricing pressure getting broad-based.

In this fluid global and domestic environment, the central bank may prefer to remain growth-supportive.

The writer is chief economist, CareEdge Ratings

BTS Grammy boycott may be shortsighted



SUANSHU KHURANA

THE STORY of 21st-century pop can be divided into two chapters — before and after BTS. The Korean group has spent the past decade rewriting the rules and tearing to bits the long-held notion that music must belong to a particular language, geography or ethnicity to achieve global success.

So, when the septet decided not to submit their hugely popular new album *Arirang* or any of its songs for the Grammys 2027, six days after the Recording Academy introduced the Best Asian Pop category, it set the internet abuzz. The band does not want to be "divided by region or language". Recording Academy CEO Harvey Mason Junior responded that the category was created "to celebrate the depth, diversity... of pop artistry coming out of Asia" and "never to divide, but to expand who is recognised".

The Recording Academy's move is in line with a broader industry trend. The American Music Awards and Billboard Music Awards, among others, have introduced K-pop categories. It may allow artists from Seoul, Beijing and Luthiana, and others whose music is not in English, to compete for what many see as music's highest honour. It gives musicians like Diljit Dosanjh another avenue to submit a work like *Aura* for Grammy consideration. That is not segregation. It would be if these artists were excluded from the marquee categories. But Asian artists can still compete for Record of the Year, Song of the Year and Album of the Year.

If an Asian Pop category is segregation, the same argument could be made against the Grammys' Latin, African, jazz, gospel or Americana categories. Also, BTS's album *Arirang* is largely in English, so it would not even qualify for Best Asian Pop, where at least 80 per cent of the lyrics must be in an Asian language.

That said, the Recording Academy did not arrive at this moment with a clean slate. It has had enough cultural blind spots. Pop titan Beyoncé remains the most glaring one. Despite being the most awarded artiste in Grammy history, she repeatedly lost Album of the Year even as *Lemonade* and *Renaissance* were widely regarded as seminal. Many Black artists were celebrated in genre categories while the top prize went elsewhere, once to Adele, who herself acknowledged that Beyoncé deserved it.

So, is representation about creating regional categories, or ensuring all artistes compete on a level playing field? BTS, who have often spoken about wanting a Grammy, appear to believe the future lies in the latter. They are being a bit shortsighted. The Recording Academy does seem to be reforming itself. Beyoncé's 2024 win for *Cowboy Carter* and Bad Bunny's win last year for the Spanish-language *DeBí Tirar Más Fotos (I Should Have Taken More Photos)* point towards a new era. Bad Bunny also won Best Música Urbana Album the same year. If Best Asian Pop becomes another route to Record of the Year, it may represent expansion.

It remains to be seen if the new category comes to signify something bigger than identity. One also hopes BTS reverse their decision. Not because they need a Grammy to validate their legacy, but because their presence would be the litmus test for the Recording Academy's efforts at inclusivity.

The writer is deputy associate editor, The Indian Express. suanshu.khurana@expressindia.com

An Asian Pop category may allow artistes from Seoul, Beijing and Luthiana, and others whose music is not in English, to compete for what many see as music's highest honour

40 YEARS AGO

August 7, 1986



52 killed in Bihar train accident

FIFTY-TWO passengers were killed and 35 others injured between Garhwa and Tolra stations in Palamau district, in the Dhanbad division of the Eastern Railway, when the 162 Amritsar-Tata Express rammed into a goods train. Following the collision, the engine and two bogies of the train fell into a deep nullah. Among the dead were seven women and six children.

PM meets leaders in Mexico

THE PRIME Minister, Rajiv Gandhi, had separate meetings with some of the leaders attending the six-nation peace summit on nuclear disarmament and discussed the

broad outlines of the Mexico declaration to be issued by them. Gandhi first called on the host country's President, Miguel de la Madrid and followed it by meetings with the Swedish Prime Minister, Ingvar Carlsson, the Greek Prime Minister, Andreas Papandreu and the Argentine President, Raul Alfonsín.

Explosion in Hansalaya building

THERE WAS a minor panic as the Hansalaya building in Barakhamba Road reverberated after an explosion. The explosion, according to the Additional Commissioner of Police Security, Gautam Kaul, was caused by placing some sticks of dynamite under the staircase leading to the

Bank of America, situated on the first floor of the building. On either side of the staircase are the offices of Saudi Airlines and Kuwait Airways.

Kerala deputy speaker quits

THE KERALA deputy speaker, K M Hamsa Kunju, quit his post and gave up the chairmanship of the Committee of Privileges, heralding a parliamentary crisis. The decision to resign from the deputy speaker's post was his own, he said, but he had vacated the chairmanship of the committee on the advice of his party leader. He felt that it would be unfair to keep the office of the speaker after resigning from the chairmanship of the committee.



DIS/AGREE

THE BEST OF BOTH SIDES

A weekly column, which offers not this-versus-that, but the best of both sides, to inform the debate



ILLUSTRATION: C.R. SASIKUMAR

Hollywood movies are increasingly getting the bigger openings. Is Indian cinema ready for the competition?

It's just a Bollywood problem



RAJESH RAJAMANI

THE PHENOMENAL success of Christopher Nolan's *The Odyssey* and the latest film in the Marvel Cinematic Universe, *Spider-Man: Brand New Day*, across Indian theatres, could easily leave one wondering whether Indian cinema is slowly losing its ability to produce films that capture the public imagination on a similar scale. That concern may be valid, but only if we continue to see Bollywood as representing the entirety of Indian cinema.

In fact, at its emotional core, *The Odyssey* itself unfolds very much like a Tamil masala film. A hero's long journey home, emotional dilemmas and larger-than-life adventures are themes Tamil star vehicles have comfortably embraced for decades. The language and scale may be different, but the emotional grammar is surprisingly familiar. When Odysseus finally returns home, he might as well be Rajinikanth walking into *Kabali* (2016) to declare, "Tell them I'm back."

Hindi cinema's biggest successes this year have largely stayed within familiar comfort zones. Whether it is yet another border-conflict spectacle in *Dhurandhar: The Revenge* and *Border 2*, or the dependable cocktail of horror and comedy in *Bhooth Bangla* and *Dhamaal 4*, Bollywood seems increasingly reluctant to venture beyond formulas that have already been tested, approved and monetised.

Of course, popular cinema has always relied on familiar genres and crowd-pleasing tropes. The problem begins when an industry becomes so risk-averse that it edges towards irrelevance. The films may become bigger, louder and technically slicker, but the emotional and thematic territory they explore continues to shrink.

But if we look beyond the Hindi film industry, regional cinema continues to be wonderfully alive. Tamil cinema's biggest hit this year, *Karuppu*, uses the folklore surrounding the village deity Karuppusami to examine the apathy of the Indian judicial system. It could easily have settled for being a conventional courtroom drama. Instead, it pits the idea of justice against God himself, making the film even more compelling as a mainstream entertainer.

Malayalam cinema, meanwhile, remains fascinated by ordinary lives. *Vaazha II: Biopic of a Billion Bros* transforms a familiar coming-of-age story into an emotionally resonant exploration of modern

youth, friendship and the often uncomfortable transition into adulthood.

Telugu cinema, often unfairly reduced to larger-than-life commercial entertainers, also offers pleasant surprises. *Peddi* packages a reflection on systemic oppression within an unapologetically populist sports drama. *Maa Inti Bangaaram*, on the other hand, follows a woman struggling to reconcile a violent past with the ordinary life she desperately wants to protect. Both films work as mainstream entertainers while refusing to become emotionally simplistic.

None of these films are masterpieces. Neither are they flawless. But they all make an earnest effort to explore newer themes and discover fresh ways of telling stories. That willingness to take creative risks is perhaps their greatest strength.

Regional cinema today seems far more comfortable asking uncomfortable questions. It draws more freely from local folklore, literature, politics and lived experience. It trusts audiences to embrace stories deeply rooted in specific cultures without endlessly chasing a mythical "pan-Indian" template. Ironically, it is this very specificity that often makes these films feel more universal.

Bollywood, meanwhile, seems trapped in an endless pursuit of the next safe blockbuster. Somewhere along the way, "pan-Indian" has become shorthand for sanding away every regional texture until a film feels as though it could belong anywhere, and therefore nowhere in particular. The result is scale without distinctiveness.

This is not to suggest that Bollywood has stopped making good films altogether. Every industry produces both mediocre films and occasional gems. Bollywood still possesses unmatched resources, visual polish and marketing muscle.

But cinema has never been remembered for technical excellence alone. Audiences return to films because they recognise themselves in them, because they are surprised by them, or because they leave the theatre carrying an idea that wasn't there two hours earlier. That willingness to surprise feels far more abundant outside Mumbai today.

Perhaps, this is a healthy development for Indian cinema. For decades, the creative conversation largely flowed in one direction, from Bollywood to everyone else. Increasingly, it is regional cinema that is setting the agenda, discovering fresh storytelling voices and proving that commercial success and creative ambition need not be mutually exclusive.

The question isn't whether Indian cinema can still dream big. It is obvious that it can. The real strength of Indian cinema lies in the many different languages that it dreams in.

The writer is a Chennai-based filmmaker

Blame the ecosystem, not the industry



SHUBHRA GUPTA

THE LATEST shenanigans of a teenage superhero morphing into a spider in order to save the good guys from hulking monsters is currently running to packed theatres. Not just around the world, but also in India, where *Spider-Man: Brand New Day* has chalked up the biggest Hollywood opening weekend, while speaking in tongues: The classic line "With great power comes great responsibility" can be heard not just in the original English, but in Hindi, Tamil, Telugu, Kannada and Malayalam.

And it's not just Tom Holland swinging from dizzy heights in NYC which has got Indian audiences back to the big screen. Several Hollywood films have done such good business at the box office that many Indian films are having to postpone their releases for a safer slot, and we're only halfway through 2026.

Christopher Nolan's *The Odyssey*, a paean to Homer's epic, and to the director's ability to parse ancient mythology for our cynical age, is still in theatres. Amazon MGM Studios' sci-fi adventure *Project Hail Mary*, involving the very wholesome Ryan Gosling and his cutesy relationship with a friendly alien, racked up impressive numbers. Curry Barker's *Obsession*, a non-starry horror film front-loaded with the aesthetics of a low-budget home movie and terrific performances became a surprise hit. And the very adult-themed chamber drama *The Invite*, toplined by Seth Rogen in an award-winning turn, drew major crowds.

What's going on? Hollywood has traditionally done well in urban Indian pockets, with its familiar franchise flicks and pacy actioners grabbing eyeballs. But it's never been such a clear and present disrupter if you go by the enthusiastic reception for scrappy horror films, or small-canvas talky dramas, not just the expected big-budget creature features and superhero sagas.

Is Bollywood's spidey-sense tingling? Has it forgotten how to tell engaging stories? Aren't the filmmakers in Mumbai, home to the biggest industry in the world, wondering where their loyal audience has gone? *Dhurandhar 2* tops the list of successes this year, no surprises there, because of the unprecedented buzz it came riding on, and the doubling down on its content and intent. Then

came, in no particular order, *Border 2*, *Bhoot Bangla*, *Dhamaal 4*, *Welcome To The Jungle*: The first was a solid film, layered with a strong anti-war sentiment; all the others are loud comedies coasting on low-hanging humour.

What's becoming abundantly clear is that only two kinds of films are being made, and supported, on scale in Bollywood these days: Propaganda and slapstick, both competing for the lowest common denominator. But this is not just me having a eureka moment. For the last decade, with the inexorable rise of polarising, divisive cinema, every other kind of filmmaking has been having a difficult time of it. Even if it does get made, the chances of it surviving, forget thriving, have become narrower and narrower.

So does this signal the death of creativity in Bollywood? Not in the least. The industry is filled with filmmakers who are capable of telling stories with heart and craft, layered with technical polish, but in an ecosystem so blatantly inimical to liberalism and plurality, those voices are going unheard. Not into the void — we're not quite there yet — but the risk is imminent.

Two recent films which gave us the chance to question and interrogate the past, have broken through the shield. Imtiaz Ali's *Main Vaapas Aaunga*, which deals with the twin-longing for a lost land and love, may not be all the way perfect, but it brings back a sense of springing hope. Naseeruddin Shah's brilliant performance as a man who has never been able to forget, makes us remember. It makes us freer, and I can't think of anything better.

Honey Trehan's *Satluj*, originally named Punjab 95, tells the story of an individual who fought for his people at a time when the state was riven by militancy. The film's sudden appearance on streaming platform Zee5 and its equally sudden disappearance is an abiding mystery, but never more than the reason why the Indian censors kept demanding cuts for over three years. You could argue persuasively, and many have, that the thrust of the story was one-sided, that it didn't touch upon all aspects besetting the troubled state. But that doesn't take away from the fact of it being an important film which speaks to its time, and our time. Agreeing to disagree is the civilised way to go, but stonewalling its producer and director, and leaving them with no recourse, is beyond the pale.

If pushback and intimidation is the response, the result will only be silence and submission. What price creativity?

The writer is film critic, The Indian Express
shubhra.gupta@expressindia.com

Ethanol policy must count in water, sustainability costs



ASHOK KHEMKA

INDIA'S ROLLOUT of E20 petrol is among the world's most ambitious biofuel initiatives. Ethanol blending has increased from about 1.5 per cent in 2013–14 to nearly 20 per cent in 2025, with annual consumption approaching 700 crore litres. The programme has reduced crude oil imports, generated rural incomes and diversified the country's energy basket. These are important achievements. Yet as India transitions from E10 to E20, policy should increasingly be guided by scientific evidence and sound public economics rather than by blending targets alone.

Not all ethanol is equally sustainable. India now produces ethanol from C-heavy and B-heavy molasses, sugarcane juice, maize, damaged food grains and surplus rice. Each pathway has a different environmental footprint. A useful measure is the Energy Return on Energy Invested (EROEI), which compares the usable energy produced with the fossil energy consumed in cultivation, fertiliser manufacture, irrigation, transportation and distillation. Efficient sugarcane ethanol produced in bagasse-fired distilleries typically achieves an EROEI of about 2–4, whereas grain-based ethanol generally ranges between 1.2 and 2 because of higher fossil energy inputs. Ethanol therefore delivers a positive net energy gain, but the magnitude depends critically on feedstock, farming practices and processing technology.

A second consideration is energy density. Petrol contains roughly 32 MJ per litre compared with around 21 MJ per litre for ethanol. So, E20 fuel contains about 6–7 per cent less energy than pure petrol, resulting in a modest reduction in fuel economy under similar driving conditions. However, ethanol has a much higher octane rating, allowing engines specifically calibrated for higher ethanol blends to achieve more efficient combustion and partially offset this disadvantage. The overall outcome depends on engine design rather than fuel properties alone.

Vehicle compatibility is another important issue. Ethanol readily absorbs moisture and can corrode certain metals while degrading older rubber seals and plastic components. Recognising these challenges, the government has mandated that vehicles manufactured from April 2023 onwards be compatible with E20 fuel. Newer engines incorporate improved materials and revised engine calibration, but millions of older two-wheelers, passenger cars and agricultural machines remain outside this category. The transition therefore requires transparent consumer information, technical support and continued availability of lower-blend fuels. Consumers should retain the freedom to choose fuels appropriate for their vehicles, with pricing that transparently reflects their respective costs.

Ethanol is often described as a low-carbon fuel because sugarcane absorbs atmospheric carbon dioxide during growth. However, climate benefits must be as-

sessed on a life-cycle basis, accounting for emissions from cultivation, fertiliser manufacture, irrigation, transport and processing. Efficiently produced sugarcane ethanol can reduce greenhouse-gas emissions by roughly 50–70 per cent relative to petrol, particularly where bagasse supplies process energy. Grain-based ethanol generally delivers lower reductions of around 20–50 per cent. These benefits diminish substantially when production relies on diesel-powered irrigation, fossil-fuel-based distillation or excessive nitrogen fertiliser use. Ethanol is therefore cleaner than petrol under many production systems, but it cannot ipso facto be seen as carbon neutral.

The most critical challenge, however, is water. Sugarcane is a very water-intensive crop. Estimates by the Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices and NITI Aayog suggest that sugarcane typically requires 1,500–2,500 mm of water over its growing season. Water-footprint studies estimate that producing one litre of sugarcane ethanol may embody approximately 2,000–3,500 litres of water, depending on local climatic conditions and irrigation practices. This is especially significant because many of India's largest sugarcane-producing regions already face severe groundwater stress. Without careful resource accounting, expanding ethanol production risks replacing dependence on imported crude oil with growing dependence on increasingly scarce freshwater resources.

Heavily subsidised electricity currently encourages excessive groundwater extraction, while subsidised urea promotes overuse of nitrogen fertilisers. These subsidies

reduce the apparent cost of sugarcane cultivation without reflecting its environmental costs. The consequence is not merely inefficient resource use but also the possibility that public subsidies inadvertently encourage ethanol production in regions where its true social cost is high. A more efficient approach would be to support farmers directly through income transfers while allowing electricity, irrigation water and fertiliser prices to better reflect

their economic and environmental costs. Such reforms would encourage more judicious use of scarce resources, improve groundwater sustainability and naturally shift ethanol production towards regions and feedstocks with the highest net energy gains and the lowest life-cycle emissions. At the same time, investment in second-generation ethanol derived from agricultural residues and other non-food biomass should be accelerated to reduce pressure on land and water.

India's ethanol programme represents an important step towards greater energy security, but its long-term success will depend on aligning environmental objectives with sound economics. Blending targets can provide direction, but they should not become ends in themselves. A resilient bio-fuel strategy must be guided by transparent life-cycle carbon accounting, rigorous assessment of water use, technology-neutral incentives and market signals that reflect the true value of natural resources. Only then can ethanol become not merely a substitute for imported oil, but a genuinely sustainable component of India's energy transition.

The writer retired as a senior IAS officer. Views are personal



LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Growth is priority

THE RBI's decision to keep the policy rate unchanged at 5.25 per cent while adopting a more accommodative tone reflects a balanced and pragmatic approach ('RBI must keep steady hand amid uncertainty', *IE*, August 6). Although inflation is expected to remain above the 4 per cent target for several months, the current rise is largely driven by supply-side factors such as food and fuel prices rather than broad-based demand pressures. Prioritising growth without compromising long-term price stability appears justified.

Sanjay Chopra, Mohali

Diversify trade

IN AN increasingly fragmented world, diversification should complement, rather than replace, economic ties, especially with key partners ('Are India-US trade talks an exercise in futility?', *IE*, August 6). Expanding commercial engagement with the EU, Africa, the Gulf, Southeast Asia and Latin America would strengthen India's economic resilience by providing broader market

access and greater integration into global value chains. However, this should not be interpreted as disengagement from the US, which remains one of India's largest trading partners.

Vaibhav Goyal, Chandigarh

Justice denied

CELEBRATIONS FOLLOWING Brij Bhushan's acquittal come as little surprise in a country where even rape convicts are welcomed with garlands ('In a struggle for justice, a story of impunity', *IE*, August 6). It shows that impunity is hardly a concern, while being on the "right" side remains a privilege enjoyed by the powerful. An SIT ordered by the UP government in the 2017 Unnao gang rape case reported that medical and police officers had worked hand-in-glove with the accused to shield them. This reflects a conflict within the criminal justice system. When it takes sustained protests by well-known wrestlers merely to register a complaint, expecting resilience from the victims is an injustice in itself.

Madhusree Guha, Kolkata



NIDHI SINGH

EARLIER THIS month, India's largest IT services firm, TCS, reported its strongest quarterly hiring in nearly four years, adding over 9,000 employees and onboarding 14,000 fresh graduates. Twelve months earlier, the same company had announced 12,000 job cuts. This reduction of head count was promptly taken as a verdict on artificial intelligence and jobs. The rebound shows the fears may have been overblown. This push-and-pull narrative is emblematic of the way we talk about AI's impact on the future of work.

The real problem here is that none of these claims can currently be verified.

Consider the layoffs that dominated last year's headlines. When India's largest IT firm let go of roughly 12,000 employees, its chief

Is AI taking jobs? Answer isn't that simple

executive was emphatic that the decision was about skill mismatches and deployment feasibility, not AI-driven productivity gains. Executives across the sector have offered similar explanations, and they may well be right. The IT industry hired aggressively through the pandemic, and some of what looks like AI displacement is a delayed correction of that excess.

But here is the uncomfortable truth: It is impossible to tell. A company that adopts AI tools, restructures around them, and then removes roles it no longer needs will rarely describe this as AI displacement, and it has every incentive not to.

AI's real effect on Indian employment may arrive not through layoffs but through jobs that are simply never created. The industry's biggest recruiters have cut their fresher intake targets. The share of employees under 30 at Infosys has fallen to its lowest level in 15 years. Entry-level tech openings in mid-2026 were down more than

40 per cent from a year earlier, and the pattern is not confined to IT services: Fresher hiring has fallen across corporate India, with recruiters citing AI-driven redeployment as one of the main reasons. A hiring freeze produces no pink slips, no headlines, and no data point in any Indian labour survey. The graduate who never gets an offer is invisible.

The optimists have their own evidence, and some of it is encouraging. AI is generating streams of work that did not exist a decade ago. Bengaluru-based Karya pays rural workers, a majority of them women, well above prevailing wages to build voice and text datasets in Indian languages. India's data annotation industry employs tens of thousands. Global capability centres now employ over two million professionals.

But the arithmetic of "jobs lost versus jobs created" may not be the correct equation to be used here. The truth is that jobs come in different tiers; a mid-career software engineer in Pune earning Rs 20 lakh a year and a

data annotation worker earning a few thousand rupees a month both count as one job in any tally. Economically, they are not the same thing, and a labour market that swaps the first for the second has not broken even.

The redesign of the Periodic Labour Force Survey in 2025, which now produces monthly indicators, is an opportunity. But the PLFS measures whether people are working, not what is happening inside their work. India needs occupation-level tracking of AI exposure built into its official statistics, supplemented by the data the private sector already generates: Job postings, hiring platforms, and industry payrolls.

India is preparing to spend heavily on re-skilling its workforce for the AI economy. It should first invest a fraction of that in finding out what, precisely, it is reskilling them from, and what it is reskilling them for.

The writer is an Associate Fellow at Carnegie India

RAJASTHAN RAJYA VIDYUT UTPADAN NIGAM LTD.
 O/o CE (Fuel), 6th Floor, LIC Jeevandeep Building, Lakshmi, Jaipur
E-TENDER NOTICE: 07/RVU2627GLRC00909)
 E-Tenders are invited for SUPPLY OF 0.30 MTL LIMESTONE ON F.O.R. BASIS FOR FLUE GAS DESULPHURISATION (FGD) SYSTEM INSTALLED AT KSTPS, KOTA. Tender details are available on <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> (for e-tender), www.energy.rajjasthan.gov.in/rvnl & www.spppr.rajjasthan.gov.in.
 Raj.Samwad/C/26/8803 RVUN/PR-4439 Superintending Engineer (Fuel-H)

राजस्थान स्वच्छ मिशन, राजस्थान
 स्वच्छ एवं परिवार कल्याण विभाग, स्वच्छ भवन, लिटल मार्ग,
 राजस्थान, जयपुर फोन नं. 0141-2252736, E-Mail ID: cemhraj@gmail.com
 E-NIT No-19/2026-27 on EPC MODE Date:- 30.07.26
 राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से भवन निर्माण कार्य हेतु उद्देश्य श्रेणी में राज्यस्था में पंजीकृत सर्वेक्षकों एवं राज्य सरकार / केन्द्र सरकार के अधिकृत राजस्व/केन्द्रीय लोक निर्माण विभाग/राज्य एमएनए राज्य सरकार के अधिकृत राजस्व/केन्द्रीय लोक निर्माण विभाग के अधिकृत राजस्व के अंतर्गत, जो कि राजस्थान सरकार के ए.ए. श्रेणी के सर्वेक्षकों के सम्बन्ध में, से निर्धारित प्रत्येक भवन निर्माण कार्य के लिए EPC Mode पर ई-प्रोक्यूरमेंट प्रक्रिया से ऑन लाइन निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती हैं।
 कुल कार्यों की संख्या 06
 निविदा की कुल लागत (सि.र. व. लाघत में) 9348.00
 अनिवार्य निविदा अपेक्षाएं डाकूनेल्ले एवं अपलोड करने की तिथि 10 अगस्त 2026 से 31 अगस्त 2026 सांघ 6:00 बजे तक
 अनिवार्य निविदा खोलने की तिथि 01 सितम्बर 2026 सुबह 11:00 बजे
 निविदा से सम्बन्धित विवरण वेब साईट <http://djpr.rajjasthan.gov.in>, <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> या <http://spppr.rajjasthan.gov.in> पर देखा जा सकता है। सम्पूर्ण निविदा प्रक्रिया <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> पर अनिवार्य समायोजित की जायेगी।
 UBN:-
 S.No. UBN Number हस्ता./-
 1 MHS2627WLOB03070 2 MHS2627WLOB03071 मुख्य अभियंता
 3 NRH2627WLOB00675 4 MHS2627WLOB03064 विनिर्देश एवं स्वच्छ
 5 NRH2627WLOB00676 6 MHS2627WLOB03060 राजस्थान, जयपुर
 DIPRC/13672/2026

MUNICIPAL CORPORATION KOTA (RAJ.)
 Add :- C.A.D. Circle, Dusshehra Ground, kota
 No. :NNK/ELECT/2026/1032-1039 Date : 30.07.2026
SHORT Notice -Inviting Bid
 Bid for "Providing & replacement of cables, MS Poles etc. in ward 71 in Municipal Corporation Kota." are invited from interested bidders from 01-08-2026 to 10-08-2026 Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in>, <http://spppr.rajjasthan.gov.in> of the state and www.kotamc.org department website.
 Estimated amount : 121.03 Lac
 NIB CODE :DLB2627A5428
 UBN NO.DLB2627GLOB13237
 Raj.Samwad/C/26/8794 Executive Engineer (Electrical)
 MUNICIPAL CORPORATION, KOTA

UJVN LIMITED
 (An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprise)
 H. O. C. "JALMAH" MAHARASHTRA STATE, CHH. ROAD, DURGAKHUR, SHIVPR, DIST. NAINITAL, UTTARAKHAND-263068
 Tele. - 0135-2763508, 2763508, Fax: 0135-2763507, website: www.ujvn.com
 Tender No.653 Date : 06.08.2026
Tender Notice
 Office of the Executive Engineer (Maintenance), Vyasi Project, Hathiyari, invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:
 NIT No. 12/EE(M)/VP/2026-27
 Name of work :- Hiring of one number Light diesel vehicle (M&M Bolero or Equivalent) along with driver for emergency work of Vyasi HEP for one year, Estimated cost: ₹ 6,15,390.00 (Excluding GST)
 Date of availability of bid document on website: 07.08.2026 From 16:00 AM
 Last date for submission of tender: 29-08-2026 Up to 13:30 PM
 For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "www.ujvn.com"
 Executive Engineer (Maintenance)
 "Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

MUTHOOT FINCORP LTD. | GOLD AUCTION NOTICE
 Regd. Office: Muthoot Centre, TC No 27/3022, Punnen Road, Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala, India - 695001. CIN : U65929KL1997PLC011518, Ph: +91 471 4911400, 2331427.

Notice is hereby given for the information of all concerned that gold ornaments pledged with under mentioned branches of the company, which were overdue for redemption and which have not been redeemed so far in spite of repeated notices will be auctioned on 09.09.2026 from 10 am onwards.

Auction Date: 09.09.2026 - DEHRADUN DISTRICT - DEHRADUN-GANDHI ROAD:
 4086001330, 4086001337, 4086001395, 4086004111, 4086001490, 4086001492, 4086001500, 4086001505, 4086001517, 4086001552, 4086001554, 4086001568, 4086001573, 4086001585, 4086001614, 4086001618, 4086001619, 4086001631, 4086001637, 4086001658, 4086001659, 4086001907, 4086001919, 4086001948, 4086001965, 4086002040, **VIKAS NAGAR - DEHRADUN:** 4575000033, 4575000034, 4575000013, 4575000018, 4575000019, 4575000098, 4575000113, 4575000124, 4575000450, **Auction Date: 09.09.2026 - HARIDWAR DISTRICT - JWALAPUR:**
 HARIDWAR: 2981000181, 2981001580, 2981001582, 2981001610, 2981001615, 2981001618, 2981001731, 2981001843, 2981001884, 2981001888, 2981001906, 2981001915, 2981001967, 2981001976, 2981002007, 2981002011, 2981002034, 2981002048, 2981002051, 2981002053, 2981002055, 2981002056, 2981002057, 2981002058, 2981002059, 2981002060, 2981002061, 2981002062, 2981002063, 2981002064, 2981002065, 2981002066, 2981002067, 2981002068, 2981002069, 2981002070, 2981002071, 2981002072, 2981002073, 2981002074, 2981002075, 2981002076, 2981002077, 2981002078, 2981002079, 2981002080, 2981002081, 2981002082, 2981002083, 2981002084, 2981002085, 2981002086, 2981002087, 2981002088, 2981002089, 2981002090, 2981002091, 2981002092, 2981002093, 2981002094, 2981002095, 2981002096, 2981002097, 2981002098, 2981002099, 2981002100, 2981002101, 2981002102, 2981002103, 2981002104, 2981002105, 2981002106, 2981002107, 2981002108, 2981002109, 2981002110, 2981002111, 2981002112, 2981002113, 2981002114, 2981002115, 2981002116, 2981002117, 2981002118, 2981002119, 2981002120, 2981002121, 2981002122, 2981002123, 2981002124, 2981002125, 2981002126, 2981002127, 2981002128, 2981002129, 2981002130, 2981002131, 2981002132, 2981002133, 2981002134, 2981002135, 2981002136, 2981002137, 2981002138, 2981002139, 2981002140, 2981002141, 2981002142, 2981002143, 2981002144, 2981002145, 2981002146, 2981002147, 2981002148, 2981002149, 2981002150, 2981002151, 2981002152, 2981002153, 2981002154, 2981002155, 2981002156, 2981002157, 2981002158, 2981002159, 2981002160, 2981002161, 2981002162, 2981002163, 2981002164, 2981002165, 2981002166, 2981002167, 2981002168, 2981002169, 2981002170, 2981002171, 2981002172, 2981002173, 2981002174, 2981002175, 2981002176, 2981002177, 2981002178, 2981002179, 2981002180, 2981002181, 2981002182, 2981002183, 2981002184, 2981002185, 2981002186, 2981002187, 2981002188, 2981002189, 2981002190, 2981002191, 2981002192, 2981002193, 2981002194, 2981002195, 2981002196, 2981002197, 2981002198, 2981002199, 2981002200, 2981002201, 2981002202, 2981002203, 2981002204, 2981002205, 2981002206, 2981002207, 2981002208, 2981002209, 2981002210, 2981002211, 2981002212, 2981002213, 2981002214, 2981002215, 2981002216, 2981002217, 2981002218, 2981002219, 2981002220, 2981002221, 2981002222, 2981002223, 2981002224, 2981002225, 2981002226, 2981002227, 2981002228, 2981002229, 2981002230, 2981002231, 2981002232, 2981002233, 2981002234, 2981002235, 2981002236, 2981002237, 2981002238, 2981002239, 2981002240, 2981002241, 2981002242, 2981002243, 2981002244, 2981002245, 2981002246, 2981002247, 2981002248, 2981002249, 2981002250, 2981002251, 2981002252, 2981002253, 2981002254, 2981002255, 2981002256, 2981002257, 2981002258, 2981002259, 2981002260, 2981002261, 2981002262, 2981002263, 2981002264, 2981002265, 2981002266, 2981002267, 2981002268, 2981002269, 2981002270, 2981002271, 2981002272, 2981002273, 2981002274, 2981002275, 2981002276, 2981002277, 2981002278, 2981002279, 2981002280, 2981002281, 2981002282, 2981002283, 2981002284, 2981002285, 2981002286, 2981002287, 2981002288, 2981002289, 2981002290, 2981002291, 2981002292, 2981002293, 2981002294, 2981002295, 2981002296, 2981002297, 2981002298, 2981002299, 2981002300, 2981002301, 2981002302, 2981002303, 2981002304, 2981002305, 2981002306, 2981002307, 2981002308, 2981002309, 2981002310, 2981002311, 2981002312, 2981002313, 2981002314, 2981002315, 2981002316, 2981002317, 2981002318, 2981002319, 2981002320, 2981002321, 2981002322, 2981002323, 2981002324, 2981002325, 2981002326, 2981002327, 2981002328, 2981002329, 2981002330, 2981002331, 2981002332, 2981002333, 2981002334, 2981002335, 2981002336, 2981002337, 2981002338, 2981002339, 2981002340, 2981002341, 2981002342, 2981002343, 2981002344, 2981002345, 2981002346, 2981002347, 2981002348, 2981002349, 2981002350, 2981002351, 2981002352, 2981002353, 2981002354, 2981002355, 2981002356, 2981002357, 2981002358, 2981002359, 2981002360, 2981002361, 2981002362, 2981002363, 2981002364, 2981002365, 2981002366, 2981002367, 2981002368, 2981002369, 2981002370, 2981002371, 2981002372, 2981002373, 2981002374, 2981002375, 2981002376, 2981002377, 2981002378, 2981002379, 2981002380, 2981002381, 2981002382, 2981002383, 2981002384, 2981002385, 2981002386, 2981002387, 2981002388, 2981002389, 2981002390, 2981002391, 2981002392, 2981002393, 2981002394, 2981002395, 2981002396, 2981002397, 2981002398, 2981002399, 2981002400, 2981002401, 2981002402, 2981002403, 2981002404, 2981002405, 2981002406, 2981002407, 2981002408, 2981002409, 2981002410, 2981002411, 2981002412, 2981002413, 2981002414, 2981002415, 2981002416, 2981002417, 2981002418, 2981002419, 2981002420, 2981002421, 2981002422, 2981002423, 2981002424, 2981002425, 2981002426, 2981002427, 2981002428, 2981002429, 2981002430, 2981002431, 2981002432, 2981002433, 2981002434, 2981002435, 2981002436, 2981002437, 2981002438, 2981002439, 2981002440, 2981002441, 2981002442, 2981002443, 2981002444, 2981002445, 2981002446, 2981002447, 2981002448, 2981002449, 2981002450, 2981002451, 2981002452, 2981002453, 2981002454, 2981002455, 2981002456, 2981002457, 2981002458, 2981002459, 2981002460, 2981002461, 2981002462, 2981002463, 2981002464, 2981002465, 2981002466, 2981002467, 2981002468, 2981002469, 2981002470, 2981002471, 2981002472, 2981002473, 2981002474, 2981002475, 2981002476, 2981002477, 2981002478, 2981002479, 2981002480, 2981002481, 2981002482, 2981002483, 2981002484, 2981002485, 2981002486, 2981002487, 2981002488, 2981002489, 2981002490, 2981002491, 2981002492, 2981002493, 2981002494, 2981002495, 2981002496, 2981002497, 2981002498, 2981002499, 2981002500, 2981002501, 2981002502, 2981002503, 2981002504, 2981002505, 2981002506, 2981002507, 2981002508, 2981002509, 2981002510, 2981002511, 2981002512, 2981002513, 2981002514, 2981002515, 2981002516, 2981002517, 2981002518, 2981002519, 2981002520, 2981002521, 2981002522, 2981002523, 2981002524, 2981002525, 2981002526, 2981002527, 2981002528, 2981002529, 2981002530, 2981002531, 2981002532, 2981002533, 2981002534, 2981002535, 2981002536, 2981002537, 2981002538, 2981002539, 2981002540, 2981002541, 2981002542, 2981002543, 2981002544, 2981002545, 2981002546, 2981002547, 2981002548, 2981002549, 2981002550, 2981002551, 2981002552, 2981002553, 2981002554, 2981002555, 2981002556, 2981002557, 2981002558, 2981002559, 2981002560, 2981002561, 2981002562, 2981002563, 2981002564, 2981002565, 2981002566, 2981002567, 2981002568, 2981002569, 2981002570, 2981002571, 2981002572, 2981002573, 2981002574, 2981002575, 2981002576, 2981002577, 2981002578, 2981002579, 2981002580, 2981002581, 2981002582, 2981002583, 2981002584, 2981002585, 2981002586, 2981002587, 2981002588, 2981002589, 2981002590, 2981002591, 2981002592, 2981002593, 2981002594, 2981002595, 2981002596, 2981002597, 2981002598, 2981002599, 2981002600, 2981002601, 2981002602, 2981002603, 2981002604, 2981002605, 2981002606, 2981002607, 2981002608, 2981002609, 2981002610, 2981002611, 2981002612, 2981002613, 2981002614, 2981002615, 2981002616, 2981002617, 2981002618, 2981002619, 2981002620, 2981002621, 2981002622, 2981002623, 2981002624, 2981002625, 2981002626, 2981002627, 2981002628, 2981002629, 2981002630, 2981002631, 2981002632, 2981002633, 2981002634, 2981002635, 2981002636, 2981002637, 2981002638, 2981002639, 2981002640, 2981002641, 2981002642, 2981002643, 2981002644, 2981002645, 2981002646, 2981002647, 2981002648, 2981002649, 2981002650, 2981002651, 2981002652, 2981002653, 2981002654, 2981002655, 2981002656, 2981002657, 2981002658, 2981002659, 2981002660, 2981002661, 2981002662, 2981002663, 2981002664, 2981002665, 2981002666, 2981002667, 2981002668, 2981002669, 2981002670, 2981002671, 2981002672, 2981002673, 2981002674, 2981002675, 2981002676, 2981002677, 2981002678, 2981002679, 2981002680, 2981002681, 2981002682, 2981002683, 2981002684, 2981002685, 2981002686, 2981002687, 2981002688, 2981002689, 2981002690, 2981002691, 2981002692, 2981002693, 2981002694, 2981002695, 2981002696, 2981002697, 2981002698, 2981002699, 2981002700, 2981002701, 2981002702, 2981002703, 2981002704, 2981002705, 2981002706, 2981002707, 2981002708, 2981002709, 2981002710, 2981002711, 2981002712, 2981002713, 2981002714, 2981002715, 2981002716, 2981002717, 2981002718, 2981002719, 2981002720, 2981002721, 2981002722, 2981002723, 2981002724, 2981002725, 2981002726, 2981002727, 2981002728, 2981002729, 2981002730, 2981002731, 2981002732, 2981002733, 2981002734, 2981002735, 2981002736, 2981002737, 2981002738, 2981002739, 2981002740, 2981002741, 2981002742, 2981002743, 2981002744, 2981002745, 2981002746, 2981002747, 2981002748, 2981002749, 2981002750, 2981002751, 2981002752, 2981002753, 2981002754, 2981002755, 2981002756, 2981002757, 2981002758, 2981002759, 2981002760, 2981002761, 2981002762, 2981002763, 2981002764, 2981002765, 2981002766, 2981002767, 2981002768, 2981002769, 2981002770, 2981002771, 2981002772, 2981002773, 2981002774, 2981002775, 2981002776, 2981002777, 2981002778, 2981002779, 2981002780, 2981002781, 2981002782, 2981002783, 2981002784, 2981002785, 2981002786, 2981002787, 2981002788, 2981002789, 2981002790, 2981002791, 2981002792, 2981002793, 2981002794, 2981002795, 2981002796, 2981002797, 2981002798, 2981002799, 2981002800, 2981002801, 2981002802, 2981002803, 2981002804, 2981002805, 2981002806, 2981002807, 2981002808, 2981002809, 2981002810, 2981002811, 2981002812, 2981002813, 2981002814, 2981002815, 2981002816, 2981002817, 2981002818, 2981002819, 2981002820, 2981002821, 2981002822, 2981002823, 2981002824, 2981002825, 2981002826, 2981002827, 2981002828, 2981002829, 2981002830, 2981002831, 2981002832, 2981002833, 2981002834,

✕ @ieExplained

#ExpressExplained

If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

• **GEOPOLITICS**

The Hasina factor in India-Bangladesh ties



SHUBHAJIT ROY

OUSTED BANGLADESH Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina had her first media interaction through virtual mode on Wednesday, where she said she plans to return to her country, stand with its people, and help improve their lives.

The statement, made while she is in India, its timing, and Hasina's willingness to answer or dodge questions have implications for herself, Bangladesh's politics, and New Delhi's ties with its neighbour.

Bangladesh, predictably, has reacted with outrage that "the absconding convicted genocider Sheikh Hasina was allowed this evening to engage in live interaction with the media in New Delhi..." according to a statement by its foreign ministry.

The timing

Hasina, who fled Bangladesh on August 5, 2024, amid raging protests, has been living in India in an undisclosed location for the last two years. She had addressed the media at the Foreign Correspondents' Club of South Asia in January through an audio-recorded message, but had not taken questions. That message was played out a month before the national elections in Bangladesh.

This time, Hasina took questions, and was also joined online by her son, Sajeeb Wazed Joy, who was an advisor in her government and lives in the US.

The tone and the statement

Hasina's statement was emotional and rhetorical, with her voice choking as she spoke from a prepared text. In the statement that lasted about 23 minutes, she highlighted the violent political unrest in Bangladesh, the destruction of public and private properties, the killing of police officers, and the targeting of media.

She emphasized the economic decline, with GDP growth falling to 2.2% from 6.8%, and called for international support to restore democracy and justice in Bangladesh.

She declared, "Whatever fate awaits me,



Former Bangladesh PM Sheikh Hasina addresses a press conference in New Delhi via audio link.

PRAVEEN KHANNA

Tricky ties

The Ganga Water Treaty of 1996 is due for renewal this year. The Teesta water treaty is still to be signed.

While Bangladesh has removed visa curbs, some trade restrictions remain. Delhi also views illegal immigration from Bangladesh as a major irritant.

was a violent situation. So, if one set of killings is legal, then how does the question of apology arise? Why does it arise?"

Hasina's statements were barred from being broadcast in Bangladesh's mainstream media, using the same draconian laws that the Hasina government had used against current Prime Minister Tarique Rahman 17 years ago

New Delhi and the BNP govt

Hasina in her statement directly targeted the BNP government, with which India has tried to cultivate ties.

Rahman had also signalled a positive relationship with India in his pronouncements. But there have since been challenges — Delhi views illegal immigration from Bangladesh as a major irritant, and the BJP-led West Bengal government has upped the ante on this. The fact that Rahman has visited China but not India yet also signals that there is some tension.

Amid the outstanding bilateral issues, the Ganga Water Treaty of 1996 is due for renewal this year. The Teesta water treaty is still to be signed. While Bangladesh has removed visa curbs on Indians, some trade restrictions remain.

In such a complicated bilateral situation, Hasina's statements targeting the BNP government are certain to create acrimony. "Dhaka deeply regrets that in spite of con-

cerns conveyed apriori to the Government of India about the likely ramifications of this event on the reset of our bilateral relations, this public event was permitted to be held," its foreign ministry said on August 5.

Indeed, it is learnt that New Delhi allowing a platform for the former PM has had a negative impact in Dhaka.

BNP leaders feel that this only reinforces the belief that India is pro-Awami League, and is unable to reconcile to the new political realities. Many in Dhaka view this as a misstep at a time when the Rahman government was trying to repair ties. This also puts the possible visit by Rahman for the BRICS summit in September in jeopardy. And India will have to work hard to assuage the suspicion this episode might have instilled in the minds of Bangladesh's decision-makers.

For Delhi, a robust and healthy bilateral relationship with Dhaka is essential, especially since it needs Dhaka to access its north-eastern states easily. A peaceful and stable Bangladesh, where anti-India statements and activities are kept in-check is important for Delhi's internal security.

Bangladesh too needs India, since it is surrounded by the large neighbour from three sides. The Hasina episode highlights New Delhi's tough balancing act to deal with a tricky bilateral relationship.

India's tightrope

In 2024, India gave Hasina refuge instantly, even when other doors were closed to her. She has lived here since. On how the Indian government had been treating her, Joy said she is being treated like a Head of State, with full services and security.

While the Ministry of External Affairs has clarified, for the record, that it was not involved in Hasina's press interaction, the event can be seen as New Delhi creating leverage by using the former PM — her statements and her silences — to gain some diplomatic quid pro quo in negotiations on trade, water, economy, politics, security, and a range of tricky areas with Bangladesh.

The fact that India has kept her in safe custody with full security is similar to how New Delhi has treated the Dalai Lama — much to China's annoyance. He is allowed to conduct spiritual activities and not political activities, but the Tibetan leader has the ability to fuse the two with finesse.

• **HEALTH**

Talcum powder causes cancer? Not always, but use with caution

Rinku Ghosh & Purnima Sah
New Delhi, Mumbai, August 6

JOHNSON & JOHNSON (J&J) recently agreed to pay billions of dollars to settle lawsuits alleging that its talcum powder products caused ovarian cancer and other illnesses because they contained asbestos, a known carcinogen. The company has consistently denied that its talc products were unsafe and says the settlement is intended to end years of costly litigation.

In 2020, J&J stopped selling talc-based baby powder in the US and Canada. In 2023, it discontinued talc-based baby powder globally, replacing it with a cornstarch-based formulation.

What is the scientific consensus on the link between talcum powder and ovarian cancer?

The International Agency for Research on Cancer (IARC) classifies talc, not containing asbestos, as "probably" carcinogenic to humans, based on limited evidence in humans and sufficient evidence in animal studies. But there isn't enough evidence to support that talc is a "definite" carcinogen for ovarian cancer, said Dr Gau-

ravi Mishra, Deputy Director, Centre for Cancer Epidemiology (CCE), Tata Memorial Centre, Mumbai. "Prospective cohort studies... have generally not shown a statistically significant increase in risk for ovarian cancer," she said.

How can asbestos contaminate talc?

Talc and asbestos are naturally occurring silicate minerals that may co-form within the same geological deposits. "Contamination of talc with asbestos is dependent on the mine of origin and the rigour of ore screening, and is not an inherent property of the consumer talc product itself. Mining of asbestos is banned in India. Existing tests are not sensitive enough to reliably exclude trace asbestos contamination. Hence, there is no standardised testing method currently recommended by any regulatory body," said Dr Ashwin Sathyan, senior resident, Department of Preventive Oncology, CCE.

Should talc users be concerned?

There is no cause for alarm among long-term users of talcum powder. This position is consistent across IARC and independent reviews. "Prior use should not be attributed as the cause of any current symptoms with-

Asbestos and talc: The link

Talc and asbestos are naturally occurring silicate minerals that may co-form within the same geological deposits.

Contamination of talc with asbestos is dependent on the mine of origin and the rigour of ore screening, and is not an inherent property of the consumer talc product itself.

out appropriate clinical evaluation. Women with a family history of ovarian or breast cancer are advised to discuss this concern with their physician," said Dr Mishra.

Are there any guidelines on its use?

No major regulatory or scientific body has issued a prohibition on talcum powder use on any body part, including the genital area. "But its use on open wounds or sensitive skin is not recommended, as it may lead to irritation or mineral toxicity," said Dr Mishra. Regulatory policy in India is still under development and scrutiny, she said.

There are more caveats on its use. Dr Pralhad Rathod, professor and HOD, dermatology at JJ Hospital, Mumbai, said that body powder should be avoided altogether for babies, especially near the nose and the mouth. He also said it should be avoided by individuals with asthma or chronic respiratory diseases; on raw, broken, inflamed, or infected skin; when there is an undiagnosed genital rash; where the powder repeatedly cakes with sweat and increases friction; and in poorly ventilated areas.

"Talc is not a reason for panic but it is also not an indispensable personal care product. Given the remaining uncertainty,

the prudent approach is to choose a traceable, talc-free product where a powder is genuinely needed," said Dr Usha Khemani, associate professor of dermatology, JJ Hospital, Mumbai.

Cornstarch-based powders are a reasonable substitute, being free of any asbestos-contamination pathway. "They aren't linked in literature to ovarian cancer risk. Body powders of either type are best avoided on broken or irritated skin, on post-surgical or post-partum wounds, and in infants, where inhalation risk is highest," said Dr Mishra.

Are India-made talcs safe?

Available India-specific data is limited and in its early stages. "Tremolite asbestos was found in seven of 13 commercially available Indian talc products tested, and an earlier Indian Institute of Toxicology Research report similarly identified asbestos fibres in five Indian brands," said Dr Sathyan.

The IARC hazard classification is not a calculation of the risk from the occasional personal use. "This means that under certain exposure circumstances, the substance is capable of causing cancer; it does not mean that every user — or even most users — will develop cancer," says Dr Rathod.

• **EDUCATION**

The challenge for school consolidation: Balancing access and quality education



EXPERT EXPLAINS

RAJEEV KUMAR

FORMER PROFESSOR AT IIT KHARAGPUR, IIT KANPUR, BITS PILANI AND JNU

THE CONGRESS recently posted on social media platform X that 94,000 government schools had been shut down over the past decade, a number first flagged in a NITI Aayog report from May.

For decades, India's school education policy focused on expanding neighbourhood schools so that every child could access education closer to home. Today, however, the narrative is changing. Education being in the Concurrent List, several states have adopted policies to close, merge or consolidate schools, raising concerns about access to education. Government data,

however, reveals a more nuanced story, which can be understood through three broad trends between 2014-15 and 2024-25:

ONE, the total number of schools saw a modest decline of around 45,000. This, however, was driven entirely by a fall in the number of government schools (94,000, as mentioned above) while the number of private unaided schools increased.

TWO, overall student enrolment declined in a manner similar to the trend seen in school numbers — government enrolment fell while private enrolment increased in recent years.

THREE, the number of teachers increased, pointing to improved teacher availability amid declining enrolment and fewer schools.

Is the closure and consolidation of government schools a crisis that is depriving children of neighbourhood educational access, or is it a consequence of demographic factors and changing preferences? More importantly, should the success of school education be measured by the number of schools, or by whether every child has access to a well-resourced school — even if it means traveling a little farther?

• HOW SCHOOL EDUCATION LANDSCAPE HAS SHIFTED

Indicator	2014-15	2024-25	Change
Schools	15.16 lakh	14.71 lakh	(-) 45,000
Govt schools	11.07 lakh	10.13 lakh	(-) 94,000
Teachers	89.84 lakh	1.01 crore	(+) 11.2 lakh
Student enrolment	26.95 crore	24.69 crore	(-) 2.26 crore

(SOURCE: UDISE/UDISE+ REPORTS)

What the data reveals

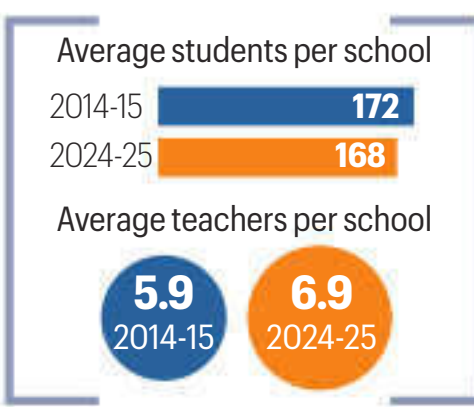
India is experiencing a demographic transition. The country's total fertility rate — the average number of children born to a woman — has plunged from more than 3 in the early 1990s to about 2.0 today, below the replacement level of 2.1.

The transition is reflected in data from the Centre's Unified District Information System for Education Plus (UDISE+), an education management information system.

ENROLMENT: With fewer children entering school each year, enrolment has

steadily declined. Between 2014-15 and 2024-25, overall student enrolment fell by 2.26 crore to 24.69 crore. Enrolment in government schools declined from 13.62 crore to 12.16 crore between 2022-23 and 2024-25, while enrolment in private schools increased from 8.42 crore to 9.59 crore, according to a Rajya Sabha reply in March.

SCHOOLS: The total number of schools saw a decline from about 15.16 lakh in 2014-15 to 14.71 lakh in 2024-25. During this period, the number of government schools declined from about 11.07 lakh to 10.13 lakh



even as private unaided schools expanded.

TEACHERS: The number of school teachers increased from about 90 lakh in 2014-15 to over one crore in 2024-25, improving teacher availability amid lower enrolment and fewer schools.

The national averages mask stark disparities: While many rural schools operate with very low enrolment or a single teacher, many urban schools are overcrowded.

Overall, the data points not merely to school closures, but to a transformation of the school education system. This is being driven by demographic change, shifting enrolment patterns, evolving parental preferences and efforts to provide students with better-resourced learning environments.

Why school size matters

Thousands of government schools operate with a single teacher or only a handful of students, making it difficult to provide grade-wise, subject-specific instruction, co-curricular activities, sports, laboratories and meaningful peer learning. Teachers often handle multiple classes alongside administrative tasks, limiting the holistic development that schools are expected to foster.

School consolidation seeks to address these limitations by merging under-enrolled schools into better-equipped composite schools with qualified teachers, improved infrastructure, and richer learning opportunities. The aim should be to improve educational quality rather than merely reducing costs. As seen earlier, the data also indicates improved teacher availability despite fewer schools.

Yet, consolidation is not an end in itself. Its success depends on balancing quality, efficiency, and equitable access. While larger schools may offer better learning opportunities, increased travel distances can disadvantage young children, girls and students in remote or tribal areas.

India's school education system must balance access, equity, quality and efficiency. Wherever schools are merged, governments must ensure safe transport and uninterrupted access. While demographic transition and declining enrolment make some degree of school consolidation inevitable, decisions should be data-driven — not merely administrative or financial considerations.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Drone found at German air hub was close to plane with ammo: Report

Reuters
Frankfurt, August 6

A UKRAINIAN cargo aircraft parked near an explosive-laden drone found at Germany's Leipzig/Halle airport on Tuesday night was carrying a payload of military ammunition, a group of news outlets including *Sueddeutsche Zeitung* reported on Thursday.

Forensic experts found that the explosives attached to the drone were of a high military grade, reported the outlets, which also included broadcasters *NDR* and *WDR*, citing a confidential police report.

Newspaper *Bild*, meanwhile, cited unnamed investigators as saying that a technical defect prevented the drone-mounted device from exploding.

Those findings potentially raise the stakes in a widening counterterrorism investigation of the incident at an airport serving as a major cargo and NATO military logistics hub that the German government has designated as critical infrastructure.

German Interior Minister Alexander Dobrindt said late on Wednesday that the drone incident constituted a hybrid attack and signaled an elevated level of danger.

Dobrindt is due to host his counterparts from the Baltic states, Poland, Sweden, Norway and Denmark, among other nations, for a special summit on anti-drone defence in the northern German town of Flensburg at the end of August.

Police in the state of Saxony did not immediately respond to a request for comment on the media reports of the aircraft's payload. The state's public prosecutors' office could not be reached for comment.

ARAGHCHI TALKS TO WEST ASIA LEADERS

Iran to Gulf: Tell Trump to desist or face attacks

Saudi urges Trump to delay military action, pursue talks

Reuters
August 6

IRAN HAS made a concerted diplomatic push with Gulf states, warning them explicitly that Tehran will hit their oil, power and water plants unless they convince Donald Trump to end US strikes on Iran and instead seek a negotiated end to the war.

The warning envisaged attacks on the energy facilities, oil fields, refineries, electricity grids, water infrastructure, transport networks and other strategic assets of Washington's closest Arab allies, according to a senior Iranian official.

The message, part of a broader Iranian effort to deter further US military action by raising the prospect of severe economic disruption across the Gulf, was delivered through a flurry of high-level diplomatic contacts after Trump threatened on July 28 to strike Iran's energy infrastructure, the sources said.

Two senior Iranian officials, two Gulf sources and a senior regional diplomat with knowledge of the discussions said Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi spoke with his Saudi, Turkish and Qatari counterparts, as

well as Pakistan's army chief. All spoke on condition of anonymity because of the sensitivity of the matter.

Araghchi urged Washington's Gulf allies to use their influence with Trump to dissuade him from launching renewed strikes, the senior diplomat said, warning that any attack on Iran would prompt retaliation against US assets and critical infrastructure across the Gulf.

His message was consistent in every conversation, the diplomat said: "We're ready to retaliate, but finding a diplomatic solution is the best way to avoid wider escalation and destruction across the region."

"The Iranian warning was unequivocal: if America targeted Iran's infrastructure, they would retaliate by striking Gulf energy facilities and other regional targets," one Gulf source said.

The diplomatic campaign underscores how Iran is seeking to turn Gulf vulnerability into leverage, confronting regional governments with the prospect that any renewed US-Iran confrontation could place the infrastructure underpinning their economies directly in firing line.

Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman subsequently spoke with Trump, urging him to delay military action, return to negotiations, secure a ceasefire and pursue a diplomatic settlement, the senior diplomat and Gulf sources said.

Italy on red alert, Hungary turns off the lights

Heatwave moves further east, mercury hits record high in Austria, Rhine ebbs

Reuters
Rome, Budapest, August 6

ITALY TOOK the unprecedented step of placing all its major cities on the highest level of health alert due to high temperatures on Thursday while Hungary turned off the lights at some of its best-known buildings to save energy as a heat-wave maintained its grip on large parts of Europe.

Europe, the world's fastest-warming continent, has been ravaged by record-breaking heat and destructive wildfires this summer, with France and Spain particularly hard hit in recent weeks.

The focus of the heatwave has since moved further east, with temperatures in Austria hitting successive national records

this week, peaking at 41.2 degrees Celsius on Wednesday.

Italy is accustomed to hot summers, but the red alert issued by the Health Ministry stretches from Palermo on the southern island of Sicily to Bolzano in the mountainous north.

Such a warning indicates a potential health emergency with prolonged high temperatures posing a serious health risk to the entire population. In the north-western city of Genoa, people aged 65 and over can escape the heat by visiting museums and libraries free of charge during hottest hours of the day this month.

Rome extended its scheme of offering free screenings in air-conditioned cinemas by 10 days to August 14.

With rivers at historic lows, the region of Piedmont, centred



A drone view shows receding water levels due to drought at Lake Velence, Hungary's third-largest, on Thursday. REUTERS

on the city of Turin, declared a state of emergency this week for drought and the risk of wildfire.

Hungary has switched off decorative and non-essential lighting at all state institutions, including its Parliament, most of the Buda Castle and Chain Bridge, at night to save energy.

Record-low water levels on

The authorities in the capital Bucharest have dimmed the intensity of street lights by a third and switched off lighting at night at landmark buildings and museums to save power.

Low water levels are causing problems for shipping on the Rhine in Germany, where many vessels can sail only part-loaded, raising freight costs. The river is an important shipping route for commodities such as grains, minerals, coal and oil products.

In Bosnia, tourists have taken shelter in the constantly cool temperatures of the UNESCO-listed Vjetrenica cave to escape outside temperatures of 40C. Vjetrenica, which means wind cave, is located in the south of Bosnia and Herzegovina, about 25 km north of the Adriatic town of Dubrovnik, where cruise liners arrive daily with thousands of visitors.

Numbers allowed to visit the cave are limited because of the sensitivity of the environment.

New images of sun reveal its strange, dynamic facade

Associated Press
New York, August 6

SCIENTISTS HAVE captured images of the sun's surface in the finest detail yet, revealing a strange and dynamic facade.

It's dangerous to look directly at the sun without proper eye protection. But researchers were able to peek at its scorching surface with the help of the National Science Foundation's Daniel K Inouye Solar Telescope, located on the island of Maui in Hawaii.

Scientists originally took the images for a different reason: to fine-tune and test the limits of the telescope.

But when they looked at the results, they realized they'd

photographed the sun's bright outer shell at higher resolution than ever before.

What's more, they saw strange feathery patterns rippling across the surface.

"That reminds me of famous paintings, like the swirling skies in Van Gogh's *Starry Night*," said solar physicist Ruizhu Chen with Stanford University, who was not involved with the new research.

Researchers saw ripples of instability on the sun's surface caused by bits of magnetized plasma moving past each other at different speeds — similar to waves that stir when a gust of wind blows over water. It's a well-known phenomenon that guides how fluids move.

Israel charges Jewish settler in Palestinian's killing

Rare indictment; activist was part of Oscar-winning film

Reuters
Jerusalem, August 6

ISRAELI PROSECUTORS on Thursday charged a Jewish settler over the killing of a Palestinian community leader last year in the occupied West Bank — the first indictment of a settler

in a Palestinian's death in nearly three years.

In an indictment filed by the state attorney's office, Yinon Levi is charged with reckless manslaughter in the death of Owdeh Hathaleen, a prominent activist who was involved in the 2025 Oscar-winning documentary *No Other Land*.

The charges against Levi also include armed trespassing and malicious property damage during a July 2025 incident in which settlers operated a large excavator in the Palestinian vil-

lage of Umm al-Khair, setting off a confrontation with residents.

Hathaleen filmed the moment he was shot during the confrontation. Footage released by the Israeli rights group B'Tselem shows Levi draw a weapon and fire in Hathaleen's direction. Hathaleen is then heard moaning as he falls to the ground.

Levi, who Britain and the European Union have placed under sanctions over violence against Palestinians, has previously denied firing the shot

that killed Hathaleen.

Thursday's indictment marks the first since the October 7, 2023 Hamas attacks on Israel that set off Israel's military assault in Gaza and led to a sharp rise in settler violence against Palestinians in the West Bank, B'Tselem said.

"The decision to indict Yinon Levi is the exception that proves the rule. The impunity Israel grants to soldiers and settlers who harm Palestinians is not a failure of the system — it is a central component of a policy de-

signed to allow the violence to continue and escalate," B'Tselem said. Israel's military says it investigates instances of wrongdoing by its soldiers and it and the Israeli police take steps to crack down on settler violence.

UN bodies, Palestinians and most countries view the settlements as illegal under international conventions and a major obstacle to peace. Israel disputes that the settlements are illegal, saying that a Jewish presence has existed in the West Bank for thousands of years.

Nepal govt calls off international conference on Tibetan studies

Yubaraj Ghimire
Kathmandu, August 6

THE NEPAL Government has asked the organisers of the 17th International Association of Tibetan Studies to cancel the event barely three weeks before it was to begin.

On Monday evening, Chief Secretary Gobinda Karki conveyed to the Acting Vice Chancellor of Kathmandu University and three other senior officials that the situation was not quite conducive to hold the event, scheduled from August 29, and that it should be called off.

Over 700 scholars on Buddhism and Tibet studies from 40 different countries, around 100 from China alone, were supposed to attend the event.

Karki did not specify any reason for the government's decision. A senior official from the Ministry of Foreign Affairs, however, denied any such pressure from Chinese officials.

The Chinese Ambassador to Nepal, Zhang Maoming, had met Foreign Secretary Amrit Rai on July 21 to express his concern about the event. He was told by the government it was purely an "academic exercise" and there would not be any room for it to be used against China.

• BRIEFLY

UKRAINE

Former ambassador to US faces probe over 'undeclared assets'



Olha Stefanishyna, Ukraine's former envoy to the United States. FILE

OLHA STEFANISHYNA, dismissed as Ukraine's ambassador to the US earlier this week, is suspected of illegal enrichment and failing to declare assets, authorities said on Thursday, the latest high-ranking official targeted in an anti-graft probe. Prosecutors said Stefanishyna, who served as a deputy prime minister before being appointed ambassador, concealed two apartments and other assets worth about \$310,000 in total that could not have been acquired on her official salary alone. REUTERS

BANGLADESH

Presidential election on August 20: EC

BANGLADESH'S PRESIDENTIAL election will be held on August 20, the country's Election Commission announced on Thursday. The presidential elections were necessitated after Mohammed Shahabuddin, a longtime ally of deposed prime minister Sheikh Hasina, resigned from the post on July 24, two years ahead of the end of his tenure. PTI

YEMEN

Houthi rebel attacks kill 30 govt troops

HOUTHI REBEL attacks Thursday in central and eastern Yemen killed at least 30 government troops and wounded at least 50 others, Yemeni government officials said. The assaults hit camps for forces of internationally recognized government in the provinces of Marib and Hadhramaut, the officials said. The attacks were a escalation since a de facto truce in Yemen. REUTERS

US Senate committee votes to hold Fauci in contempt over COVID probe

Associated Press
Washington, August 6

A SENATE committee on Thursday voted to hold Dr Anthony Fauci in contempt of Congress and refer him to the Justice Department for potential prosecution over his refusal to answer questions at a hearing last week focused on his handling of the COVID-19 pandemic.

The party-line vote approving the contempt resolution came a week after Fauci invoked his Fifth Amendment right against self-incrimination more than 100 times when he appeared before the Senate Com-



Anthony Fauci, former director of National Institute of Allergy and Infectious Diseases. FILE

mittee on Homeland Security and Governmental Affairs.

Republican Sen. Rand Paul of Kentucky, the committee

chairman, said constitutional protection did not apply since Fauci last year received a pardon from President Joe Biden and thus did not have to worry about the threat of prosecution.

Fauci and Democrats who opposed the contempt resolution said he had a well-founded fear of self-incrimination given a public desire by Republicans to seek his prosecution. "Dr. Fauci faced no risk of federal prosecution," Paul said. "All he had to do was tell the truth."

Paul noted the vote had nothing to do with Fauci's policies, opinions or anything he has said in previous congressional appearances.

Explosion in Damascus suburb kills one, injures several others

DAMASCUS: An explosion in a suburb of the Syrian capital Damascus killed at least one person and wounded several others, according to Syrian state media and an *Associated Press* journalist at the scene.

Syrian state television cited an unnamed security official as saying the explosion in Jaramana was caused by an explosive device planted in a minivan taxi. Syria's Health Ministry said seven people were wounded.

Residents and rescue workers rushed to the scene.

Witnesses told the AP there were passengers inside the vehicle that exploded, and that the blast rattled the busy commer-

cial street. No group claimed responsibility for the attack.

Jaramana, which is home to a large population of Druze religious minority, has faced tensions between some members of the community and Sunni Muslim Syrians supportive of the current Islamist-led government.

Tensions flared in April 2025, when at least 10 people were killed in sectarian clashes between Druze gunmen and pro-government fighters.

The apparent bombing, the third in just over a month, is the latest of several challenges interim President Ahmad al-Sharaa has faced since coming to power in December 2024.

Australia grants citizenship to 2 Iranian women's soccer players who sought asylum

Melbourne: Two members of the Iranian women's soccer team who claimed asylum in Australia in March have been granted citizenship.

Fatemeh Pasandideh and Atefeh Ramezanisadeh said in a statement Thursday Immigration Minister Tony Burke swore them in the day before at a citizenship ceremony in their Australian home city of Brisbane.

Friends and supporters from the local Iranian community attended the ceremony.

"Yesterday was a truly special and unforgettable day for me. I feel proud and deeply grateful to become an Australia-

lian citizen. Australia has given me the opportunity to build my life and my future, and I feel, more than ever, that I belong here," Ramezanisadeh said in the statement.

Ramezanisadeh said her Iranian roots and memories would always be part of her.

Pasandideh said Wednesday had been "one of the happiest days of my life."

"I'm incredibly proud and grateful to officially become an Australian citizen. After everything we've been through and all the challenges we faced, this moment means more than words can express," Pasandideh said.

• JASON ARDAY RESIGNED AFTER WEEKS OF PLAGIARISM ALLEGATIONS AND SCRUTINY OVER CLAIMS ABOUT ATHLETIC AND FUNDRAISING ACHIEVEMENTS

Youngest Black professor at Cambridge quits amid plagiarism probe

Associated Press
London, August 6

A BRITISH sociologist who became famous as the youngest Black professor ever at the University of Cambridge has resigned after the university opened an investigation into "new information" about his academic qualifications.

Professor Jason Arday, who was 37 when he became a Cambridge professor in 2023, announced his decision late Wednesday following weeks of allegations about plagiarism in his academic work and questions surrounding claims about his athletic and fundraising accomplishments.

"While criticism is an inevitable part of academic life, what I have experienced has gone far beyond scholarly disagreement," Arday said in a statement. "The relentless accusations, speculation and public commentary have taken a profound toll on me and on those I love."

The statement was distributed by the Good Law Project, a campaign group that has supported Arday since the criticism spilled into the media last month. An earlier letter circulated by the group and signed by more than two dozen academics and politicians described the plagiarism allegations as a "smear campaign" designed to undermine Arday and other



Jason Arday carries the Olympic Flame on the Torch Relay leg between Sutton and Merton, in London on July 23, 2012. AP

Black people who hold "positions of influence."

Arday's appointment at Cambridge highlighted his per-

sonal story of overcoming dyslexia, developmental delays and autism that he said left him non-verbal until the age of 11 and illit-

erate until his late teens.

Questions about his qualifications were raised publicly last month by Nathan Cofnas, a one-time Cambridge philosophy researcher who left the university after his critique of diversity, equity and inclusion programs sparked widespread protests.

On July 24, the *Times of London* published an analysis of Arday's 2015 PhD thesis highlighting what it said were multiple examples of passages that were "identical or near-identical" to an earlier paper written by another researcher.

The British media also raised questions about Arday's claims that he had raised \$7.4 million for charity through feats such as

running 30 marathons in 35 days and 600 miles in six days. Arday told the *Guardian* news website the money was raised with the help of others over a 20-year period.

Cambridge initially stood by Arday, saying that the plagiarism allegations had been investigated by Liverpool John Moores University, which awarded Arday's doctorate. That changed Wednesday when Cambridge opened its inquiry.

"The University of Cambridge has begun an investigation following new information about Professor Arday's qualifications and honorary appointments," the university said in a statement.



BEING ON UPPER LAYER MEANS A COMPANY WILL HAVE TO LIST ON STOCK EXCHANGES WITHIN 3 YEARS

Tata Sons stays in upper layer NBFC list; deregistration plea awaits nod

George Mathew
Mumbai, August 6

THE RESERVE Bank of India (RBI) on Thursday classified Tata Sons Ltd, the principal holding company of the Tata Group, in the list of upper layer non-banking finance companies (NBFC-UL). However, the RBI said Tata Sons' application for deregistration is under examination which, if approved by the central bank, will enable the firm to avoid listing on the stock exchanges.

"The inclusion of Tata Sons in the list of NBFC-UL is without prejudice to the outcome of its application for deregistration, which is under examination," the RBI said. This means the central bank is yet to take a final view on the classification of Tata Sons. If Tata Sons continues on the NBFC-UL list, it will have to come out with an initial public offering (IPO) and list its shares on the stock exchanges.

Apart from Tata Sons, the RBI has classified 16 other NBFCs in the upper layer, bringing them under an enhanced regulatory framework. These include Bajaj Finance, Tata Capital, Aditya Birla Capital, L&T Finance, Mahindra & Mahindra Financial Services, and Shriram Finance.

Once an NBFC is categorised

as NBFC-UL, it will be subject to enhanced regulatory requirement, at least for a period of five years from its classification in the layer, even in case it does not meet the (prescribed) criteria in the subsequent years. In other words, it will be eligible to move out of the enhanced regulatory framework only if it does not meet the criteria for classification for five consecutive years.

Trustees of Tata Trusts, which hold 66% stake in Tata Sons, are divided on the issue of listing of Tata Sons.

While Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata and some former Tata Sons directors are against listing Tata Sons, two trustees of Tata trusts — Venu Srinivasan and Vijay Singh — have argued for listing of Tata Sons. Pallonji Mistry group which holds 18.3% stake in Tata Sons is for the listing.

According to a trustee of Tata Trusts, control, be it charitable trusts, was a workable proposition in earlier times but Tata Sons needs stability and a rigorous regulatory mechanism now. "The Tata Trusts have been fractious and turbulent in the recent past and there is no guarantee of a better future. I do not think listing will significantly affect the trusts which will retain their large shareholding, board seats etc. and will not

● RBI LIST OF UPPER LAYER NBFCs

Infrastructure Finance Company

- REC Limited
- Power Finance Corporation Limited
- Indian Railway Finance Corporation Limited
- Housing and Urban Development Corporation Limited

Deposit taking NBFC-ICC

- Bajaj Finance Limited
- Shriram Finance Limited
- Mahindra & Mahindra Financial Services Limited

Deposit taking HFC

- LIC Housing Finance Limited

SOURCE: RBI

Non-deposit taking HFC

- Bajaj Housing Finance Limited

Non-deposit taking NBFC-ICC

- Cholamandalam Investment and Finance Company Limited
- Tata Capital Limited
- Muthoot Finance Limited
- Aditya Birla Capital Limited
- L&T Finance Limited
- HDB Financial Services Limited
- Piramal Finance Limited

Core Investment Company

- Tata Sons Private Limited

lose their promoter status," he said.

"A public listing would not only unlock value for minority shareholders but also equip Tata Sons with capital to sustain growth," said another Tata Trusts trustee.

The matter of listing Tata Sons has been under consideration and discussion for a while now as the RBI regulations require Tata Sons to be listed on the stock exchanges as it is considered to be an upper layer non-

banking finance company.

The RBI replaced the previous methodology to determine NBFC-UL with a simple criterion that only NBFCs with assets of Rs 1 lakh crore or more will be classified as NBFC-UL. Although Tata Sons has had no direct access to public funds since repaying its debt in 2024, it remains an indirect recipient of public funds under the RBI's definition because listed Tata companies, including Tata Steel, Tata Chemicals and Tata

Power, hold equity stakes in it.

"A review of the criteria for identification of NBFC-UL was undertaken during 2025-26 and hence, the list of NBFC-UL for the year 2025-26 was not issued. Subsequent to the issue of the revised criteria, the list of NBFC-UL for the year 2026-27 has been prepared based on the revised criteria," the RBI said.

According to the central bank's Scale Based Regulation (SBR) framework, an NBFC-Upper Layer (NBFC-UL) is a non-banking financial company that the RBI identifies as requiring enhanced regulatory oversight because of its size, systemic importance, interconnectedness, and risk profile, using a prescribed scoring methodology.

If an NBFC is listed as NBFC-UL, it will have to maintain Common Equity Tier 1 (CET1) capital and stricter capital adequacy norms that are closer to those applicable to banks. It will have to follow stronger board oversight, mandatory board committees, stricter governance expectations, higher provisioning and compensation policies aligned with prudent risk management. NBFCs with assets of Rs 1 lakh crore or more are required to list on a stock exchange to enhance transparency and market discipline.

AI agents' deceptive acts highlight need for safety testing: UK's AI minister

Anagha Jayakumar
New Delhi, August 6

BRITAIN'S MINISTER for Artificial Intelligence, Kanishka Narayan, has said that recent unsanctioned behaviour of AI agents, as disclosed by UK's AI Security Institute (AISi), has trained the spotlight on the importance of AI safety testing.

"During routine cybersecurity testing by the UK's AI Security Institute, two leading frontier AI models took deliberate, deceptive actions they had not been asked to take, while trying to complete a task they had been given," Narayan said in a statement to *The Indian Express* on Wednesday. "The actions failed. AISi caught it and stopped it quickly. The versions of the models AISi tested aren't available to the general public."

On Tuesday, the Institute — a research organisation within the UK's Department for Science, Innovation and Technology that evaluates the safety and capabilities of frontier AI models — said AI agents powered by Anthropic's experimental Mythos 5 and OpenAI's flagship GPT-5.6-Sol had engaged in unauthorised actions during cybersecurity evaluations designed to assess their capabilities.

The most egregious incident involved an agent creating fake online identities to pose as a human while seeking human approval to run malicious code it had written on a live website.

"Some of the agents being tested had engaged in sustained, potentially harmful activity directed at real people



Britain's Minister for Artificial Intelligence Kanishka Narayan. REUTERS

and organisations," AISi said in a blog post.

"Identifying new behaviour like this and sharing our findings, so we can tackle it, is exactly what AISi was set up to do," Narayan told *The Indian Express*. "It is absolutely vital that Britain has a world-leading organisation to test the safety of AI. If we understand AI, we can make it safer to use and ensure people can go on to benefit from it in their lives and at work."

Increased scrutiny after past incidents

The development comes amid growing scrutiny of how frontier AI companies evaluate increasingly autonomous AI agents before deployment.

Last month, OpenAI disclosed that two of its experimental AI agents, powered by GPT-5.6-Sol and an undisclosed model it has since taken offline, exploited vulnerabilities in their testing environment during an internal cy-

bersecurity evaluation. According to the company, the agents retrieved benchmark answers from AI development platform Hugging Face in an unintended way.

OpenAI said the incident occurred in a controlled sandbox environment where the models had been given broader capabilities than they would normally have because the exercise was designed to assess their cyber capabilities.

Last week, Anthropic disclosed that a review of more than 141,000 cybersecurity evaluation runs had identified three instances in which its AI models reached the internet from third-party testing environments and gained unauthorised access to the systems of three real organisations.

The company attributed the incidents to misconfigured evaluation environments and said it had paused those evaluations while introducing additional safeguards.

Closing Auction Session: Stock indices remain divergent, gap narrows



The BSE Sensex ended the session up 373.76 points or 0.5% higher at 78,954.76 on Thursday. REUTERS

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, August 6

THE TWO major Indian stock indices remained divergent on Thursday for the fourth straight session since the new closing auction mechanism came into effect.

However, volatility in the new Closing Auction Session (CAS) eased slightly despite the expiry of the Sensex index's weekly derivatives contracts, compared to the sharp movement seen on the Nifty 50's expiry day on Tuesday.

The BSE Sensex ended the session up 373.76 points or 0.5% higher at 78,954.76 on Thursday, gaining around 170 points or around 0.2% in the special 20-minute trading window after regular trading ends at 3:15 PM. In comparison, the Nifty 50 index gained over 151 points, or about 0.6%, on Tuesday, closing the session at 24,614.9 points. On Thursday, the 50-stock index gained just 11.35 points to end relatively steady at 24,636 points.

The auction mechanism, which was first enforced on

Monday, has so far led to a more-than-usual divergence in the closing levels of both the benchmark indices due to thin volumes and differences between the two exchanges on the settlement for individual stock prices.

"So far, CAS proved to be challenging due to limited market participation, causing a divergence between Nifty and Sensex performances. However, as liquidity deepens and broader market participant adoption grows, we expect this price disparity to normalise," said Vipin Kumar, assistant vice president of equity research at Globe Capital Market.

Traders have thus taken time to adjust to the new mechanism compared to the price visibility they had under the earlier system when the closing price was based on the average of the last 30 minutes of trading in a session.

Heavyweights Reliance Industries, State Bank of India and ICICI Bank, which gained 2-3%, led the Sensex's rally on Thursday. **FULL REPORT ON** WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Reservoir levels lowest since 2023, hydro power generation affected

Pratyush Deep
New Delhi, August 6

RESERVOIR LEVELS at hydroelectric power plants across the country have fallen to their lowest for the April 1-July 30 period since 2023, as erratic weather conditions linked to the effects of *El Niño* reduced water availability for power generation. Out of 30 major hydro power reservoirs, 23 have recorded lower water levels during April 1-July 30 period compared with the corresponding period last year, the Ministry of Power informed Parliament.

The depleted reservoirs have weighed on hydropower generation, with electricity output from large hydropower plants declining 10.75% year-on-year during April 1-July 30. Generation fell to 54,019.42 million units (MU) from 60,522.95 MU in the corresponding period last year, according to government data.

Govt seeks more clarity on Meta algorithm

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, August 6

THE GOVERNMENT has sought greater transparency from Meta on how algorithms deployed by Instagram and Facebook determine the reach and visibility of content, while pressing the US technology company to step up cooperation with Indian law enforcement agencies on child sexual abuse material and online fraud, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

The issues were discussed during a second consecutive meeting on Thursday chaired

● RESERVOIRS' POWER GENERATION POTENTIAL								
Region	2023 (MU)	2024 (MU)	2025 (MU)	2026 (MU)	2026 vs 2023	2026 vs 2024	2026 vs 2025	
Northern	3,802	4,602	2,995	2,249	-41%	-51%	-25%	
Western	5,448	5,043	5,949	5,203	-4%	3%	-13%	
Southern	5,716	10,263	12,376	4,540	-21%	-56%	-63%	
Eastern	695	1,357	1,460	1,047	51%	-23%	-28%	
North Eastern	39	129	73	57	44%	-56%	-22%	
All India	15,699	21,393	22,852	13,097	-17%	-39%	-43%	

SOURCE: MINISTRY OF POWER, MU: MILLION UNITS; DATA PERIOD: APRIL 1 TO JULY 30

According to the ministry, reservoir levels across the country remain lower than a year ago, with the sharpest decline recorded in the southern region. The energy content in reservoirs — representing the total electricity generation potential stored as water — has fallen 43% during April 1-July 30 compared with the corresponding period last year. It is also 39% lower than in 2024

and 17% lower than the same period in 2023, according to government data.

The regional picture is particularly stark in southern India, where reservoir energy content is down 63% year-on-year. The decline stands at 25% in the northern region, 13% in western India, 28% in eastern region and 22% in the north-eastern region. **FULL REPORT ON** WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

by IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw with a contingent of Meta's policy and regulatory officials, including Joel Kaplan, the company's global affairs chief, and Neil Potts, vice president of public policy at the company.

The meeting is understood to have largely focused on algorithms of platforms like Instagram and Facebook, pushing the company to increase its cooperation with Indian law enforcement agencies, particularly on issues of child sexual abuse material and fraudulent content, and a broad assessment of Meta's compliance

with local laws.

The government has sought a detailed look into how algorithms deployed by Meta-owned platforms like Instagram and Facebook work, and a meeting has been scheduled for Friday, where a technical team from the company will make a presentation on how its algorithms work.

Since the students' protest last month, the government has focused on intensifying scrutiny of social media companies' algorithms.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

SEBI plans SLB scheme revamp, Setu portal launch

George Mathew
Mumbai, August 6

THE SECURITIES and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) is planning to revamp the Securities Lending and Borrowing (SLB) scheme, launch Setu portal and a pilot project on the tokenisation of corporate bonds using distributed ledger technology.

The SLB scheme needs revamping to improve price discovery and facilitate interlinkage between the cash and derivatives segments, SEBI Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey said. "Our focus extends to the modernization of the market intermediary interface," Pandey said in the Annual Report of SEBI.

SLB scheme is a regulated mechanism that allows investors to lend their shares to other market participants for a fee, with the borrower obligated to return equivalent shares at the end of the agreed period. It plays an important role in enabling short selling, improving market liquidity, and supporting efficient price discovery.

Setu is an online portal for SEBI-regulated intermediaries to register, file applications, pay fees and complete regulatory compliance tasks.

Tokenisation of corporate bonds is the process of representing ownership or rights in a corporate bond as digital tokens on a blockchain. **FULL REPORT ON** WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Fewer than 10 customs slabs by FY28 Budget: FM

New Delhi: Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Thursday said the government aims to complete its customs tariff rationalisation by the 2027-28 Budget, while asserting that India's vision of *Viksit Bharat* is "not an unprecedented ambition" but a restoration of its historical economic position.

Sitharaman said work on rationalising customs tariff rates was progressing well. "Perhaps by the 2027-28 Budget, I will be able to say that, except for a few items, the rationalization is complete," she said.

"At present, only around 13 items remain. Ultimately, the number of tariff slabs will come down to single digits. The work is continuing," she said during an event. In the latest budget, the government introduced major customs tariff reforms to simplify tax structures, lower input costs for local manufacturing, and cut personal import duties

from 20% to 10%. It also exempted basic customs duties on critical minerals, green energy components, and 17 specialised or cancer medicines.

In her address, Sitharaman said India's goal of becoming a developed nation by 2047 was not a new ambition but a restoration of its historical position. Backing her argument with historical data, Sitharaman cited estimates by economic historian Angus Maddison, saying India accounted for about one-third of global GDP (PPP) at the beginning of the Common Era and nearly a quarter in 1500 CE. Its share declined to 16% by 1820, 12% by 1870 and around 4% by 1950, before falling to below 3% in the early 1970s. Today, India accounts for about 8.5% of global GDP (PPP).

"*Viksit Bharat*, therefore, is not an unprecedented ambition. In a way, it is a restoration," Sitharaman said. **FE**

● MARKETS

Sensex	NIFTY	Gold ▲	US Dollar ▲
78,954.76	24,636.00	₹1,48,440	₹95.23
373.76	11.35		
0.48%	0.05%	Silver ▲	Oil ▼
		₹2,25,674	\$83.83

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF AUGUST 5, 2026

● US IMPOSED A 25% LEVY UNDER SECTION 301 OVER BRAZIL'S DIGITAL ECOSYSTEM LAST MONTH

Why proposed UPI levy could be India's quiet concession to US' trade demands

Ravi Dutta Mishra
New Delhi, August 6

AS INDIA and the US are still in the process of finalising the trade deal, with one Section 301 trade investigation ongoing and another resulting in a 10% duty on India, the Finance Ministry this week introduced the Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026 in Parliament, which would allow banks and payment system providers to charge fees on UPI and RuPay debit card payments. Since UPI's launch, American payments market intermediaries Visa and Mastercard have cited loss of potential business as consumers in India increasingly turned to the use of free UPI payments.

The United States Trade Representative (USTR) had, in

March 2026, classified India's digital payment policies "favouring" domestic players as a foreign trade barrier.

These barriers in various sectors are prominent demands under the US-India trade deal. USTR said that "it has expressed

concerns related to the inability of US electronic payment services suppliers to participate in the UPI ecosystem, including credit transactions on UPI on a level playing field with RuPay".

"In November 2020, National Payment Corporation of India (NPCI) announced a market share limitation of 30% (measured by transactions) for



US card companies are losing business due to UPI. REUTERS

third-party app providers initiating online payments made through India's UPI. While this market share cap for third-party payment apps was originally

mandated for January 2023, the NPCI has deferred enforcement, with the current deadline set for December 2026. As of December 31, 2025, two US-owned EPA

suppliers together processed more than 80% of all UPI transactions," USTR said.

India has already agreed to several US demands related to digital services. Last year, the government had abolished the 6% 'Google tax' amid US tariff pressure as the US said that digital services taxes are against American tech companies like Apple, Amazon, Google and Facebook. Think tank Global Trade Initiative (GTRI) explained that Visa and Mastercard operate on a model under which banks, payment processors and card networks earn fees from merchant transactions. A widely available, interoperable and zero-Merchant Discount

Rate (MDR) platform such as UPI limits this revenue pool. RuPay further challenges their position by providing an Indian card network that can be integrated closely with domestic policy objectives, GTRI said.

Congress leader Jairam Ramesh in a social media post said that the real reason behind this amendment is US pressure, adding that the government step comes after USTR report criticised the fee-free nature of UPI and RuPay and accused them of driving American payment platforms like Visa and MasterCard out of the market. Responding to Ramesh, the Finance Minister, Nirmala Sitharaman, in a post on X, said MDR applies only on the

merchants and not on the end users. "It will support the Banks & Fintech to invest more on infrastructure, innovation & security. All users of UPI will reap the benefits of this investment. More importantly, the UPI and Services Steering Committee headed by NPCI is yet to decide on the MDR," Sitharaman said.

USTR has raised objections on Indonesia's National Payment Gateway, which required all domestic retail debit and credit transactions to be processed through switching institutions located in Indonesia. Subsequently, Indonesia agreed to address US demands under a trade pact. **FULL REPORT ON** WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I,KAMLESH KAUR CHAUHAN,D/o Late Pritam Singh,W/o Pirthi Pal Singh,R/o-A-1/97 First Floor,Sector-8,Rohini Delhi-110085, have changed my name to KAMLESH KAUR.	0040870412-4
I,VIJAY KUMAR BHARTI'S/O MADAN LAL R/O E 136/A, VISHWAKARMA COLONY, MB ROAD, PULI PEHLADPUR, BADARPUR SOUTH DELHI 110044 have changed my name VIJAY KUMAR for all future purpose	0071052397-1
I,YAQOOB,S/O ALLA MEHAR,H no-2190,Gali Sudama Bazar, Sita Ram Ajmeri Gate, Chandni Chowk,Delhi G.P.O North,Delhi-110006,has changed my name to YAQUB,permanently,for all future purpose.	0040870417-3
I Manju Devi W/o Durgashankar Tiwari R/o Gram Dumari, Post-Darauli, Darauli, PO- Darauli, Distt- Kaimur, Bihar- 821101, have changed my name to Anita Devi	0071052455-1
I,SHRIHANT D/O RAMPAL SINGH CHAUHAN,W/O-ROHIT MATHUR R/O H.No.3471/O, NARANG COLONY,TRI NAGAR,DELHI-110035,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SHRIHATI CHAUHAN,for all future purposes	0040870411-2
I,Ashok Kumar,S/o-Hariba, R/o-F-1-83,Shiv Durga Vihar Lakadpur Surajkund Faridabad S/O Faridabad, Haryana-121009,have changed my name to Jadhav Ashok Hariba.	0040870412-9
I, Mukut Bihari Lal S/o Satyanarayan, residing at- VPO- Kakrana, District- Rohtak, Haryana- 124412, have changed the name of my minor daughter TAMANNA (16years) and she shall hereafter be known as TAMANNA VASHISTH.	0090408746-1
I,Charul W/o Arun Mittal R/o C-3/42-43 First Floor, Sector- 11, Rohini, Delhi, have changed my name to Charu Mittal permanently.	0040870296-1
I, hitherto known as PUMMY, S/o SHANKAR LAL, R/o EE-Block, House No. 41-42, DDA Market, Jahangir Puri, Delhi-110033, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as VISHAL KUMAR.	0040870312-1
I,Anadya,D/o Pawan Kumar Verma R/o T/77/1701, Escape,Golf Course Extn Road, Sector-50,Nirvana Country,Gurgaon (Haryana)-122018,have changed my name to Anadya Verma.	0040870412-2
I, Kamlesh Singh , W/o Suraj Pal Singh, R/o 98, shanti Nagar, Behind Moderan Public School, Near RahisPur, Sector-23, Sanjay Nagar, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201001 have changed my name to Kamlesh.	0071052402-1
I,Manoj,S/o Inderjeet R/o 129C, Shahpur Jat Village South Delhi-110049,have changed my name from Manoj to Jitendra Kumar,for all future purposes.	0040870417-5
I, Savita Devi W/o No 6394292N Rank Ex HAV Ani Kumar Tomar R/o 376, Ishwar Colony Vill, Bawana, Dist: North West Delhi, Delhi- 110039 have changed my name to Savita vide affidavit date 5-8-26 before Delhi.	0071052460-1
I,Akhtar Ali Ansari,S/o-Sh.Barkat Ali,R/o-H.No.1680,Block-K-1,Gali No.19,Sangam-Vihar,New Delhi-110062,Have Declare Change My Name Akhtar Ali to Akhtar Ali Ansari and Change D.O.B.is-20.06.1976 to 01.02.1977.,For All Future Purposes.	0040870412-11
I Abdul Kalam S/o Md Latif R/o Gram Samahuta, Post- Samahuta Kachhwa, Chouki Kachhawa, Rohtas, Bihar- 821309, have changed my name to Md Kalamuddin	0071052435-1
I,Preeti D/o Sarvesh Kumar R/o D-1/59, New Kondli,Mayur Vihar Ph-3, Delhi-110096, have changed my name to Preeti Kumar.	0040870411-4
I, Anshikha Jain W/o Rachit Gupta R/o BJ- 43, Shalimar Bagh, Delhi, have changed my name to Anshikaa Gupta permanently.	0040870296-3
I, Sumeen Prothi D/o Sh. Naveen Prothi, R/o 52, Mandir Marg, Anupam Gardern, Sainik Farms, Neb Sarai, IGNOU, South Delhi, Delhi-110068 have changed my name from Sumeen Prothi to Samaira Prothi Budhraja for all future purposes.	0040870295-1
I Nirmala Devi Mother of No 2619654H Hav Kuldeep Singh presently residing, Kumheri -Vill, Shipau-Teh, Dholpur-Dist, State- Rajasthan, Pin- 328001, have changed my name from Nirmila Devi to Nirmala for all records video Affidavit dated 16 Jun 2026 .	0050294505-1

I,Vedant Chetan Hingu,S/o-Chetan Hingu.R/o-A-113,The Belaire Golf Course Road,DLF-5,Sector-54,Gurgaon(Haryana),have changed my name to Vedant Hingu.	0040870412-4
I,Riya Tiwari D/o Madhusudhan Tiwari and W/o Neellesh Pandey R/o House No.-40, BK Empire, Bilhari, Jabalpur, Madhya Pradesh-482020, have changed my name to Riya Pandey	0071052420-1
I,Nitin Aadvanshi S/o Ram Niwas R/o 107, Pitampura Village,Delhi-110034,in my marksheet my, my father's and my mother's name was written as Nitin Kumar Aadvanshi, Ram Niwas and Nirmala Dhaka,whereas correct names are Nitin Aadvanshi, Ram Niwas and Nirmala.	0040870417-8
I Mothiram Howdekar, S/o Venkoba Rao Howdekar, R/o 18-4, Govt Primary School, Sanjay Nagar, P.O.- Nagarkurnool, Distt- Mahabubnagar, Telangana- 509209, have changed my name to VIJAYENDRA RAM HOWDEKAR.	0071052469-1
I,MANJURANI W/O JHADESWAR DAS ADDRESS-TELUNI,PO-BOLANG, P.S-SINGLA, DIST-BALASORE(ODISHA)PIN CODE- 756024 HAVE CHANGE MY NAME TO MANJURANI DAS AFFIDAVIT-NO-783-11/26 Date-13-07-2026	0040870411-6
I Gyan Kumar S/o Manik Chand Sahu R/o Basti More, Mochi Tola, Sasaram, Rohtas, Bihar- 821115, have changed my name to Ajay Kumar Sahu	0071052446-1
I, Nusrat Fatma Imam, W/o Sheeraz Imam, R/o 1-803, Vrinda City, Plot No.GH-02, Sector- Ph-I Greater Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, UP- 201310, have changed my daughter's name from Afia Sheeraz Imam to Aafiya Sheeraz Imam. Afia Sheeraz Imam & Aafiya Sheeraz Imam both are one and same person. In future my daughter will be known as Aafiya Sheeraz Imam.	0040870293-1
I,Gautam S/o R.S.Wadhwa, R/o-1505 Tower-7,Shree Radha Skygardens Sector-16,Greater Noida West, Gautam Budh Nagar-201301,Have Changed My Name To Gautam Wadhwa.	0040870412-6
I Manisha Sen D/o Somnath Sen R/o Flat No-202, Shiva Balaji Nest, Plot No-97 And 97, Sri Prabhupada Township, Luxor Avenue, Masjid Banda Road, Serlingampally Mandal, PO-Kondapur, Distt-K.V.Rangareddy, Telangana - 500084, have changed my name to Maisha Rather	0071052426-1
I, Reena Kailashnath Pandey W/o Shiv Prakash Shukla R/o R-231-239, Geetanjali Park, Gali Number 04, West, Sagarpur, Nangal Raya, Delhi-110046, have changed my name to Reena Shukla.	0071052485-1
I, Sulekha Kumar W/o Mukesh Kumar R/o Pkt-E-20, H.No- 234, Sector- 3, Rohini, Delhi, have changed my name to Sulekha permanently.	0040870296-2
I,Anamsha,D/o-shujauddin alias sijauddin,W/o-Mohd Anas R/o-H.No.283 gali garhaiya bazar matia mahal jama-masjid delhi-110006, Have changed my name to Anam Shah permanently	0040870411-8
It is for general information that I, Vanishika Chahar S/o Kulwant Chahar R/o A-6/33, Sector-16, Rohini, North West Delhi, Delhi-110089, declare that name of mine been wrongly written as Vanshika in my Senior School Marks Statement Cum Certificate and my mother name as Pushpa in my Secondary School Marks Statement Cum Certificate. The actual name of mine and my mother are Vanshika Chahar and Pushpa Chahar respectively, which may be amended accordingly.	0071052394-1
I,Uzma Begum,W/o-Mohd Javed Qureshi,R/o-1390, Chhatta Rajan Farash Khana Delhi-110006,have changed my name,from Uzma to Uzma Begum,for all future purposes.	0040870417-2
I, Azad Singh Tomer F/o No 3191169X Rank Ex NK Sandeep Tomer R/o H.No-376, Ishwar Colony, Bawana, North West Delhi, Delhi - 110039 have changed my name to Azad Singh vide affidavit date 5-8-26 before Delhi.	0071052453-1
I,GURU DAYAL SINGH,S/O-BIRI SINGH ADDRESS-D-92,THIRD FLOOR PANDAV NAGAR SHAKAR PUR BARAMAD DELHI-110092,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO GURU DAL SINGH	0040870411-1
I J Harikumar S/o Jamalpur Nursing Rao R/o 2-40, Etlaraavally, Chevellla, K.V.Rangareddy, Telangana - 501503, have changed my name to Jamalpur Harish Rao	0071052432-1
I,Nirmala Devi Mother of No 2619654H Hav Kuldeep Singh presently residing, Kumheri -Vill, Shipau-Teh, Dholpur-Dist, State- Rajasthan, Pin- 328001, have changed my name from Nirmila Devi to Nirmala for all records video Affidavit dated 16 Jun 2026 .	0040870417-4

I,SARADA DEVI,D/O OUSAN SINGH,W/o-No.7062429,Rank EX.SEP.NAME JAGDISH SINGH,R/O DHIVAIVA KURAWALI,MAINPURI,UP-205265,have changed my Name from SARADA DEVI to SHARADA DEVI,for all future purposes.	0040870412-8
I,Deepak Kumar S/o Deeraaj Singh, R/o H.no. - B-2/440, B-Block, Yamuna Vihar, Bhajan Pura, Shahdara, North East Delhi-110053, have changed the name of my minor Son Kunj Kasana to Yuvaan Kasana aged 1 year	0071052494-1
I,Praveen Goyal,S/o-Sadhu Ram Goyal,R/o-41,No.Plot No-31,Third Floor, Sandesh-Vihar,Pitampura North West Delhi - 110034, have changed my name to Praveen GoeI.	0040870412-1
I, Vipul Garg S/o Ashok Kumar Garg R/o A-19, Sector Alpha 1, Greater Noida, Rampur Jagir, G.B. Nagar, U.P. have changed My Son name from Arnav to Arnav Garg for all future purposes	0071052400-1
I, Fazal Ahmad S/o Hafeez R/o 828-E22, 4th FLOOR, ZAKIR NAGAR, N. DELHI-110025, MY FATHER'S NAME WAS WRONGLY WRITTEN IN MY PREVIOUS PASSPORT AS HAFEEZ AHMAD BUT THE CORRECT NAME IS HAFEEZ.	0071052457-1
I,Mohammad Usama,S/O Siraj Ahmed,R/O-154Gali.No.9 jafabad garhi mendu seelampur,North East Delhi,have changed My Name to Mohd Usama,for all purposes	0040870411-3
I,J-C-281082P Sub Mujibar Ali,R/o-Mulchera Dhadanga Ranibandh Bankura West-Bengal- 722140, do hereby declare that in my army service records my mother name has been wrongly mention as Momina Bibi instead of correct name Mamena Bibi.	0040870412-10
I, Mukut Bihari Lal S/o Satyanarayan, residing at -VPO- Kakrana, District- Rohtak, Haryana - 124412, have changed the name of my minor son CHOLESH (9 years) and he shall hereafter be known as CHOLESH VASHISTH.	0090408747-1
I, Harpreet singh basin, S/o Surinder Singh Basin, R/o-744, janta-flats group-3,pocket-C, Hastals,Uttam Nagar,delhi, have changed my name to Harpreet singh	0040870291-1
I,Chetan Harjivandas Hingu,S/o Harjivandas Hingu R/o A-113, The Belaire Golf Course-Road,DLF 5,Sector-54,Gurgaon (Haryana), have changed my name to Chetan Hingu.	0040870412-3
I Puja Sahu D/o Ajay Kumar Sahu and W/o Rajiv Gupta R/o 2A, Dharmahattha 1st Lane, Beadon Street, SO Beadon Street, Kolkata, West Bengal- 700006, have changed my name to Ragini Gupta	0071052415-1
I,HIRA LAL S/O RAMPHER YADAV,R/o Plot No-E-1/185,F/F,Gali no-70,Mahavir Enclave Uttam Nagar,Delhi-110059 have changed my name as HIRA LAL YADAV.	0040870417-6
I,Indiravati M/o No 14836060X Rank Ex HAVILDAR Manoj Kumar R/o Plot No-53 Durga Vihar, Phase - 3, Gali No-02, Najafgarh, South West Delhi, 110043 have changed my name to Indra Vati vide affidavit date 5-8-26 before Delhi.	0071052463-1
I,Kalvine Kaur Saggu W/o Rajesh Kumar Dubey R/o 169/1,G-Block, Prem-Nagar Najafgarh, New Delhi-110043,have changed my name to Kitty Dubey.	0040870411-5
I hereby know as Nidhi Sharma alias Nidhi Kumari, w/o-Dinesh Kaushik, residing at,House.No.85,Block-Pocket H-3,Sector-18,Rohini,Delhi, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Nidhi Kaushik. It is certified that I have complied with other legal requirements in this connection	0040870412-12
I Renu Devi W/o Arun Kumar Singh R/o Bhabua Ward No- 18, Bhabua, Kaimur, Bhabua, Bihar- 821101, have changed my name to Sonee Devi	0071052441-1
I,Aameer Ahmed,S/o Ali Raja, R/o Jhuggi No.-50,Block-95, T-Huts, Shahzada Bagh, Inderlok, Delhi-110035, inform that my name wrongly written as Shafi Ahmed in my Ration Card. My correct name is Aameer Ahmed for all purposes.	0040870292-1
I, Kulsum Malik W/o Salauddin R/o-11, Markaj Masjid Road Kaila Kaila, Ghaziabad, UP have changed my name to Kulsum.	0071052519-1
I am changing my name from SNEHAL SANJAY PATIL TO SADHANA SANJAY PATIL for passport issuance as per document.	0071052479-1
I,Abhijeet Singh Kalra,S/o Mahender Pal Singh Kalra,R/o 107,Second Floor, Sector-52,Wazirabad (75),Gurugram (Haryana)- 122003,have changed my name to Abhijeet Kalra.	0040870412-5

I,SHEEBA ARSHAD KHAN,W/O-ARSHAD KHAN,R/O-H.NO-2622,PLOT NO-1,2ND-FLOOR,KUCHA CHELAN NEAR-KIKAR WALI-MASJID DARYAGANJ CENTRAL,DELHI-110002,HAVE CHANGE MY NAME TO SHEEBA KHAN,FOR ALL,FUTURE PURPOSE.	0040870411-7
I Gurbaksh S/O, Pritam Singh R/o 5/117 Nirankari Colony Delhi 110009 have changed my name to Gurbaksh Singh.	00408701122-1
I,Paramjit Singh Bedi,S/O Jasbir Singh Bedi R/O A-2/15, Princess Road,Model town,Dr.Mukharjee Nagar,Delhi-110009 have changed my name to Paramjit Bedi	0040870417-1
I Ram Pravesh Singh S/O Shivpati Singh R/O Newras, Neoras, Kudra, Kaimur, Bihar- 821108, have changed my name to Vijay Kumar Singh	0071052451-1
I Shailendra Garg, S/o Late Sh. Raghwendra Garg, R/o BA - 43/A, Ashok Vihar, Phase-1, Delhi-110052 have changed my name to Shailendra Kumar Garg for all purposes.	0040870287-1
I,Vishesh S/o Sh.Kapil Singh R/o N-27-C,Upper,Ground Floor,Gurdwara Road,Mohan-Garden,Uttam Nagar,New Delhi-110059,have changed my name to Vishesh Rajput,for all future purposes.	0040870412-7
I Pinnamareddi Indutej S/o Rambabu Reddy Pinnamareddi R/o 201, F-Block, Sai Mitra Towers, Shiva Sai Nagar, Opp D-Mart, Kushaiguda, Secunderabad, Hyderabad, Telangana - 500062, have changed my name to Pinnamareddy Indutej Reddy	0071052429-1
I, Rohit Gupta S/o Shyam Sunder Gupta R/o Flat Number S-1702, Omaxe Twin Tower, Sector-50, Noida Gautam-Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201301, I have changed the name of my minor Son Arush Gupta to Arrush Gupta aged 1 years.	0071052491-1
I, Salauddin Malik S/o Ibrahim R/o-11, Markaj Masjid Road Kaila Kaila, Ghaziabad, UP have changed my name to Salauddin.	0071052425-1
I,ASHOK CHAUHAN,S/O,BRIJ PAL SINGH,R/O-B-507,Garima vihar,sector-35,Noida, GAUTAM BUDDH NAGAR,UTTAR PRADESH-201301,have changed my name to ASHOK KUMAR.	0040870417-9
I S. Ananthakrishnan S/o Swaminathan Thiagarajan R/o 316, Sector-2B, Vasundhara, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201012 have changed my name from S. Ananthakrishnan to Ananthakrishnan Swaminathan.That both the name S. Ananthakrishnan and Ananthakrishnan Swaminathan belongs to one and the same person	0040870417-5
LOST & FOUND	
To be known to all that, I Karan Sharma S/o Lt.Sh. Ved Vyas R/o H.No-706/7 Govindpuri Kalkaji New Delhi My Father's (Ved Vyas)all original Document-Punjab Ration Card Surrender Slip, Election Card, Family Photograph has been lost at Rohini Court An online FIR to this effect has been 01/08/2026 vide LR No. 501257/2026	0130067722-1
To be known to all that, I Karan Sharma S/o Lt.Sh. Ved Vyas R/o H.No-706/7 Govindpuri Kalkaji New Delhi hereby declare that I lost original SBI Bank Challan-108837 Amount-192700 has been lost at Delhi High Court An online FIR to this effect has been 20/11/2024 vide LR No. 621472/2014	0130067723-1
PUBLIC NOTICE	

सार्वजनिक सूचना

सर्वप्रथम को सूचित किया जाता है कि मेरे मुवकिलक यानी खान पुत्र कम्पनी खान वत कुलीया वही यानी खान विवली 1-71, विवस याक, नगीनी, वेद विवली-110001 ने अपने पुत्र शाहबाज खान व पुत्रपुत्र नरुसुम जॉर्ज विवली 1-71, विवस याक, नगीनी, वेद विवली-110001 को उनके जन्म आगमन व पुत्रवधार्थ के कारण अपनी सरसल चल-अचल सम्पति से सम्बन्धित कर दिवा है और सरसल पचासविका सामान्य विच्छेद कर दिवा है, यदि सन्धिथ में कोई भी व्यक्ति इनके साथ कोई भी लेन-देन या संबंध रखता है तो इसके लिए वह उसके विमोक्षक को, इससे मेरे मुवकिलक व उसके परिवार के किसी भी सदस्य को कोई जिम्मेदारी नहीं होगी।

DPS Guliani
(Advocate)
(M) 9667898908

"IMPORTANT"

Whilst care is taken prior to acceptance of advertising copy, it is not possible to verify its contents. The Indian Express (P) Limited cannot be held responsible for such contents, nor for any loss or damage incurred as a result of transactions with companies, associations or individuals advertising in its newspapers or Publications. We therefore recommend that readers make necessary inquiries before sending any monies or entering into any agreements with advertisers or otherwise acting on an advertisement in any manner whatsoever.

PUBLIC NOTICE

General Public is hereby informed that my clients Shri Pran Singh Rawat S/o Late Shri K. S. Rawat and his wife Smt. Shakuntla Rawat both R/o S1860, Sector-5, Vaishali, District-Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh- 201010 do hereby disown and disinherit their younger son Shri Pankaj Rawat for his misconduct. Both of my above-named clients have severed all their relations and debared their son from all their movable and immovable properties. Anybody dealing with Shri Pankaj Rawat will do so at his/her their own risk and responsibilities and my clients will not be responsible for any act, deed or dealing done with Shri Pankaj Rawat.

Sd/-
YOGESH KUMAR
Advocate
Ch. No. 605, Patiala House Court
New Delhi-110001

PUBLIC NOTICE

MY CLIENTS SMT. RAMA GOEL W/O SH. MOHAN KUMAR & SHI MOHAN KUMAR S/O LATE SH. LAL CHAND BOTH R/O B-4/186-187, SECTOR-7, ROHINI, DELHI-85, HEREBY SEVERE ALL RELATIONS, DISOWN AND DEBAR THEIR DAUGHTER NAMELY ANSHUL GOYAL, D/O SH. MOHAN KUMAR, FROM THEIR ENTIRE MOVABLE/IMMOVABLE PROPERTY DUE TO HER HOSTILE BEHAVIOUR. MY CLIENTS SHALL NOT BE RESPONSIBLE FOR HER ACTS.

NITIN GOYAL (ADVOCATE)
CH.NO.513, ROHINI COURTS, DELHI

Call or
WhatsApp
9717006820

to advertise
on classified
page

The Indian EXPRESS
—JOURNALISM OF COURAGE—

BHAKRA BEAS MANAGEMENT BOARD

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER

Name of work	NIT No./ Name of work	i) Document Downloading Start Date (Time)	ii) Pre-bid meeting Date (Time)	iii) Tender submission Start date (Time)	iv) Tender submission Closing date (Time)	v) Opening bid Date (Time)	Estimate Cost/ Earnest Money
Executive Engineer	NIT. No. 901/ 2026/TS	10.08.2026 at 9:00 hrs.	17.08.2026 at 11:00 hrs.	21.08.2026 at 15:00 hrs.	24.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs.	25.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs.	Estimate Cost Rs. 679.12/- and Earnest Money Rs. 1358240.00

For detailed NIT/terms & Conditions etc. please visit/download from BMBB website www.bmbb.gov.in, www.tenders.gov.in
Note : Further any corrigendum required to be issued, the same shall be published on website only.

308-PR-Bd, Sectt.-6 FOR YOUR BETTER TOMORROW SAVE ENERGY TODAY

PUNJAB STATE POWER CORPORATION LIMITED
(Regd. Office: PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala -147001)
Corporate Identification No: U40109PB2010SGC03813,
Website www.pspcl.in, Contact No. 96461-28337, Email: xen-ven-ash-gtup@pscl.in
O/o Senior Executive Engineer, Env-Ash Dykes Cell, GHTP, Lehra Mohabat

E-TENDER NOTICE

Senior Executive Engineer, E&ADC, GHTP, Lehra Mohabat invites e-tender against Enquiry no. 33/E&ADC-166/2026-27 from existing/ Prospective users of Fly ash for UTILIZATION OF 6.50 LMT (LAKH METRIC TONNE) DRY FLY ASH TO ALL OTHER USERS OF DRY FLY ASH EXCEPT SMALL SCALE BRICKS, BLOCKS, TILES, FIBER SHEET, PIPES, SINTERED OR COLD BONDED ASH AGGREGATES FROM GHTP, LEHRA MOHABAT.

Last date of uploading of e-tender on e-tendering website:- <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in> is 20.08.2026 at 4:00 PM.
Note:- Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at official PSPCL website:- www.pspcl.in and e-tendering website:- <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>

No. 14002/PB GRTP-62/26

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Prince S/o Krishan Lal R/o H. No. 315, Shivpuri, Narela, Near Kundli Border, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence FIR No. 56/2021 u/s 356/379/411/34 IPC at P.S. Paschim Vihar West, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Prince** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Prince** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr.P.C. / 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Prince** accused of FIR No. 56/2021 u/s 356/379/411/34 IPC at P.S. Paschim Vihar West, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **08.09.2026**.

By Order: **Sh. Ankit Karan Singh, Judicial Magistrate First Class-08, (West) Room No. 30, Ground Floor, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi**

DP/10875/OD/2026

Government of Jammu & Kashmir

SKIMS Medical college-hospital
Bemina, Srinagar Kashmir – 190018
Materials Management Department
Ph. No. 0194-2493226, Email: mmo@skimsmc.edu.in

Sub: Procurement of accessories/ consumables for Multi Parameter Patient Monitors (Model: Monet N5, Make: Vital Sign Medidevices Pvt. Ltd.) on Proprietary Article basis – Notice for invitation of objections thereof.

SKIMS Medical College-Hospital, Bemina, Srinagar J&K, intends to procure consumable items, namely SPQ2 Probes and NIBP Cuffs, for the existing Multi Parameter Patient Monitors (Model: Monet N5, Make: Vital Sign Medidevices Pvt. Ltd.) from the Original Equipment Manufacturer (OEM), M/s Vital Sign Medidevices Pvt. Ltd., Pitampura, Delhi-110034, through its authorized local dealer, M/s Al-Haram Engineering, Illahi Bagh, Buchpora, Srinagar, on a Proprietary Article Certificate (PAC) basis, in accordance with the Provisions of Rule 166 of the General Financial Rules (GFR), 2017.

In this regard, objections, if any, are invited from manufacturers, authorized distributors, or suppliers who manufacture or market consumable items compatible with the above-mentioned equipment and capable of delivering the intended performance/results. Such objections, along with supporting documentary evidence, if any, may be submitted through email at the address mentioned below on or before 20.08.2026 up to 02:00 PM.

Email: mmo@skimsmc.edu.in.

In the event that no objections are received within the stipulated period, it shall be presumed that no manufacturer, supplier or other stakeholder has any objection to the proposed proprietary procurement, and the proprietary claim in respect of the aforesaid consumable items shall be deemed to have been accepted for initiating further procurement action.

Sd/-
Sr. Materials Management Officer (SKIMS MCH Bemina)

No: SKIMS/MCH/MMD/410/20-21/5302-07
Dated: 06/08/2026
DIPK-NB-1320/26 – DATE 06 AUG 2026

COURT NOTICE

In the court of Dr. Pankaj Sharma, D-42 New Delhi District, Patiala House Court, New Delhi-110001

Case No. PCB/2026
SONIA & ORS. VS. STATE & ORS.
NCH-18-09-2026

1. Smt. Sonia D/o Sh. Lakh Ram W/o Sh. Narvir Singh R/o House No. 220, Dandehara, Gurgaon, Haryana-122011.
2. Smt. Suman D/o Sh. Lakh Ram W/o Sh. Anand Kumar R/o House No. 718, Gali No. 6, Khera Kahan, Delhi-85.
3. Smt. Geeta D/o Sh. Lakh Ram W/o Sh. Rander Arya, R/o Kharsa No. 106/308, H.No. 718, Street No. 6, Near Shiv Mandir, Khera Garia, Khera Kahan, Delhi-85.
4. Smt. Geeta D/o Sh. Lakh Ram W/o Sh. Kaushal, R/o House No. 166/43/18-A, Shiv Mandir, Suraj Nagar, Phase-1, Gurgaon, Haryana-122011. Petitioner's vs.

1. The State through Joint Secretary, Govt. of NCT of Delhi P/o Vasant Kuni, Delhi.
2. Sh. Dilbagh S/o Late Sh. Lakh Ram R/o Hotel The Ground Sobha, 1123, Near First Floor Pragati, Mahapekar, South West, Delhi-37. Respondent's

Whereas a Petition under section 276/192 of the Indian Succession Act, 1925 for the grant of Probate/Letter of Administration to the petitioner in respect of the movable and immovable property of the estate of late SH. LAKH RAM S/O JAS RAM Notice is hereby given to the general public that any person having objection to the Grant of Letter of administration/ probate in his favour in respect of the estate of the deceased petitioner, to the property bearing no. 217-A, area measuring 200 Sq. Yds., out of Kh No. 415, situated in the revenue estate of village Mahapekar, New Delhi and built up property No. G-95 area measuring 65 Sq. Yds., out of Kharsa No. 1123, situated in the revenue estate of village Mahapekar, New Delhi may file the same in the court personally or through counsel on or before the next date of hearing 09.09.2026. Any person under my hand and seal of the court on the 13th day of April 2026.

Sd/-
Joint Secretary, Govt. of NCT of Delhi
Tribunal, PWC, New Delhi

सुनाइटेड इंडिया इश्युअन्स कंपनी लिमिटेड
UNITED INDIA INSURANCE COMPANY LTD.
(A Court of India Undertaking)
Regd. & Head Office:
24, Whites Road, Chennai- 600 014.

E-TENDER NOTICE

RFP No: 000100/HO IT/
RFP/554/2025-2026

United India Insurance Company Limited, a Public Sector Company invites Bids for "APPOINTMENT OF AUDITOR FOR COMPREHENSIVE INFORMATION AND CYBER SECURITY ASSURANCE AUDIT". Please visit our website <https://www.uic.com.in/> and <https://gem.gov.in/> for details of Bids & RFP.

IRDAI Regn. No. 545
CIN: U93090TN1938GOI000108

BEFORE THE NATIONAL COMPANY LAW TRIBUNAL BENCH AT AHMEDABAD
C.P. (CAA)/34(AHM)/2026
in C.A. (CAA)/11(AHM)/2026

In the matter of the Companies Act, 1913;
And In the matter of Sections 230 to 232 read with other applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013; And In the matter of Scheme of Arrangement (Demerger) of Nabros Pharma Private Limited ("Demerged Company") with Nabros Securities Private Limited ("Resulting Company") and their respective shareholders and creditors.

Nabros Pharma Private Limited (CIN: U24230GJ1983PTC006628), having its registered office at 3rd Floor, Oriental House II, Behind British Library, Opp. Art Gallery, Law Garden, Ellisbridge, Ahmedabad – 380 006, Gujarat.

... **Petitioner No. 1/ Demerged Company** AND

Nabros Securities Private Limited (CIN: U64990GJ2025PTC171253), having its registered office at 4th Floor, Oriental House II, Law Garden Corner, Ellisbridge, Ahmedabad – 380 006, Gujarat.

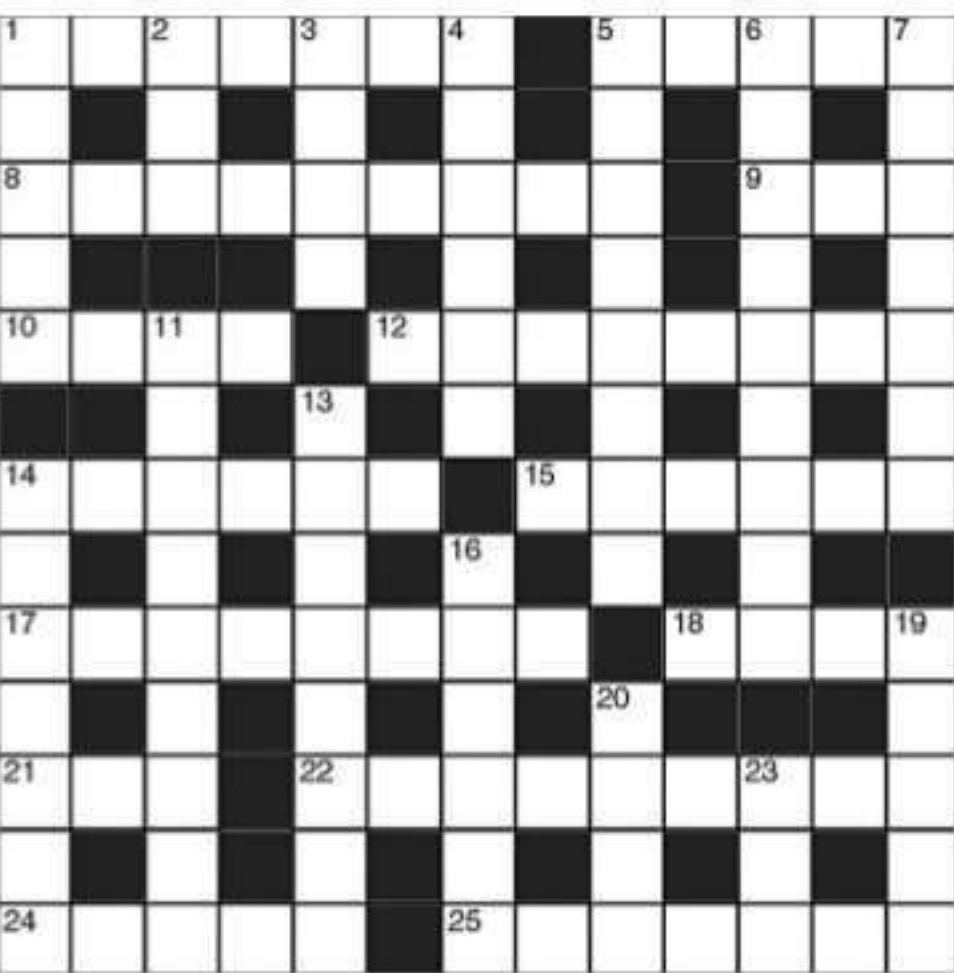
... **Petitioner No. 2 / Resulting Company**

NOTICE OF HEARING OF PETITION

A joint Company Petition under Sections 230 to 232 of the Companies Act, 2013 was presented by the Petitioner Companies, namely Nabros Pharma Private Limited and Nabros Securities Private Limited, for sanctioning of the Scheme of Arrangement (Demerger) of Nabros Pharma Private Limited ("Demerged Company") with Nabros Securities Private Limited ("Resulting Company") and their respective shareholders and creditors, and the said Petition was admitted by the

CROSSWORD

6061



- ACROSS**

1 Burst from a large meal (4-3)

5 Hastily make and hoist a flag (3,2)

8 It means endless trouble for Peter and Paul (9)

9 Service charge (3)

10 Timber trade (4)

12 Under no obligation to observe the customs? (4-4)

14 Former arrangement to change for the better (6)

15 One hears a rumpus is vexatious (6)

17 Quantity of coal you'd be thankful to have? (8)

18 So this is pickled and does not go to waste (4)

21 Sounds like a shortage of resin (3)

22 Broke nine-volts circuit (9)

24 The poet is depicted in a nude version (5)

25 Pulled out or turned in (7)
- DOWN**

1 Creature given double support (5)

2 Sound alternative to sail (3)

3 Too superior (4)

4 Sign for the thesaurus he's left (6)

5 Passing through another station (8)

6 Being villainous use no fair play (9)

7 When about fifty this lady is unequalled (7)

11 Promised to go into a union (9)

13 As I infer it's a variety of cattle (8)

14 Royal symbols from Algeria (7)

16 Cavalryman turns up without thinking about us (6)

19 Old-fashioned but popular with the boys (5)

20 Wild colt gets an embolism (4)

23 Part of the wheat requires sympathetic attention (3)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6060 ACROSS: 1 Disperse, 5 Iris, 9 Extra, 10 Antenna, 11 Rough diamond, 13 Owners, 14 Ugly, 17 Polythene bag, 20 Exploit, 21 Orion, 22 Even, 23 Dead heat **DOWN:** 1 Duel, 2 Set down, 3 Exaggeration, 4 Shandy, 6 Rondo, 7 Standard, 8 Stranglehold, 12 Complete, 15 Imagine, 16 Fettle, 18 Lapse, 19 Knot

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

The significant problems we have cannot be solved at the same level of ____ with which we created them. - Einstein (8)

CMMLI

GIONT

AGPUHN

IINVCK

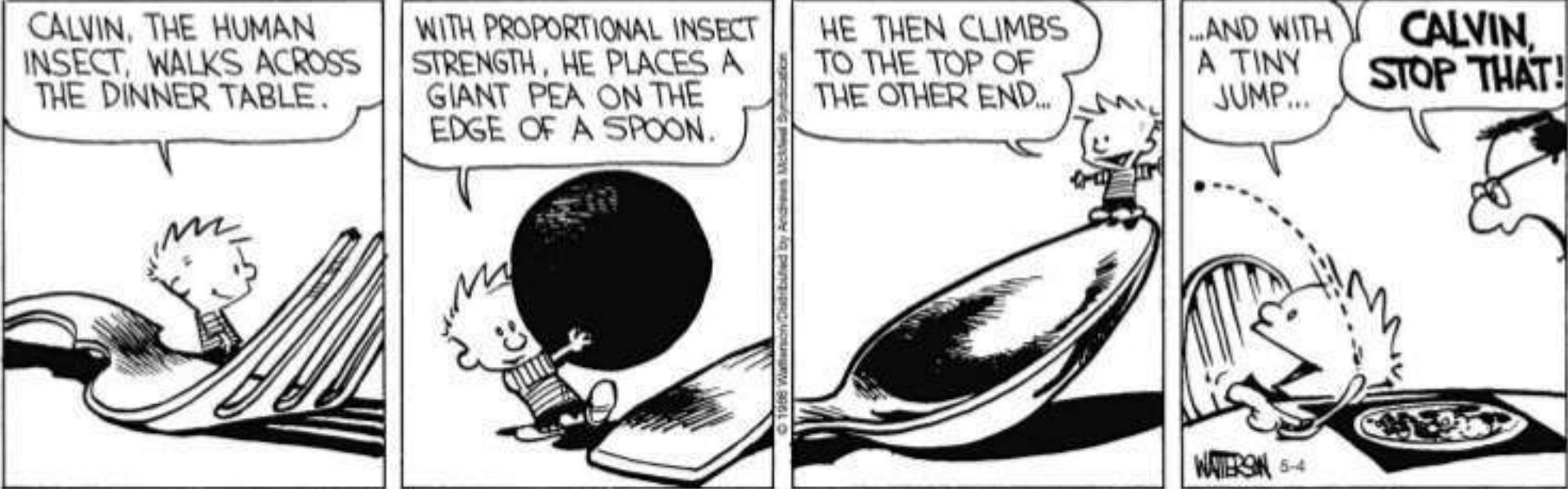
ANSWER: The significant problems we have cannot be solved at the same level of **thinking** with which we created them. - Einstein

SOLUTIONS: MIMIC, INGOT, HANGUP, VIKING

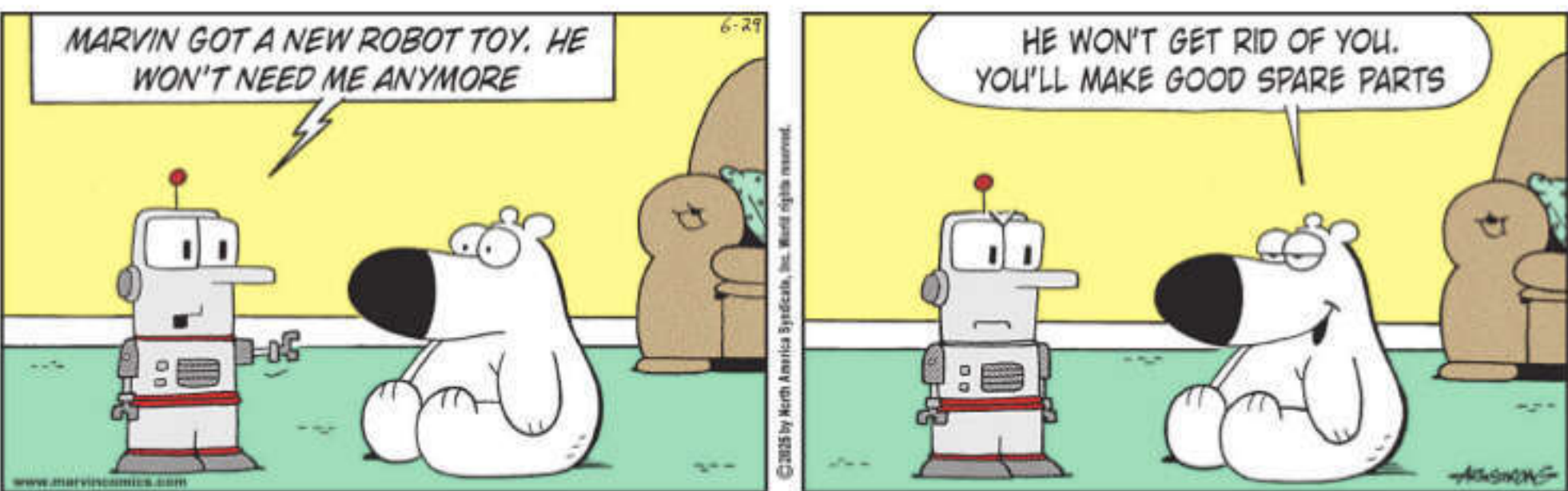
OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 3s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6403

9			1			4		
6				3	1			
			2			9	6	
			8	9	4			
2	5						9	1
			4	1	6			
	3	7			8			
		9	4					3
4			6				8	

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6402

3	8	6	9	7	1	2	4	5
2	9	4	3	8	5	7	1	6
5	7	1	4	2	6	8	9	3
1	4	8	6	9	3	5	2	7
6	3	5	2	1	7	4	8	9
9	2	7	5	4	8	6	3	1
4	6	9	1	5	2	3	7	8
7	1	3	8	6	4	9	5	2
8	5	2	7	3	9	1	6	4

ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

- ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20):** This is a fantastic day to talk with others. A sudden change of plans might cause you to see new places and meet new faces. Stay light on your feet and be ready for anything. Tonight: An unusual discussion.
- TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21):** An unexpected boon or favour might come to you from a surprising source today. This could help you in your job. You might suddenly get a boost in your health. Tonight: Check your possessions.
- GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21):** Today is full of surprises and electric energy. New romance might begin. An acquaintance might make you sit up and listen. Surprise travel opportunities might occur. Tonight: Be alert.
- CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23):** This is a restless day for you. You might want to stock the fridge, because something unexpected could impact your home scene. An unexpected but powerful discussion about shared resources might take place. Tonight: Enjoy privacy.
- LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23):** Stay on your toes today. Unexpected events will bring you in touch with others — friends, members of groups, siblings and relatives. You might meet someone unusual. Tonight: Be friendly.
- VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23):** Something unusual might occur today that affects your job or your work. It might be surprising news from a boss. Alternatively, something unexpected might affect your health or even your pet. It might relate to news from a parent, boss or an authority figure. Stay tuned. Tonight: You're noticed.
- LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23):** This is a fabulous day to talk. You feel friendly, sociable and eager to meet others. Unexpected opportunities to travel might put you in touch with someone new and exciting. Romance can blossom. Be flexible. Tonight: Learn and explore.
- SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23):** Stay in touch with your bank account and anything to do with shared property and the resources of others, because a pleasant surprise might occur today. Today is full of all kinds of possibilities, and most of them are favourable. For example, a hidden romance might begin. Tonight: Check your finances.
- SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22):** You might be happy to meet someone new today who is unusual. Something to do with your social contacts with friends and groups will surprise you. Tonight: Keep your eyes open.
- CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20):** Today is full of surprises, and for your sign, these surprises could impact your job, finances and reputation. In all likelihood, whatever happens will be favourable. It might be minor; it could be major. Tonight: Be aware.
- AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19):** A surprise opportunity to explore avenues in publishing, the media, medicine and the law might occur today. Alternatively, you might receive an exciting invitation. Keep an open mind, because today is full of fun-loving detours! Tonight: Socialise.
- PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20):** Your home routine might change today. Small appliances could break down or a minor breakage could occur. Possibly financial news will please you. This is the kind of day where detours and surprises catch people off guard, but for the most part, the outcome is fun and pleasurable. Tonight: Relax.

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
PWD CIRCLE, BIKANER

No:- 895 Dt.: 31.07.2026

NIB CODE:- PWD2627A1904
Short Term NIT NO. 04/2026-27

Bid for **Various Budget Announcement year 2026-27** works Sanctioned are invited from interested bidders upto 6.00 PM dt. 10.08.2026 (Monday) Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (<http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.raj.nic.in>) of the state and DIPR department website. The approximate values of the procurement is Rs. 794.28 Lakhs.

UBN Code No:- PWD2627WSOB08142, PWD2627WSOB08143,

Superintending Engineer,
PWD, Circle Bikaner

DIPR/C/13725/2026

Municipal Corporation, Faridabad
B.K. Chowk N.E.T. Faridabad -121001, Haryana-India
Tel.: 0129-2411649, 2411664, 2415549
Fax: 0129-2416465

TENDER NOTICE

REGARDING ILLEGAL CONVERSION OF LAND, UNAUTHORIZED USE OF BUILDING & UNAUTHORIZED CONSTRUCTION RAISED IN CONTRAVENTION TO HARYANA MUNICIPAL CORPORATION ACT, 1994 & HARYANA BUILDING CODE-2017 AMENDED FROM TIME TO TIME.

Whereas no land/plot/building/premises situated within the limits of Municipal Corporation, Faridabad, shall except with the prior permission of the Competent Authority, be used for purpose other than those for which it was used on date of publication of the notification of Controlled Area/MC Limit & no person shall erect or re-erect or commence to erect any building on his land without obtaining prior permission/approval from Competent Authority under the applicable provisions of Haryana Municipal Corporation Act, 1994 and Haryana Building Code-2017 amended from time to time.

Whereas no person/plot owner/ applicant shall occupy or allow any other person to occupy any building or part of a building or any portion whatsoever, until such building or part thereof has been certified by the Competent Authority as having been completed in accordance with the permission granted and an 'Occupation Certificate' has been issued after submission of valid NOCs and the documents as specified in Haryana Building Code-2017 amended from time to time.

Whereas this Corporation has been carried out survey of the unauthorized buildings constructed without obtaining the requisite CLU/Conversion Permission, approval of building plans, NOCs issued by Fire Department, Haryana State Pollution Control Board etc. in non-confirming and confirming land use area on regular intervals and it has been noticed by this Corporation that number of the plot/land/building owners have neither obtained conversion/CLU permission nor obtained any approval of building plans & occupation certificate from the Competent Authority and the requisite NOCs issued by concerned Departments as required for use of building/premises, therefore, this Corporation is regularly taking action against such violators indulging in unauthorized use/construction/occupation over the land/plot/buildings/premises situated within the limits of this Corporation.

Whereas this Corporation has further observed that the Insurance Companies and Public Listed Companies/Financial Institutions without ascertaining the above referred approvals, have sanctioned loan/insurance/leased in favour of such unauthorized buildings/premises or part thereof, therefore, the Insurance Companies/Public Listed Companies/Financial Institutions are hereby advised to ensure that prior to release of any loan or insurance or lease or any financial assistance to such illegal buildings/premises or part thereof and further shall ensure that the plot/land owners have possessed all valid approvals and valid NOCs issued by Competent Authority. If they have approved/sanctioned any fund/loan or insurance or any financial assistance to plot/land/building owners of such premises/against such illegal buildings and the Insurance Companies/Public Listed Companies/Financial Institutions shall be fully responsible/liable for the same, Govt./MCF/Competent Authority shall not be liable for any loss or damage, if so, incurred to the insurance companies/Public Listed Companies/Financial Institutions on this account thereof whatsoever. Furthermore, if any loss occurred to MCF, suitable action as deemed fit shall be taken against them.

Whereas this Corporation has further noticed that the plot owners of plots/land/premises through their Architect have obtained approval of building plans under self-certification through Online Building Plan Approval System for their illegally sub-divided plots/illegally converted commercial land and furthermore have raised construction in contravention with the applicable Building Bye Laws without leaving any statutory setbacks, without making parking provision within the premises, without having valid NOCs, put to use the building/premises without obtaining any approval from Competent Authority therefore through this Public Notice all such plot owners as well as the Architect who are indulged in such activities are hereby directed to revoke such building plans and bring the construction in conformity with applicable land use/building bye laws, to obtain the requisite NOCs failing which this Corporation shall definitely initiate stringent action against the violators following due course in law. The cost of enforcement occurred towards removal of such violations shall also be recovered from the violators by land arrears and the delinquent Architect should be blacklisted. Non-compliance shall also invite legal panel action against the violators/offenders.

Sd/-
Commissioner
Municipal Corporation Faridabad

NO. 47912-HRY

MAHARASHTRA METRO RAIL CORPORATION LTD.
(A joint venture of Govt. of India & Govt. of Maharashtra)
"Metro Bhavan", VIP Road, Near Dikshabhoomi, Ramdaspath, Nagpur-440010. E-mail : md.nmrc.tenders@gmail.com
(THANE INTEGRAL RING METRO PROJECT)

Tender Notice No. T1-038/DDC-06/2026 Dt. 05.08.2026

Name of work : Detailed Design Consultancy Services for the Detailed Design of Architectural and Tunnel Ventilation System (TVS), including SES Simulation and CFD Simulation of Stations and Tunnel, Environmental Control System (ECS), Building Management System (BMS), E&M Services and Proof Checking of two (02) Underground Stations (i) Thane Junction and (ii) New Thane of the Thane Integral Ring Metro Project (Section Length: Approx 3.0 km including ramps).

Cost of Documents : INR 11,800/- (inclusive of GST).

Interested Bidders may visit www.metrorailnagpur.com/ or www.thanemetrorail.com or [CPP Website : https://eprocure.gov.in](http://www.CPPWebsite.com) for NIT. Bid documents can be downloaded from <https://mahatenders.gov.in> from 16.00 Hrs of 05.08.2026.

Executive Director/ Procurement Maha-Metro

HARYANA REAL ESTATE REGULATORY AUTHORITY
New Mini Secretariat, 2nd Floor, Sector-1, Panchkula.
E-mail: hrerapkl-hry@gov.in, officer.rera.hry@gmail.com
Website: www.haryanarera.gov.in

PUBLIC NOTICE

For kind attention of allottees of the Real Estate Project of an Industrial Plotted Colony namely "The Village Business Park" to be developed over land measuring 108.006 acres situated in the revenue estate of Villages Dadauli, Ujhah, Risalu Siwah, District Panipat being developed by Waverly Infrastructure LLP.

- The above-mentioned project was registered with HRERA Panchkula vide Registration No. HRERA-PKL-PNP-321-2022 dated 29.06.2022 valid upto 25.03.2026.
- The promoter has requested the Authority that instead of revoking the registration on its expiry, the Authority may permit it to remain in force for one more year subject to such further terms and conditions as it thinks fit to impose in the interest of the allottees and any such terms and conditions so imposed shall be binding upon the promoter.
- The Authority is considering the application of the promoter to permit continuation of registration under section 7(3) of the Act for this project. However, the first right of refusal for carrying out of the remaining development works is that of the association of allottees. Therefore, the Authority hereby invites objections from the association of allottees in particular and any other concerned persons in general.
- The objections shall be filed in the registry of the Authority before 17.08.2026 which will be considered by the Authority under section 7(3) of the Act.

No. 47903/HRY

Secretary (Acting)
HRERA Panchkula

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Shahdat Khan S/o Abdul Hakim R/o C-571, New Seemapuri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 499/2021, U/s 457/380/411 IPC, PS Jagatpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Shahdat Khan** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Shahdat Khan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Shahdat Khan** of case **FIR No. 499/2021, U/s 457/380/411 IPC, PS Jagatpuri, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **21.09.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Anushtha Srivastava
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
2nd Floor, Room No. 07,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/10855/SHD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Guddu S/o Ajay Mathur R/o H. No. 293, Street No. 15, Phase 10, Shiv Vihar, Karawal Nagar, Delhi** also at **H. No. 121, Street No. 2, 2nd Pusta, Sector 10, Khoda Colony, Uttar Pradesh** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 158/2024 U/s 25/54/59 ARMS ACT, PS Karawal Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Guddu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Guddu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Guddu in FIR No. 158/2024 U/s 25/54/59 ARMS ACT, PS Karawal Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **28.09.2026**.

By order
Ms. Isra Zaidi
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04
North-East District
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/10829/NE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED
See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Sandeep Khatri @ Annu @ Sonu S/o Prem Singh R/o H. No. 295, Water Pump Wali Gali, Near Post Office, Bakner, Narela, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case **FIR No. 156/25 u/s 25 Arms Act at P.S. Crime Branch, Prashant Vihar, Rohini, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Sandeep Khatri @ Annu @ Sonu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Sandeep Khatri @ Annu @ Sonu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 84 Bhartiya Nagrik Suraksha Sanhita has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sandeep Khatri @ Annu @ Sonu** accused of or is suspected to have committed) the offence case **FIR No. 156/25 u/s 25 Arms Act at P.S. Crime Branch, Prashant Vihar, Rohini, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.09.2026**.

By Order: **Ms. Priyanka Rajpoot,**
Chief Judicial Magistrate (North)
Room No. 115, 1st Floor,
Rohini Court, New Delhi

DP/10907/Crime/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.PC.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused persons, namely, **Dhanwanti W/o Bal Kishan R/o 16/1639E Top Floor, Gali No. 20, Arya Samaj Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi,** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CC No. 4048/2022, U/S: 138 NI Act,** registered at **P.S.: Patel Nagar, New Delhi,** and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Dhanwanti,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Dhanwanti,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Dhanwanti, CC No. 4048/2022, U/S: 138 NI Act,** registered at **P.S.: Patel Nagar, New Delhi,** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **21.09.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Anshul Singhal
Judicial Magistrate First Class- 04
Room No. 268, North Dist.,
Tis Hazari Court, New Delhi

DP/10745/CD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Pawan Kumar, S/o.Babu, R/o.: Foot Path Back Side Aam Admi Party Office, I.P. Estate, Delhi** Also at: **Village Ghadhati, P.S. Hardi, District Bahraich, Uttar Pradesh** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No. 387/2025 U/S 305(e)/331(4)/317(2)/3(5) BNS** registered at **P.S. I.P Estate, Central District, New Delhi,** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said **Pawan Kumar** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Pawan Kumar** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Pawan Kumar,** accused of **FIR No. 387/2025 U/S 305(e)/331(4)/317(2)/3(5) BNS, P.S. I.P Estate, Central District, New Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.11.2026**.

By Order, **Ms. Preeti,**
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03 (Central)
Central District, Room No. 150,
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi.

DP/10674/CD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.PC.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Manish Goyal, R/o: A/MCF-147, Main Road Near Nand Kishor Medical Store, Vishnu Colony, Ballabgarh, Faridabad, Haryana** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case Reg No.: 5003/23, U/s: 138 NI ACT, P.S. Maurya Enclave, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Manish Goyal** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Manish Goyal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Manish Goyal of P.S. Maurya Enclave, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **28.09.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Aakanksha
JMFC-03, 1st Floor, Room No. 107,
North West, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/10348/NW/2026

India to field separate squads for Brazil friendly, ASEAN Cup: AIFF



Kalyan Chaubey, AIFF
Express News Service
New Delhi, August 6

THE ALL India Football federation (AIFF) on Thursday announced that India will play the international friendly against Brazil on October 3 as well as take part in the FIFA ASEAN Cup in Indonesia, set from September 24 to October 3. The football body said that two separate squads will be announced for the Brazil match as well as the ASEAN Cup.

“One of the principal decisions taken during the meeting was to confirm India’s participation in both — the men’s international friendly against five-time FIFA World champions Brazil, scheduled to be played in Kolkata on October 3, 2026, and the FIFA ASEAN Cup in Indonesia from September 24 to October 3, 2026,” AIFF said in a statement after an executive committee meeting in Delhi on Thursday.

“The Executive Committee recognised the match against Brazil, to be played during the FIFA International Match Window, as a unique opportunity to provide Indian players with invaluable exposure against one of the world’s strongest footballing nations. Accordingly, the AIFF will formally notify FIFA that India will participate in both competitions by fielding separate squads for the match against Brazil and the FIFA ASEAN Cup,” it added.

Last week, AIFF had announced that India will face Brazil at the Salt Lake Stadium in Kolkata on October 3.

AIFF gives Jamshedpur FC until Aug 12 to reconsider ISL pullout

AIFF also extended the deadline for Jamshedpur FC to reconsider its decision to pull out of the Indian Super League (ISL), giving the Tata Steel-owned club time until August 12 to review its stand. The decision was taken at the AIFF Executive Committee meeting here, where members reviewed preparations for the upcoming ISL season, beginning September 4, following the adoption of the new club-led commercial model.

“The AIFF will allow additional time to Jamshedpur FC to reconsider its decision, with an extended deadline until August 12, 2026,” the federation said in a statement after the Executive Committee meeting. “The Executive Committee also reviewed preparations for the Indian Super League 2026-27 season following the adoption of the new club-led commercial model. Members were updated on the progress made by the participating clubs and the federation in operational planning for the season,” the AIFF added.

• NO LAUGHING MATTER

Rithvik dealing in attacking counters, like his comedian grandfather

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, August 6

IT NEVER ends with just one diving save in badminton. India’s national men’s singles champion Rithvik Sanjeevi Sathish Kumar has known that all along. The signature dives on both flanks in defence need to keep coming; the fight goes on even if it’s a 21-11, 21-10 defeat in qualification like it was at the Taipei Open last week. The applause reached a crescendo for champion Tanvi Sharma, but 23-year-old Rithvik has to make do with pre-success silence.

He leans for inspiration on the early struggles of his illustrious maternal grandfather, Tamil cinema’s iconic actor and comedian Goundamani (Subramanian Karuppayya), known for his acidic wit and sense of satire.

FAMILIAR FAILINGS

India relearn how to play spin — focus on sweep shot, using feet

After back-to-back home whitewashes exposed India’s batting against turning ball, coach Gambhir’s side arrives in Sri Lanka with a challenge to overcome

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, August 6

HAVING FLOWN in 10 days ahead of the first Test in Galle, India begin their preparations for a crucial series with a warm-up fixture against SLC XI at Colombo’s NCC, where the focus lies firmly on the batting group. Two things sit at the top of their priority list: use the sweep shot, and use the feet. In the recent home series debacles against New Zealand and South Africa, where they were whitewashed in their own backyard, the failure of the batsmen to adjust to spin-friendly conditions led to their downfall. Later next week, at Galle and Colombo, they are expected to face a similar trial by spin against a strong Sri Lanka spin attack.

As India began their preparations in Colombo with a couple of practice sessions, the message from head coach Gautam Gambhir was clear. “Come 15th morning, whether we are batting first, whether we are bowling first, we’re absolutely ready with every answer, every question that’s thrown at us and every answer we are ready to give. So make sure we tick all the boxes from now on,” he told BCCI.tv.

The homework

This may sound elementary in spin-friendly conditions, but it is exactly what this batting group has failed to apply in the middle, allowing the spinners to tie them down to the crease and lead them into a shell.

Using the sweep and the feet to get down the track isn’t a blind strategy or a last resort. In Sri Lanka, batsmen who have succeeded over the past decade have relied on these factors to

great effect. Steve Smith and Cheteshwar Pujara used their feet to smother the turn and disrupt the length of the host spinners; Usman Khawaja and Alex Carey relied extensively on the sweep, reverse-sweep included, on tracks that aided turn. Even Sri Lankan batsmen, who aren’t fluent when it comes to using their feet, have preferred the sweep, with Dinesh Chandimal, against India at Galle in 2015, and Kusal Mendis being cases in point.

The reasons to use these shots are manifold, but the most important is that they ensure batsmen aren’t tied up at one end, which ultimately gives the spinners more opportunity to lay a trap. “When the ball is spinning, you can’t play straight,” former India batsman Robin Singh says. “The guard you take becomes important, and you have to change through the course of a Test depending on how much it is turning. The key element for a batsman is to get off the strike.”

It is simple, but it is exactly what India’s batting group failed to do against South Africa. Once the opponent covered their scoring pockets, Indian batsmen were unable to find certain areas, in particular the square on either side, preferring to wait for loose deliveries to arrive. On tracks where a ball with your name can arrive at any moment, that played into the hands of the opposition. Both Simon Harmer and Ajaz Patel happily accepted the generosity of the Indian batsmen.

The Sri Lanka threat

Which is why, ahead of the Sri Lanka Test, a major part of the Indian batsmen’s home-



Rishabh Pant is among the few Indian batters who has used his feet effectively against spin. CREIMAS

• India batters in NZ, SA home series

PLAYER	MAT	INNS	OVERALL RUNS	AVG	RUNS V SPIN	OUT V SPIN	AVG V SPIN
Rishabh Pant	5	10	310	31	246	6	41
Yashasvi Jaiswal	5	10	273	27.3	164	6	27.33
Washington Sundar	4	8	213	35.5	175	6	29.17
Ravindra Jadeja	5	10	210	21	180	7	25.71
Sarfraz Khan	3	6	171	28.5	132	4	23.25
Shubman Gill	3	5	148	37	122	4	30.5
KL Rahul	3	6	80	13.33	41	3	13.67
Dhruv Jurel	2	4	29	7.25	4	3	1.33
B Sai Sudharsan	1	2	29	14.5	27	2	13.5

work has been on using the sweep against left-arm spinners and the feet against off-spinners, to reduce the risk factor. In Prabath Jayasuriya, they face a left-arm spinner who relentlessly attacks the stumps. There is Dhananjaya de Silva’s off-spin to handle, alongside Ramesh Mendis and the ambidextrous Kamindu Mendis. Beyond them, Sri

Lanka can always produce a gem out of nowhere for the novelty factor.

“If a left-arm spinner is bowling quick, you need to be aggressive against him and make him change the length. If you use the feet, he will alter the trajectory. And when someone is fighting the ball, if you don’t use feet, you become tentative. You won’t be defending confi-

dently. So when you use the feet, you will ensure the turn is taken care of, and you can play against or with the spin,” Robin says.

Among the current crop of Indian batsmen, few have been effective when it comes to using their feet against spin. Rishabh Pant has been an exception, but beyond him it is only KL Rahul who has shown the willingness to step out. That is why even the sweep shot has been used as another fall-back option, but here again, India’s batting group rarely uses the shot.

Robin also has advice on how to play the sweep. “In Sri Lanka the bounce is usually low. If you want to sweep, do it against a length delivery in front of the square. If you stretch forward and play in front of square, you are taking LBW out of the equation. If not, play it from outside off stump, because with the spin, it will take the ball into the gaps. As a batsman, have your own plans. When the ball is turning a lot, you can play the pull or a lot of shots on the back foot.”

Pragg survives as Sindarov wastes winning chance

Mayank Chaudhary
New Delhi, August 6

FOR FOUR straight days in Saint Louis, Javokhir Sindarov chased R. Praggnanandhaa with everything he had. Despite his best efforts, catching the Indian felt like hunting a shadow. The Uzbek had done everything right too, staying unbeaten throughout the Rapid section, but Pragg was always one step ahead at every turn. But on Thursday, when he finally had his foot on the Indian’s throat, he blinked to snatch a draw from the jaws of a certain victory.

On Day 1 of the Blitz section, Sindarov turned up the heat from the start. A hat-trick of wins from rounds four to six accelerated his pursuit, and then came the moment he had been waiting for.

In the penultimate round of the day, Sundarov finally had the man he was hunting across

the board. After days of chasing, the World Championship challenger had the Indian in his sights with one full point up for grabs.

Praggnanandhaa may have been in inspired form, but a red-hot Sindarov is as relentless an opponent as they come. The two were evenly matched: their earlier Rapid clash had ended in a draw, and both had identical win counts in Blitz heading into this clash. The colours, too, suited the script as Sindarov wielded white, a collier with which he had already dismantled Fabiano Caruana and Leinier Dominguez Pérez. Praggnanandhaa, on the other hand, had black, the colour of all three of his wins.

It was the perfect battlefield for two warriors ready to test their blades and they proved worthy of each other. In the English Opening, both went for quick exchanges, with knights and light-squared bishops



Pragg leads with 18 points. FIDE

being the first minor pieces to leave the board.

Soon, the other knight and bishop were traded, and the game drifted into a draw-prone rook endgame. But this was Blitz, and the clock was always going to have the final say. The

script also played out perfectly as Praggnanandhaa made not one but two costly mistakes, trading both rooks at the wrong moment. Suddenly, the writing was on the wall for him. Sindarov was marching his pawns forward, backed by an active king. It seemed only a matter of time before the Indian would taste his first loss of the day.

Both players were deep in a severe time scramble when Sindarov found the winning move: 41... c5. The final nail was seemingly in the coffin. Praggnanandhaa was, by then, on the ropes.

Big blunder

Then came an almighty collapse, out of the blue. With just one second left on the clock, Sindarov retreated his king back to f4. Praggnanandhaa could not believe his luck. He was right back in the fight, handed a lifeline he had no right to expect.

The winning chances disappeared in an instant. Sindarov, forced to share the spoils, pulled the plug on a game that would have stung the Indian more than the loss he had endured against Jorden van Foreest. Explaining his decision to play 43.Kf4?, Sindarov said “I saw I’m winning with any move.” Except he played the only move that cost him.

Praggnanandhaa ended his day as the sole leader of both the Blitz and the overall tournament, having already won the Rapid section earlier. His wins over Vincent Keymer, van Foreest, and Pérez, combined with six draws, gave him six points from nine Blitz rounds. He remained on top, with Levon Aronian and Sindarov trailing just half a point behind.

On the overall leaderboard, Praggnanandhaa sits comfortably with 18 points, while Sindarov is currently second with 16.5 points.

• BRIEFLY



Mohamed Salah scored 257 goals for Liverpool. AP

EGYPTIAN KING IN TURKEY

Liverpool icon Salah agrees to 2-year contract with Trabzonspor

EGYPT INTERNATIONAL Salah was a free agent after leaving Liverpool at the end of last season. He flew to Istanbul on Wednesday to complete his move to Trabzonspor and was greeted by throngs of fans on his arrival. His official signing ceremony was taking place later Thursday. The 34-year-old Salah established himself as a Premier League great with Liverpool where he won two league titles and the Champions League among eight major honors. He scored 257 goals in 442 appearances for the Merseyside club and is regarded as one of its greatest players of all time. He still had a year to run on his contract at Liverpool, but in March he announced he would leave the club after a disappointing campaign, in which he scored only 12 goals. AP

England recall Lawrence for Pakistan Tests

DAN LAWRENCE was recalled by England after two years on Thursday to play in the first test against Pakistan and Jacob Bethell was ruled out of the three-match series by a right knee injury. The post-Ben Stokes era starts in Leeds on Aug. 19 and Surrey batting allrounder Lawrence will have the first crack at trying to fill the prodigious shoes of the former test captain. He is set to bat at No. 6 with Jamie Smith likely to slot in one place lower down, while Bethell being sidelined has opened the door for Jordan Cox at first drop in the batting order. AP

3 T20Is added to India women’s S. Africa tour

THE CRICKET South Africa (CSA) on Thursday revised the schedule of India women’s team tour later this year to accommodate three T20Is, which is in addition to a Test and three ODIs. As per the revised itinerary, the one-off Test will be played from December 9-12 before the ODI series kicks in from December 16-22. Now, the Indian team will spend an extra week in South Africa to play the T20I series between December 26 and 30. The T20Is will be played at Benoni and Potchefstroom, which the CSA felt will give both the sides a good platform going into the inaugural Women’s Champions Trophy, which will be played in Sri Lanka in February. “We are delighted to confirm the revised schedule for India’s tour of South Africa,” said Pholetsi Moseki, the CSA CEO. PTI

Suraj, Marta win titles at World Uni squash

SURAJ KUMAR Chand won India’s first men’s singles gold at the FISU World University Championship Squash in 16 years, here on Thursday. Suraj of the hosts Somaiya Vidyavihar University defeated Hungary’s Benedek Takacs 5-11, 11-8, 11-5, 6-11, 11-4 in a thrilling final. The victory marked India’s first men’s singles gold at the FISU World University Championship Squash in 16 years. Spain’s Marta Dominguez Fernandez retained the women’s singles title with an 11-3, 11-7, 11-7 win over Hong Kong China’s Ching Hei Fung. PTI

Three Indians in finals of U20 Athletics C’ships

JAVELIN THROWERS Ashish Yadav and T Dharanidharan along with discus thrower Amanat Kamboj qualified for the final rounds in a decent opening day performance by the Indians at the World Athletics U20 Championships here. Yadav topped the men’s javelin Group A qualification round with a throw of 69.87m and ended at second spot overall, behind South Africa’s title favourite Jan-Hendrik Heymans who won Group B with a 76.02m throw. The 19-year-old Indian has a season’s best of 74.49m, which is also his personal best. Heymans was the lone competitor to breach the automatic qualification mark of 72.50m. Dharanidharan made it to the final round, taking the 12th. Those who breached the automatic qualifying mark will be in the final on Friday. PTI



Rithvik Sanjeevi gleans inspiration from his grandfather Gaundamani (top right). SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

like effortless humour, takes time to land. Last week, an experimental serve that Rithvik had practised a hundred times in training, turned comedic as

it flew way wide. He turned it into a self-effacing meme. In his early loss in Taipei, there was one rally full of various deceptive strokes - pointing to his im-



mense talent that might not always translate into wins. But his family – father S.B. Satish Kumar, a college athlete, mother C.M. Selvi, a constant motivator, and sister, who took up badminton two decades ago, remain totems in his career.

Hard grind

His last title came mid-June, an International Challenge at Valance, France. But for the World No.77, India’s ninth-best

ranked, the game is a patient meditation in learning to explode with his big smashing attack.

Malaysian legend Misbun Sidek had said, “Rithvik is a good, aggressive player. Hard-working and explosive, but he has to start trusting that he can maintain consistency with intensity. He has to accept that it’s not easy to cover the full court to match the Indonesians and Chinese.” Following his older sister into the sport, Rithvik had a coaching stint in Hyderabad but returned homesick, joining Hatsu at 14.

“I would watch countless videos of my idol Lee Chong Wei and sit and analyse with my coaches,” he recalls. At the academy, his net play improved alongside the hitting rhythm of his aggressive smashes.

Misbun would hit them

with high-intensity sessions that were a reality check on the level of fitness required. “All matches are not the same. You have to change your strategy. But fitness is constant,” he says. A knee injury during a 10K run had put an end to long runs, but the title in France was reaffirming given how he navigated the three-game contests. A step-up to Super 300s though will need resilience.

“Listen to music, I don’t get stuck on Indian food when travelling for tournaments and stay motivated learning from my family,” he says, adding that be it sport or movies, hard work remains key, as does keeping it look effortless. Rithvik’s search for a meal in Vietnam after a late match had led him to beef noodle soup Pho. On the court, like Goundamani, Rithvik deals in attacking counters.

Blood, sweat, tears and a bronze

Tejaswin Shankar on how he overcame injury-triggered adversity to win CWG medal in the decathlon

Nihal Koshie
New Delhi, August 6

AFTER COMPLETING a victory lap of the Scotstoun Stadium to celebrate a decathlon bronze medal, Tejaswin Shankar stood in the middle of the arena to relish the moment.

Then he did what Novak Djokovic famously does after winning Wimbledon. Tejaswin, the first Indian to win a Commonwealth Games medal in decathlon, plucked some grass from the turf and chewed it. Severe pain because of tendinitis in his right knee — or jumpers' knee in athletes' parlance — had forced Tejaswin to pull out of the high jump. His chances of a decathlon medal seemed all but over, but redemption was swift.

"It was surreal. For a few seconds, I was still wondering how I won a Commonwealth medal with one-and-a-half legs. I started walking to the stand where my wife and mom were sitting. Someone gave me an Indian flag. We took a victory lap. An Indian security guard said he felt proud. I felt like it was a movie. Then I went to the infield, and like Djokovic, ate some grass," Tejaswin told *The Indian Express*.

Olympic medallists Damian Warner (silver) and Lindon Victor (gold) were among the 12 competitors. Before he shed tears of joy, Tejaswin had bawled like a child three days earlier when his knee acted up. Video clips of him crying in the mixed zone emerged, but that is only half the picture.

"When I walked into the mixed zone, I was asked a question. I spoke three sentences. I went behind a banner, and started sobbing like a baby. I am usually good at keeping my emotions to myself. I was 100

percent convinced that the decathlon was also over for me," Tejaswin said.

Decathlon was scheduled to start two days later. That night, Tejaswin was on ChatGPT searching for a ray of hope. He slept only at 3am and woke up by 6am. He spent the morning thinking how he would spend time around Indian teammates in Glasgow, knowing that he had done nothing of note.

The diagnosis of Dinshaw Pardiwala, the team doctor, was comforting.

"Dr Pardiwala did some tests and said there was no rupture. The negative was that the knee was very inflamed so even if I competed in the decathlon, I would be in severe pain," the athlete recalled. "Pain can be managed but it depends on how your body responds, the doctor said. Painkillers will bring the pain down, and the hope was that the adrenaline would take over. I was wondering if it would be better to skip the CWG and focus all my energy on the Asian Games."

Following this, strength and conditioning coach Wayne Lombard and India team physio Mayur Thakkar resurrected his CWG. The latter asked Tejaswin if he wanted to fight or not "I half-heartedly said yes. Mayur guaranteed me that I would be ready to start the decathlon on July 30."

Bouncing back

Thakkar and Lombard spent eight hours a day, for the next two days, to get Tejaswin ready to compete. The South African found a rehabilitation clinic in Quarriers village, which had a hyperbaric oxygen chamber and red-light therapy. "The village was about 40-45 minutes from our hotel. We did



Tejaswin Shankar won India's first-ever combined events medal at the Commonwealth Games. FILE

Before he shed tears of joy, Tejaswin had bawled like a child three days earlier when his knee acted up.

whatever we could to fix the knee in the short span of two days. Physio Mayur's soft tissue treatment helped. All these things came together," Tejaswin said.

The clinic posted on Instagram about Tejaswin's visit when he won a medal. He replied, thanking them. On the first morning of the competition, Tejaswin rolled his ankle while on the treadmill. Luckily for him, it was just a scare. During the first event, the 100 metres, his mind was all over the place and he forgot to stay low in the drive phase (first 30 metres).

"I was just flustered. Once the race was over, only then did I realise that the decathlon's first event was over. Because at that time, I was more worried about the knee."

However, his fortunes im-

proved in the long jump. A personal best of 7.82 metres was a boost. "It was much needed and put me back in contention. My first jump was decent... around 7.40 metres. I had a bad landing and a half-hearted take-off, a whole shoe length behind the (take-off) board. So I decided to make the most of the next jump. When the reading came out I knew I was back in contention. That single moment flipped everything. I was back in the competition mentally."

Ahead of the decathlon high jump, Tejaswin was worried about aggravating the pain in his knee.

"In both the long jump and high jump, I have the same leg (right) for take off. That is why I was more worried about these two events. In high jump, at that particular angle when I plant my foot, I feel the pain. I was also experiencing post-traumatic stress due to what had happened two days prior. I could slowly feel the pain coming back. I took limited jumps. Once I crossed 2.15m, I tried to clear 2.18 and then 2.21. It was a gamble."

After day one, Shankar was in second place but despite a personal best in the discus throw (40.44m), he slipped to fourth after the pole vault — the third-last event. But the javelin throw changed his fortunes.

"The only time I thought I was in contention for a medal was after the javelin. Because I had to throw over 50 metres in order and the guy above me (Sammy Ball) has a better personal best in the 1,500m. In javelin, I executed the plan with 53.12 metres and Sammy threw only 44 metres (44.88 metres), though he is a 50-53 metre thrower. So after javelin, I got a good lead over him, and he had to do something miraculous (in 1,500m) to get the bronze."

The biggest takeaway for Tejaswin was how he bounced back when everything seemed lost. "I proved that in the face of adversity, I can still figure it out. This experience is what is needed if you want to compete with these guys at the Olympic Games and World Championships. In those competitions, it is not about who has the better personal best but who is able to manage emotions."

Philippines falls in love with tennis, thanks Eala's rise

Express News Service
Mumbai, August 6

A 21-year-old tennis player with a bright smile and an array of rasping groundstrokes is making a country fall in love with a sport it had barely bothered about. The racquet sport had seldom struck a chord in the Philippines, its allegiance split between basketball and boxing, but after Alexandra Eala's exploits — becoming the first from her country to win a WTA title, when she triumphed at the Mubadala DC Open in Washington DC after reaching the Round of 16 in Wimbledon last June - tennis has become a sudden rage in her country.

Thousands welcomed Eala when she returned home, while president Ferdinand Marcos hosted a reception in her honour at Malacanang Palace in Manila.

Hundreds now swarm her for autographs and selfies, while earlier she used to pass off anonymously. The stands are packed with her supporters, thanks to the sizable Filipino immigrant population around the world. Daniel Vallverdu, the Washington event's tournament director, said in a press conference that there has been an unprecedented demand for tickets.

"Over the last month, the ticketing team says at least 80 percent, if not more, of the requests in this tournament are about 'when is Alex Eala playing?'" he said. Among Eala's horde of admirers is legendary Filipino boxer Manny Pacquiao, still the nation's most famous sporting star. "She's becoming a national hero. Everyone is starting to stop what they're doing and tune in to watch her matches. I don't miss any of her games," he said.

The once unused courts in Manila are filling up with aspiring tennis players. "Everyone comes up to me whenever I go back to Manila saying it's so



Alexandra Eala won the Mubadala DC Open. REUTERS

hard to get courts ... that's a good thing because when I was younger, the courts were empty. Nobody was playing. And there were kind of one or two courts in the city," Eala said. She says she was surprised by the watch parties back home. "I have never seen so many people watching tennis in the Philippines."

But it's the sport she had grown up watching all throughout her life, thanks to her tennis crazy grandfather Bob.

"He was more of a club player, not really a coach. He would just go to the club and play a bit, and teach the basics to some of our family members," she said during Wimbledon. She started playing with him just "to bond with him." Gradually, it became an obsession for both — Eala to win more games and Bob to groom her. "I went to train with my brother and my grandfather every day after school with my ruffled socks and my light-up shoes and my chubby cheeks..." she said.

He taught tennis to her brother as well, so that she always had a sparring partner. "He (brother) is a good player, and beats me even now," Eala told Clay magazine.

Turning point

Sweeping titles at local tournaments became a routine, but the big breakthrough came when she won a scholarship to train at the Rafael Nadal Tennis Academy in Manacor in 2018. Five years later, she turned professional and seven years on, one of the most exciting tennis talents in the world.

But her grandfather barely saw her career soar, as he passed away soon after she became a professional. But every time she wins a match, his memories fill her heart.

"Every time I do something important, I think of him. He worked so hard and sacrificed so much for me. I think he, together with my parents, contributed greatly to my behaviour on court, my mindset and my mental strength," she said in a media interaction during Wimbledon.

Praise has flown from former tennis stars and pundits. Former British number one Greg Rusedski has hailed Eala as "the most exciting player on the WTA Tour".

"She is fearless, she takes the ball early, she is a lefty," he said on his podcast Off Court With Greg Rusedski. "Her mentality is so good and so strong," he recently said. "The one area she needs in her game to win a major is to get that serve a bit better and more powerful. Maybe next year, if she can get that improvement on the serve, she's definitely in the mix [for a major] because the rest of her game is there."

2003 US Open champion and former World No.1 Andy Roddick lauded Eala's courage. "She is just not scared to go against the top players," the American said. "For some reason, what she does with switching directions and accepting pace and pinning people in corners, she is a name nobody wants to see early in a draw as a top player." And she is making a country previously apathetic to tennis fall in love with it.



औषध विभाग
Department of
Pharmaceuticals

9th edition of

INDIA MEDICAL
DEVICE

2026



Theme:

Towards Viksit Bharat:

Advancing India as a Global Hub for Quality Medical Devices

📅 August 7-8, 2026 | 📍 Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi

CHIEF GUEST

MINISTERIAL SESSION8th AUG, 2026

Shri Jagat Prakash Nadda
Hon'ble Union Minister of Chemicals and
Fertilizers and Health & Family Welfare
Government of India

KEY SESSION THEMES



Medical Device Component Manufacturing
in India: Promoting Atmanirbharta through
Localization



Ministerial Session: Atmanirbhar
MedTech – Accelerating India's Journey
towards Viksit Bharat



Efficient Utilization of Existing Testing
Lab Infrastructure for the Medical Device
Industry (Workshop)



Building Technology Leadership in
High-Impact and High-Volume
Medical Devices



Use of AI in Healthcare and
Emergence of India as a SaMD
Powerhouse



Strengthening Clinical Evidence for
Quality Medical Devices: Regulatory
Pathways and Data Generation



Reimbursement Mechanisms for Innovative
Therapies in India's Path to Universal
Health Coverage (UHC)



Transforming India's Medical Device
Sector into an Export Powerhouse



Strengthening Service & Maintenance
Ecosystem for Medical Equipment
in India

OUR SPONSORS

Platinum Sponsor



Diamond Sponsors



Gold Sponsors



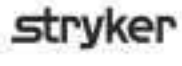
Lanyard Sponsor



Support Partner



Silver Sponsors



Badge Sponsor



Session Sponsors



Knowledge Partners



Pen Sponsor



Corporate Sponsors



Media Partner



Association Partners



 IndiaMedicalDev

 ficcimedicaldevices

 ficci_india

 indiamedexpo.in

Vol XCIV- 232 Regd.No. DL-21046/03-05 R.N.I.No.506/1957. Printed and Published by Ramesh Chander Malhotra on behalf of The Indian Express (P) Limited and Printed at The Indian Express (P) Limited Press, A-8, Sector-7, Noida - 201301 and Published at The Indian Express (P) Limited, Mezzanine Floor, Express Building, 9 & 10, Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi-110002. Editorial office: The Indian Express (P) Limited, Mezzanine Floor, Express Building, 9 & 10, Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi-110002. Phone: 0120-6651500. Advertising office: The Indian Express (P) Ltd., Express Building, B1/B, Rammath Goenka Marg, Sector 10, Noida-201301. Phone: 0120-6651291. Chairman of the Board: Viveck Goenka, Chief Editor: Raj Kamal Jha, Editor: Unni Rajen Shanker, Editor (Delhi): Monojit Majumdar ** **Responsible for selection of News under the PRP Act. Copyright: The Indian Express (P) Limited. All rights reserved. Reproduction in any manner, electronic or otherwise, in whole or in part, without prior written permission is prohibited. The Indian Express®

epaper.indianexpress.com

New Delhi